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Mistrial but no end in Clancy case



ABOVE: SJC; GREG DERR/THE PATRIOT LEDGER/POOL

Lindsay Clancy and her lawyer, Kevin Reddington, during the emergency SJC hearing. Reddington (right) sought a delay in the declaration of a mistrial. Judge William Sullivan (left) gave him an hour to appeal to the state's highest court.



Defense loses last-minute bid to remove juror

By Shelley Murphy and Travis Andersen
GLOBE STAFF
and Bryan Hecht and Chloe Craft
GLOBE CORRESPONDENTS

PLYMOUTH — After 38 hours of deliberation over seven days, a mistrial was declared Friday in Lindsay Clancy's murder trial after jurors alerted the judge they were hopelessly deadlocked over whether she is criminally responsible for killing her three children in 2023.

►What happens next is largely up to the district attorney. B1.

"It is with a heavy heart we report we are unable to come to a unanimous decision," jurors wrote. It was the fourth time since Tuesday they signaled they were at an impasse.

Superior Court Judge William F. Sullivan granted the mistrial after a last-minute appeal to a single justice of the state's highest court by Clancy's attorney, who challenged the judge's refusal to remove the single juror who appeared to be a holdout.

Once that appeal was denied, Sullivan called jurors into the courtroom and told them they were being released.

Two jurors, including one who buried her face in her hands, cried as the judge declared the case officially over and thanked them for working so hard.

The ruling capped an extraordinary period of tension and drama over whether one juror, whom Clancy's attorney claimed was the lone holdout against acquittal, was refusing to follow the judge's

VERDICT, Page A6

Crime and coverage combined for media spectacle

By Aidan Ryan
GLOBE STAFF

PLYMOUTH — Just before 8:30 Friday morning, under a thick fog, a line of photographers and reporters waited in a row behind Plymouth Superior Court for the daily start of the Lindsay Clancy murder trial. When attorney Kevin Reddington approached from his car, they bolted forward, surrounding him with a mass of mics, cameras, and cell-phones.

Photographers, some walking backward to keep up, repeatedly yelled at Reddington to step to the podium. One had a visible cut above his nose after he was hit; another person fell to the ground.

"This is not normal," one

quipped.

Once again, a suburban Massachusetts courthouse was the center of a media maelstrom this week, as people across the world followed the trial of Lindsay Clancy, the Duxbury mom charged with killing her three children. Amid extended jury deliberations, and despite little new news, the media circus grew by the day until Friday's declaration of a mistrial — a spectacle highlighting how the combination of social media, enthusiasm for true crime, and wall-to-wall news coverage can set off a firestorm.

It is, of course, the third trial-turned-media-event south of Boston in the last few years, on the heels of the two Karen Read trials, in 2024

and 2025. And while the attention is national, it is felt most intensely here in our backyard, said Kathryn Coduto, assistant professor of media science at Boston University who researches true crime.

"I think the Boston media environment helps some of these cases to take off in a national spotlight," she said. "That combination of this rich media industry alongside the growth of interest in crime stories, it kind of makes it a perfect recipe for a story like this."

There has always been a gap between the trial as it happens in the courtroom and the trial as it is communicated to the public. Ever since the start of nationally televised tri-

MEDIA, Page A7

Legal experts unsurprised by SJC decision not to intervene

By Mike Damiano, Laura Crimaldi, and John R. Ellement
GLOBE STAFF

Over just a few short hours Friday, the fate of accused murderer Lindsay Clancy rested on an extraordinary legal battle that went all the way to the state's highest court, as her lawyer sought to have a holdout juror removed from the trial.

But ultimately, legal analysts said, attorney Kevin Reddington's argument that a rogue juror was refusing to follow legal instructions was always going to be a long shot and that a mistrial seemed inevitable.

Courts are extremely hesitant to intervene in jury deliberations and generally only do so when a juror's honesty or impartiality can be called into doubt, lawyers said in interviews with the Globe.

And, in the Clancy case, they said, that high bar was not met.

On Friday afternoon, Judge William F. Sullivan made official what had seemed clear for days: The jury was hopelessly deadlocked. He declared a mistrial.

Sullivan's decision followed two days of legal wrangling that included Clancy's defense attorney, Kevin Reddington, accusing a holdout ju-

ANALYSIS, Page A6

Blue Hill Ave. plan adds parking spots

But center-running bus lane still a key feature

By Diti Kohli
GLOBE STAFF

For years, residents and politicians have railed against the plan to reconfigure Blue Hill Avenue and the impact that proposed bus and bike lanes could unleash on the busy corridor through the heart of Black Boston.

Now city officials and the MBTA say they've funneled those concerns into a new design that preserves a controversial center-running bus lane but significantly expands the portions of the boulevard with two traffic lanes on each side.

The new plan shrinks the amount of proposed bike lanes to dedicate more of the road to motor vehicle travel and parking between Grove Hall and Mattapan Square, effectively creating a more car-friendly design.

Mayor Michelle Wu billed the plan as a "generationally transformational" layout, with \$163 million in improvements to public transit and other public works that she said the

BLUE HILL AVENUE, Page A10

Turnpike rest stops, there when you need them

By Billy Baker
GLOBE STAFF

THE MASS. PIKE — Fiona Wong looks around to make sure no one can hear her, then drops her voice to a whisper before she commits the cardinal sin of stating the obvious.

REPORTER'S NOTEBOOK

"This place is low-key dingy," she says as she glances at the ... well, there's not much to look at. "But I low-key like it."

Wong is a teenager who works at the Dunkin' inside the Westborough Service Plaza on the Mass. Pike.

If your bladder lives in the Bay State, you probably know this rest stop, or its more-or-less identical twins on the pike in Framingham, Natick, and Charlton (East and West).

Their familiarity and identity are, for many travelers, so ingrained in the brain that you navigate them instinctually. Your mind knows where the McDonald's is located. It knows where the claw machines are. It knows that there's not much to know.

But know this: They're all set to disappear, these five utilitarian icons that are the first and last rest stops you hit on I-90, that great ribbon of asphalt that connects Boston to Seattle, the Atlantic to the Pacific.

The state has made a mess of the bidding process to modernize the facilities, but when they finally get their act together, these familiar five will either be bulldozed or renovated beyond recognition.

Before that day comes, let's pay re-

REST STOPS, Page A10



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Tables and diners at the Framingham Service Plaza on the westbound side of the Massachusetts Turnpike.

President Trump threatened to halt a broad swath of US trade unless the Federal Reserve slashed interest rates. A2.

Two mud-caked survivors were rescued from min-

ing tunnels in Nepal, a week and a half after deadly flooding. **A3.**

Locations of the state's automated license plate reader cameras must be shared with the public along with information

about when State Police search the system's database, a judge ruled. **B1.**

More than 1,000 workers at Encore Boston Harbor went on strike, just before the Labor Day weekend began. **D1.**

Grays and rays

Saturday: Sun and clouds. High: 69-74. Low: 58-63.

Sunday: Sunny. High: 68-73. Low: 58-63. Comics and Weather, **D4-5.** Obituaries, **C9.**

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The Nation

OUT ON A LIMB

Sisters Julianne (left) and Madeline McIlwain played on a mature maple tree that had fallen onto the property belonging to their grandmother Sally McIlwain in Johnstown, Pa., Friday after an overnight storm.



JOHN RUCOSKY/THE TRIBUNE-DEMOCRAT VIA ASSOCIATED PRESS

Judge again blocks mail-in ballot limits

Says states would lose control of vote

By Zach Montague

NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — A federal judge in Boston ruled for the third time Friday that the Trump administration’s plans to restrict mail-in voting are likely unconstitutional and it should be prevented from implementing them before the midterm election.

Judge Indira Talwani had already temporarily blocked the US Postal Service from moving forward, in a ruling that was set to expire Sept. 10. The new order extends that block indefinitely.

She wrote that the Trump administration appeared to be denying that its effort at the Postal Service was “an election rule” to get around that the Constitution reserves the power to administer elections to the states and Congress.

“This denial rings hollow,” she wrote. “The final rule explicitly and exclusively regulates election mail.”

What the ruling did not do was move the issue much closer to a resolution, even with time rapidly running out for state election officials to start distributing mail-in ballots to voters.

The Trump administration had already appealed her temporary block to the Supreme Court, and the justices are like-

ly to have the final word on President Trump’s plans ahead of the election.

The ruling came just a day after Talwani held a two-hour hearing in Boston, with lawyers representing large coalitions of Democratic-led states and voting rights groups squared off with lawyers representing the Postal Service and a smaller group of Republican-led states that support the rule.

Talwani reviewed their concerns about the Postal Service rule, which would require states to report to the Postal Service which of their voters are qualified to use mail-in ballots, and to adopt a new ballot envelope designed to be scanned and linked to voters. The Postal Service could withhold mail delivery of ballots in states that don’t comply.

She said she believed the concerns among states and election officials that it was too late to adopt the changes without widespread mishaps and delays. The election is now only 60 days away.

Talwani wrote the rule appeared to force states to work against their own privacy laws and imposed requirements that appeared certain to result in some voters being disqualified.

“Having considered this series of hurdles for officials against the backdrop of an impending election, and mindful of the fact that any minor malfunction will result in the denial of mail ballots, the court



MATT RAMEY/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Wake County Board of Elections employees prepared absentee ballots to be mailed Thursday in Raleigh, N.C.

concludes that disenfranchisement for plaintiff organizations’ members, regardless of residence, is practically inevitable,” Talwani wrote.

In particular, Talwani questioned why the Postal Service was moving ahead with exceptional urgency to get the rule approved in time for the midterms while also insisting it was a relatively routine action that required only minor clerical changes. She also cast doubt on Trump’s claims that the rule was necessary for election security.

She wrote that proceeding so soon before the election “threatens disenfranchisement of millions of United States citizens who seek to vote by mail.”

“And, on the other side,” she wrote, she found that “the re-

cord includes no evidence relating to fraudulent mail voting to support the rushed implementation.”

Several officials from Democratic-led states welcomed the ruling.

“We are glad that this court has stopped the Postal Service from impacting who can receive a ballot in the 2026 election,” Jena Griswold, Colorado’s secretary of state, said in a statement. “The Postal Service must stick to its job of delivering the mail, rather than trying to decide who gets to vote.”

Still, Talwani wrote that she would not second guess or seek to prevent any of a number of Republican-led states that support the rule from meeting its requirements voluntarily.

She also said the decision

Friday addressed only the implementation of the rule for the current election cycle, and that courts could later sort out whether it was lawful in its entirety.

Like in her two previous rulings, she wrote that the rule appeared to exceed the Postal Service’s statutory authority by assigning broad authority to the service to regulate election mail, beyond what lawmakers intended.

She added that with each passing week, it had become increasingly unrealistic to expect states to be able to comply.

Jeff Jackson, the North Carolina attorney general, said in a statement that the administration’s request to the Supreme Court on Thursday came just as the state was scheduled to send out ballots to voters Friday.

“That would throw our election into chaos,” Jackson said. “The ballots are printed, the process is underway, and North Carolinians deserve a lawful and orderly election.”

The decision Friday technically appeared to render the Trump administration’s appeals of Talwani’s previous orders moot.

But at the hearing Thursday, Michael Velchik, a Justice Department attorney representing the Postal Service, indicated that if she took this step, the Trump administration would likely return to the Supreme Court to “start the process again.”

Trump threatens trade to force Fed rate cut

President wants world’s lowest interest rate

By Tony Romm and Colby Smith

NEW YORK TIMES

President Trump threatened Friday to halt a broad swath of US trade unless the Federal Reserve slashed interest rates, issuing a sweeping ultimatum that could prove costly to the economy if he were to carry it out.

The Fed is a politically independent institution, and it has long kept rates steady as it tries to tame years of persistent inflation. Trump’s demand risked undermining that work, while choking off commerce in ways that could harm American families and businesses.

The president delivered his threat on a day that began on a positive note for the White House. Hiring figures showed that employers added about 162,000 jobs in August, evincing a labor market that has weathered a range of shocks under Trump — from the global trade war he commenced last year to the war with Iran that has intensified recently.

On social media, Trump heralded that development before seizing on it to issue his demands. He called on the Fed to reduce borrowing costs to “the LOWEST RATE of any country in the World.”

The Fed has kept rates steady since December as it tries to discern whether recent economic turbulence represents a short-term problem or a longer-term driver of higher prices. In fact, policymakers have actually signaled that they are considering whether to

cut, Trump signaled that he could interrupt global trade.

“LOWER THE RATE OR I’LL STOP TRADING WITH COUNTRIES WITH WHICH WE HAVE A DEFICIT, which the U.S. Supreme Court, in its ridiculous and very costly Tariff decision, strongly acknowledged ‘the President’ has an absolute right to do,” Trump said.

The list of countries with which the United States has a trade deficit is lengthy, including its neighbors, Canada and Mexico, nations in the Europe-

Policymakers have actually signaled that they are considering whether to raise rates as soon as this month, after failing for more than five years to bring inflation down.

raise rates as soon as this month, after failing for more than five years to bring inflation down to the central bank’s 2 percent target.

But Trump insisted Friday that the US economy was “STRONG” and, as a result, could afford to lower borrowing costs. Such a move could actually worsen inflation. But absent a

an Union and others including China, according to federal data. That represents a substantial amount of the goods bought and imported by American families and businesses.

Globally, the US trade deficit in goods and services rose to its biggest gap in 16 months in July, data released this week showed. Some economists see

that activity as a sign of strength for the United States, one caused in part by surging domestic demand for the electronics that help to power artificial intelligence. But Trump disagrees and has sought to apply substantial tariffs globally in the hopes of driving down the imbalance.

“The Fed Board, with its great new leader, must get smart — BE PATRIOTS for a change,” the president said. “High interest rates put the U.S.A. at a very unfair disadvantage, and I won’t allow that to happen!”

Trump’s remarks were his latest attempt to pressure the Fed, even after securing the confirmation of his handpicked chair, Kevin Warsh. The president has made no secret about his views on monetary policy or the lengths he is willing to go to achieve them, even targeting — and trying to oust — Fed officials who do not share his stance.

The Fed’s decision on interest rates later this month hinges in part on inflation data coming out next Friday. Investors started to ratchet up bets about a possible increase after Warsh signaled in a speech last week that he was open to the idea. He

did not explicitly call for a rate increase.

Other top policymakers this week conveyed different degrees of urgency around the need to raise rates.

On Thursday, Christopher J. Waller, a governor, said that a “hot” report on inflation from the Bureau of Labor Statistics would compel him to support a rate increase. But if there was further evidence that inflation was not getting worse, he said he would be inclined to hold rates steady.

“What’s the cost of waiting one meeting? Hiking 25 basis points one meeting right now is not going to bring the CPI down to 2%,” Waller said, referring to the bureau’s consumer price index. “You want to take a chance to see if disinflation continues, but I’m not taking a big chance on it.”

Michael S. Barr, a Fed governor, said Tuesday that if inflation data showed continued signs of progress, then the Fed could afford to take more time to assess if rate increases are needed.

“However, if inflation appears not to be moderating sufficiently, then I think we should act decisively to raise rates,” Barr said.

DAILY BRIEFING

Armed man shot dead on bridge

NEW YORK — Police shot and killed a man early Friday after he climbed the cables of the Brooklyn Bridge and raised his arm and extended a knife toward officers, officials said.

The fatal shooting happened just days after police shot and killed a woman in Times Square who had attacked two people with knives, killing one. According to the state attorney general’s office, this week’s deaths were the eighth and ninth fatal police shootings in 2026.

On Friday, officers responded to a 911 call made at 3:28 a.m. that reported a man walking on the beams of the Brooklyn Bridge. The police officers climbed onto the bridge, using harnesses to clip onto the cables for safety, said Gerard Dowling, the commanding officer of the Police Department’s emergency services unit.

According to Dowling, the man told the police officers that he had a bomb and wanted to die. After a standoff lasting about an hour, the man began quickly descending a bridge cable toward the officers, who were clipped on the same cable below him. The officers began moving backward but were not able to move as quickly.

The man was within 3 feet of the closest officer when he raised his arm and extended a knife, Dowling said.

NEW YORK TIMES

Sinema can be sued, judge says

PHOENIX — Former Senator Kyrsten Sinema can be sued under North Carolina’s home-wrecker law over her relationship with a member of her security detail, a judge ruled Friday.

Sinema has acknowledged having a romantic relationship with Matthew Ammel but argued that she can’t be sued in North Carolina because she has no connection to the state.

US District Judge David A. Bragdon rejected that argument, saying nine text messages she sent Ammel while he was in the state give North Carolina jurisdiction over her. He found it implausible that she was unaware of Ammel’s whereabouts when she texted him.

Sinema’s lawyer, Steven Epstein, did not immediately respond to an email seeking comment.

The lawsuit, filed by Ammel’s ex-wife, seeks financial damages from Sinema, who represented Arizona in the House and later the Senate for one term that ended early last year. North Carolina is one of a handful of states that allow jilted spouses to sue for “alienation of affection” to seek compensation from a third party responsible for the breakup of their marriage.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Tesla Cybercab being investigated

Federal regulators have opened an investigation into whether Tesla’s new Cybercab model is compliant with safety regulations, a potentially big obstacle to the company’s plans to offer paid rides in the driverless vehicles.

The investigation by the National Highway Traffic Safety Administration began Thursday, according to a document posted on the agency’s website, the same day that Tesla displayed dozens of Cybercabs in Austin, Texas, near the factory where they are produced.

Tesla has indicated that it plans to offer paid rides in the Cybercabs, which do not have steering wheels, brake pedals or side and rearview mirrors. The company has also invited inquiries from people interested in buying fleets of Cybercabs.

The Cybercab is central to plans by Elon Musk, Tesla’s CEO, to revolutionize transportation and dominate the growing market for vehicles capable of acting as robot chauffeurs.

NEW YORK TIMES

The World

Ukraine’s security service struck

Russia attacks headquarters ahead of US talks

By Samya Kullab
ASSOCIATED PRESS

KYIV — A Russian drone struck the headquarters of Ukraine’s security service in central Kyiv, President Volodymyr Zelensky said Friday, ahead of diplomatic talks with US officials on ending the war.

The air war between Russia and Ukraine has intensified as the conflict stretches toward five years since Moscow’s invasion of its neighbor. Russia recently has been using fast-flying, jet-powered drones, and the recurring wail of air-raid sirens has become part of daily life in Kyiv.

Ukraine’s security service headquarters, near the historic St. Sophia Cathedral and international hotels, is among the agencies carrying out deep strike operations inside Russian territory. Twelve people were wounded in Friday’s attack, local authorities said.

“The drone was deliberately targeted at the head of the SBU’s office in that building,” Zelensky said Friday.

Zelensky wrote on Telegram that acting security chief Oleksandr Poklad had briefed him on a response, including possible targets.

Ukrainian Foreign Minister Andrii Sybiha called Friday’s drone strike a “major escalation” that came as potential peace talks were building momentum.

“Moscow launched this strike during a renewed push for peace — laying bare its true rejection of diplomacy,” he said in a post on X.

President Trump confirmed Friday that envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner will travel to Moscow and then Kyiv over the weekend and into early next week. The United States has not provided more specific timing for the stops.

“They are bringing with them a proposal to end the war,” Trump said.

This would be their first visit to Kyiv. US efforts to negotiate a settlement have yet to produce a path to peace.

Zelensky said Friday that he was expecting Witkoff and Kushner to visit Kyiv on Sunday, after visiting Moscow. He said in a Telegram post that Ukraine will refrain from airstrikes during the negotiations and called on Russia to reciprocate to allow

the talks to proceed safely.

“As with previous diplomatic visits by the American side, we will ensure the normal functioning of Russian airspace so that the negotiators can arrive safely. We are concerned about their safety, not about Russia,” Zelensky said.

Speaking with journalists Friday, presidential spokesperson Dmitry Peskov refused to confirm reports that Kushner and Witkoff would visit Moscow, saying only that the media would be informed if such a meeting took place.

Kushner and Witkoff last visited Moscow in January, where they met with Russian President Vladimir Putin. After that meeting, Russian presidential aide Yuri Ushakov described talks as constructive but said that “reaching a long-term settlement can’t be expected without solving the territorial issue.”

Further talks have lost momentum, with the White House’s attention focused on its conflict with Iran.

The latest diplomatic developments coincided with a “massive” overnight Russian attack on the Odesa region that killed one person and injured at least five others, including a child, regional

head Oleh Kiper said in a post on Telegram. The attacks damaged multiple residential buildings, including two multistory blocks.

Overnight strikes elsewhere in Ukraine killed two police officers in Dnipro, officials said, while a drone attack in Kyiv wounded three people after hitting a residential building.

Russian forces have relentlessly struck civilian areas. Previously, these attacks occurred mostly at night, but now they are happening during the day as well. The front line in eastern and southern Ukraine remains largely deadlocked.

In Russia, a large-scale Ukrainian drone strike hit the Black Sea resort city of Sochi and the nearby district of Sirius, regional officials said Friday. They said the attack sparked a blaze at an oil depot but gave no further details. Russian media outlets reported two depots were hit, with one fire in Sochi and another in Sirius.

Ukraine has repeatedly targeted oil facilities that form the backbone of Russia’s economy, one of the world’s largest energy producers. Growing economic pressure and public frustration have mounted in Russia after months of escalating Ukrainian strikes on refineries and e-com-



FRANCISCO SECO/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Firefighters worked to extinguish a fire at a partially destroyed warehouse in Brovary on the outskirts of Kyiv after another day of Russian air assaults Friday.

merce hubs that have caused nationwide disruptions.

The barrages prompted Putin last month to decree that the state can temporarily seize control of critical infrastructure facilities if private owners fail to protect them from Ukrainian drone attacks or don’t rebuild them after strikes. Analysts said the move was aimed at forcing companies to pay for their own security and bring damaged assets back into service, despite the cost.

Finnish authorities said they were investigating how a Russian-made drone ended up on a rocky shoreline in the Pellinge archipelago east of Helsinki.

Finland’s Border Guard said what appears to be a Geoscan 701 drone, manufactured by a Russian company, was found on the shore. “The device model in question is used by both state and civilian operators, and it is not possible at this stage to determine its intended use or identify the country or entity operating it,” the Border Guard said in a statement.

Geoscan describes itself as one of Russia’s leading drone manufacturers, and says the 701 model is designed for large-scale aerial surveying.

DAILY BRIEFING

At least 21 dead in Sudan clashes

CAIRO — Clashes in southern Sudan have killed at least 21 people, including children, a doctors’ group said Friday.

Sudan Doctors Network, which tracks violence throughout the war in Sudan, said that the rebel group Sudan People’s Liberation Movement-North, or SPLM-N, launched an attack on Thursday in the areas of Debi and Luweri in the town of Kauda in South Kordofan.

Rebel leader Abdel Aziz al-Hilu has aligned his fighters with the Sudanese paramilitary Rapid Support Forces, which has been battling the Sudanese military since 2023. The war

killed 59,000 people, displaced some 13 million, and pushed parts of the country into famine. Al-Hilu’s group has been active in South Kordofan and joined a local government set up by the RSF. The group is a breakaway faction of the SPLM, the ruling party of neighboring South Sudan.

Thursday’s attack was part of clashes that erupted between SPLM-N and the Otoro tribe, a minority group in the Nuba Mountains of South Kordofan.

The fighting came despite a cease-fire initiative backed by the RSF last month.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Influencer indicted on sex charges

BUCHAREST, Romania — Romanian prosecutors on Friday indicted social media influencer Andrew Tate on charges of trafficking minors, sex with a minor, and money laundering.

Tate, 39, and his brother Tristan Tate, 38, were first arrested in Romania’s capital, Bucharest, in late 2022. Tristan is indicted with complicity in the case, according to DIICOT, Romania’s anti-organized crime agency.

The agency said on Friday that the Tate brothers coerced a victim by pretending to be in a loving relationship and then forcing her to produce pornographic material for an online webcam business.

A lawyer for the Tate brothers in Romania did not respond to a request for comment.

The new indictment stems from an investigation that led to the brothers’ arrest in 2022 and their being formally indicted in 2023. A court returned that case to DIICOT in 2024 because of multiple legal and procedural irregularities. The case wasn’t closed, and there was also a separate legal case against the brothers in Romania in 2024.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

United Arab Emirates pardons poet

BEIRUT — The United Arab Emirates said Friday that it had pardoned an Egyptian poet and dissident, days after he was sentenced to 10 years in prison, a case that drew scrutiny from human rights experts over the Persian Gulf state’s efforts to punish critics beyond its borders.

The dissident, Abdulrahman al-Qaradawi, was pardoned by the Emirati president, Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan, according to state media. Authorities did not immediately specify when al-Qaradawi, who had been held for months without trial, would be released.

The Emirati government previously told The New York Times that al-Qaradawi was being investigated on charges of “engaging in activities that aim to undermine public security” and that his detention complied with legal and human rights standards.

He was convicted on Aug. 27 on those charges and fined \$54,000, state media said.

The unusual case had attracted international attention.

NEW YORK TIMES

37 reported dead in attempted oil theft

ABUJA, Nigeria — An attempt to steal oil from a loading vessel in Nigeria’s oil-producing Rivers state left at least 37 people dead, most of them from inhaling toxic fumes, an advocacy group said Friday.

The Youths and Environmental Advocacy Center said the victims were simultaneously siphoning crude products into their boats from an “illegal tapping point” on Thursday. It caused them to inhale toxic fumes at high pressure, it said. Many are still missing.

The Nigerian police confirmed the incident on Friday but gave no death toll and said an investigation was underway.

“The victims were allegedly attempting to steal crude oil,” Blessing Agabe, Rivers State police spokesperson, said.

Oil theft is common in the Niger Delta region of Nigeria.

ASSOCIATED PRESS



NEPAL ARMY VIA ASSOCIATED PRESS

Soldiers rescued a worker Friday during an operation at the Trishuli 3A hydropower project in Nepal’s Rasuwa district.

2 pulled alive from sludge-filled tunnels

Nepal workers trapped 9 days after flooding

By Mujib Mashal, Anupreeta Das, Laura Chung, and Thomas Fuller
NEW YORK TIMES

RASUWA, Nepal — The rescuers heard voices. They crawled through a sludge-filled tunnel deep underground where employees of a hydroelectric plant in Nepal had been trapped for nine days.

“We are coming!” Lieutenant Colonel Ganga Baral, one of the leaders of the operation, said he had called out. “Don’t worry, the Nepali army is coming.”

Friday morning, two mud-caked survivors were rescued from the tunnels and hoisted into the open air, an extraordinary moment captured on video and in photos by the army.

The improbable rescue provided a measure of hope a week and a half after a glacial collapse unleashed a tsunami of mud and boulders that killed more than 1,300 people in Nepal and Tibet and left thousands of others missing.

The men were rescued from a hydroelectric center buried so deeply in the detritus of the flood that engineers had to use satellite images to pinpoint its location amid the disfigured landscape.

Hirashova Maharjan, the wife of Kabir Maharjan, one of the workers rescued, described her husband as deeply disori-

ented after being airlifted to Kathmandu, the capital, for medical treatment.

“He didn’t even recognize me,” she said from the army hospital in Kathmandu. But his condition has since improved, she said.

“He is stable now,” she said. “We’re so happy. We are crying with happiness. Thank you to the army and to the government.”

The raging floodwaters that erupted on Aug. 26 washed away roads, bridges, and, in some cases, entire villages.

The two men were rescued from a tunnel in the Upper Trishuli 3A hydropower project. The body of a third man, a me-

page. He said he thought three or four people were still alive in the area where he had been found.

“I used to work in the control room as an operator,” he says in the video. “Usually there would be four or five people there, but at the time, there were 40 or 45.”

He added: “I tried to get everyone out and tried to warn everyone. But then I ran out of time.”

Sah, who was a mechanical foreman at the hydroelectric plant, said he had recited prayers “over and over again” during his time trapped underground in darkness. “How many days has it been?” he

op a plan to rescue the workers.

Nepal has a large hydroelectric industry that harnesses the fast-flowing waters in the Himalayas. Many of the projects have tunnel systems deep in the earth along the Bhotekoshi and Trishuli rivers, which bore the brunt of the flooding.

Dix said he had focused on the Trishuli 3A hydropower project, relying on engineering drawings of the structures underground, satellite imagery and old charts to try and identify any potential “Goldilocks zones” — a term he used to describe a small subterranean area “where a human being could have survived.”

Most of the rescue efforts have been focused in the project’s cable tunnel, which runs from the underground powerhouse to the transmission grid.

The operation has been slow and difficult work, Dix said. Rescuers have had to dig through mud and use explosives to blast through rocks “the size of cars.” Once inside the tunnel, they were faced with water that had to be drained, he added.

Workers had to dig a huge drainage canal back to the river.

“We were worried that the tunnel was full of water, and it would drown us, or maybe drown people who were ahead of us in the tunnel,” Dix said.

Rescuers were then able to create a small gap along the top of the cable tunnel through which they could crawl, calling to any survivors. That was the area where rescuers found Maharjan and Sah.

‘I used to work in the control room as an operator. . . . How many days has it been?’

SANJAY SAH, *one of the rescued hydroelectric center workers*

chanical engineer, was also recovered Friday, according to Dirghayu Kumar Shrestha, the head of the Nepal Electricity Authority.

More than 40 other workers were thought to be inside the tunnel, according to Sanjay Sah, one of the rescued men. It was not clear how many were still alive.

Sah was able to answer questions through an oxygen mask. He spoke from a stretcher in a video that was posted to a government ministry’s Facebook

asked.

The rescue efforts have been grueling. Images posted by the Nepali army showed rescuers slithering through sludge deep in the tunnels with hard hats and flashlights. Other rescuers paddled through tunnels in inflatable dinghies, the kind used in white-water rafting.

Arnold Dix, an Australian geologist and engineer who is assisting Nepalese authorities in the rescue operations, said it had taken a day or two to locate the power stations and to devel-

OpenAI faces 30 new lawsuits over Canada shooting

Survivors claim attack could have been prevented

By Michael Levenson
NEW YORK TIMES

Survivors of a mass shooting in British Columbia filed 30 new lawsuits against OpenAI this week, contending that the company should have notified the police when it shut down the shooter’s disturbing ChatGPT account eight months before the attack.

The lawsuits significantly expand a legal fight against OpenAI and its chief executive, Sam Altman, that began in April when victims’ families filed seven lawsuits claiming the company could have prevented the shooting at Tumbler Ridge Secondary School on Feb. 10.

That day, Jesse Van Rootselaar, 18, took two guns from her home in Tumbler Ridge, a remote town roughly 415 miles northeast of Vancouver, and killed her mother and 11-year-old brother, authorities said. She then went to the school and killed five students and an educational assistant and shot two other students.

Van Rootselaar died in the school of a self-inflicted gunshot wound, authorities said.

OpenAI has acknowledged that in June 2025, eight months before the attack, it shut down Van Rootselaar’s ChatGPT account after an automated system detected “a violation of our usage policy.” But company officials did not contact the authorities.

“Based on what we could see at that time the account was banned in June 2025, we did not identify credible and imminent planning that met our threshold to refer the matter to law enforcement,” OpenAI’s vice president of global policy, Ann M. O’Leary, wrote in a letter to Canada’s artificial intelligence minister in February.

The lawsuits, citing a report in The Wall Street Journal, contend some OpenAI employees were urging the company to contact the Royal Canadian Mounted Police. But the lawsuits say OpenAI’s leaders overruled members of the company’s internal safety team.

“Sam Altman and his leadership team knew what silence meant for the citizens of Tumbler Ridge, but they were more concerned about what disclosure meant for themselves,” one of the lawsuits states. “Warning the RCMP would set a precedent the company deemed unacceptable, as OpenAI would be compelled to notify authorities every time its safety team identified a user planning real-world violence.”

It is not clear what content on Van Rootselaar’s ChatGPT account prompted OpenAI to remove it. But The New York Times reported in February that she had posted on other platforms about her mental health problems, drug use, and fascination with weapons and extreme violence.

In April, Altman wrote an open letter apologizing to the community of Tumbler Ridge.

“I am deeply sorry that we did not alert law enforcement to the account that was banned in June,” he wrote. “While I know words can never be enough, I believe an apology is necessary to recognize the harm and irreversible loss your community has suffered.”

The new lawsuits were brought by educators, a principal, and students at Tumbler Ridge Secondary School, including siblings who were separated during the attack, and a teacher and her nephew who shared the same classroom that day. One of the plaintiffs, who was 13 at the time of the shooting, played dead as his classmates were killed in the library.

British Columbia’s premier, David Eby, said the suits were filed after OpenAI walked away from a mediation process.

“It underlines why these companies cannot be trusted,” Eby said Tuesday, according to CityNews Vancouver. “They can’t be trusted to regulate themselves; they can’t be trusted in what they say.”

In response to a request for comment, OpenAI pointed to a post on the social platform X by its chief strategy officer, Jason Kwon. Kwon wrote that the company has been “approaching this litigation with respect for both the legal process and the families and victims of this tragedy, and we’ll continue to engage in good faith with that process.”

Kwon added that OpenAI’s intelligence and investigation team and its legal department “work hard to define standards and processes for when to report cases to law enforcement and to apply those standards to really difficult and complex situations.”

Deidre Rushlow, who taught at Tumbler Ridge Secondary School, is one of the plaintiffs in the 30 lawsuits stemming from the shooting, which were filed in US District Court in San Francisco, where OpenAI is based.

“What is done cannot be undone,” she said in a statement released by her law firm, Edelson PC. “We will not forgive, we will not forget, and we certainly will not rest until every last individual at OpenAI who was complicit in the Tumbler Ridge shooting has been brought to justice.”



HUMANE WORLD FOR ANIMALS VIA ASSOCIATED PRESS

CHIMP IN THE MIDDLE — In a photo released by Humane World for Animals, a chimpanzee formerly used in research received a health check at a retirement sanctuary for chimpanzees in Bapakwali, Liberia.

5 EU nations to send migrants to ‘hubs’

Leaders agree to use facilities in third countries

By Claudia Ciobanu and Renata Brito
ASSOCIATED PRESS

Denmark and four other European Union countries agreed Friday on a model for “return hubs” in non-EU nations and hope to begin sending migrants to the facilities as early as 2027, an official said Friday.

The announcement, made after a one-day meeting in Copenhagen, is the latest development in an effort by EU states to send people whose asylum requests have been rejected to third countries outside the bloc.

“We are moving forward toward what is actually a fundamental transformation of the common European migration and asylum system,” said Morten Bødskov, Denmark’s minister of immigration and integration.

He briefed reporters alongside counterparts from Germany, the Netherlands, Austria, and Greece. The five countries have been negotiating with governments mainly in Africa over potential sites, pioneering the initiative for the whole of the EU.

Human rights groups have criticized plans to deport migrants to centers or prisons in third countries, arguing that European nations cannot guarantee their rights will be respected

there.

Bødskov rejected the idea that “return hubs” were a euphemism for detention and deportation centers and said the International Organization for Migration and the UN Refugee Agency would monitor the centers.

“We are not talking about camps, we are talking about opportunities, for a new chance for irregular migrants who cannot return to their own country today and who have no legal grounds to be in our countries,” Bødskov said.

‘States need to commit to the guardrails necessary to prevent setting up human rights black holes.’

MICHAEL O’FLAHERTY, *Council of Europe Commissioner for Human Rights*

The UNHCR told the Associated Press that it “has not been approached with details of such a proposal,” and therefore “cannot comment on the specific arrangements being discussed or on what any potential role for UNHCR might entail.”

IOM told AP that no decision had been made on IOM’s potential role in “return hubs.” “Discussions remain exploratory,” and IOM had provided only “technical advice to some EU Member States on safeguards and operational considerations.”

“We have consistently underscored that any such initiative

must comply with EU regulatory and legal frameworks, protect migrants’ rights, respect partner countries’ interests, and ensure individuals’ access to meaningful, sustainable solutions,” an IOM spokesperson said in an emailed statement.

Although the ministers did not specify which third countries were being considered, Bødskov said they expect to reach their first deal by early 2027.

He acknowledged that the concept of “return hubs” was mocked only a few years ago and

with European countries and others to potentially host asylum seekers who are not allowed to live elsewhere.

Speaking to Royal FM Kigali, Rwandan government spokesperson Yolande Makolo cited an emergency transit mechanism established in Gashora in 2018 for people evacuated from Libya, who could stay there until they were resettled in third countries.

Makolo said one of the ideas discussed was to offer a “safe place” where people who have nowhere else to go could get medical care, training, and rest while their asylum applications were processed, until they could go back home if safe or get resettled to yet another country.

It remained unclear what countries in negotiations with EU nations would gain in return for taking Europe’s rejected migrants.

Migrant rights groups have criticized European efforts to set up migrant centers abroad where it may be difficult to monitor and enforce human rights.

In an emailed statement, Council of Europe Commissioner for Human Rights Michael O’Flaherty said “vague assurances of compliance with human rights law are not enough.”

“States need to commit to the guardrails necessary to prevent setting up human rights black holes,” he said.

The European ministers in Copenhagen emphasized the new hubs would abide by European and international law.

Israel frees 4 Lebanon prisoners in deal tied to civil war’s missing Jews

By Fadi Tawil and Abby Sewell
ASSOCIATED PRESS

HAROUF, Lebanon — Four prisoners from Lebanon held in Israel were released and handed over to Lebanese authorities via the International Committee of the Red Cross on Friday as part of a deal between the two countries. In return, Lebanon agreed to search for the bodies of Jewish Lebanese citizens who went missing during the country’s civil

war decades ago.

Dozens of Lebanese prisoners are believed to be held in Israeli detention centers, including civilians as well as Hezbollah militants captured during fighting in southern Lebanon. A total of five detainees were released under the deal, all civilians.

The first Lebanese prisoner, identified as Malek Ghazi, was released to the International Committee of the Red Cross, or ICRC, and then to the Lebanese army on Thursday.

Those released Friday included two Lebanese citizens and two Syrians who had been captured in Lebanon, according to two Lebanese officials who spoke on condition of anonymity because they were not authorized to comment publicly. Hundreds of thousands of Syrian refugees and workers live in Lebanon. It was not clear if the released detainees would be sent back to Syria.

Associated Press journalists waiting at a checkpoint south of the city of Tyre in southern Lebanon saw a convoy of ICRC vehicles heading toward the Naqoura border crossing Friday morning and later return. The convoy then entered a Lebanese army barracks in Tyre.

Mahmoud Ayash, the brother of prisoner Hussein Ayash from the village of Harouf, who was waiting there, said his brother had been detained for about



MOHAMMED ZAATARI/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Hussein Ayash, released from an Israeli prison, hugged his mother Friday at their home.

three months and had called from the border crossing in Naqoura to say that he had been released and was with the ICRC.

“I hope all our prisoners in Israeli prisons will be released and for all Lebanese citizens to be liberated,” he said.

Ahmed Atwe, also waiting at the checkpoint, said his relative, Mohammed Juheir, was a fisherman from the border town of Naqoura who was captured at

sea by Israeli forces a year ago, when a cease-fire agreement was in place.

Hours later, Hussein Ayash entered his hometown, standing up to flash a V for victory sign through the roof of a convertible car. He appeared tired but not in ill health as he hugged and kissed relatives while villagers threw rose petals on his head.

Regaining his freedom and returning home “feels like the

day you are born anew,” he said.

Ayash said of his time in Israeli prison, “There was no torture, in the literal sense of the word. But it was not a comfortable experience at all. May God spare anyone from ever having to go through it.” He declined to give further details.

The ICRC said in a statement that the remaining prisoners had been transferred to it on Friday. The organization called for

its teams to be granted access to the remaining prisoners, noting that it has not had access to detainees held in Israel since October 2023.

“Many families in Lebanon are still waiting for answers about the fate of loved ones who may be detained, deceased or otherwise unaccounted for,” it said.

Among the missing are two men taken by Israeli troops from the village of Halta Thursday — the same day Ghazi was released.

Issa Abdel-Al, a local official in the village, said Israeli forces raided the area early Thursday, interrogated residents, and seized a member of the municipal council and two other local men, farmers who kept livestock and bees. He said the three were civilians and that Hezbollah has no presence in the village. Halta has a mostly Sunni population, while Hezbollah has its support base in Shiite communities.

The Israeli military said the soldiers “apprehended three military operatives of the Lebanese Resistance Brigades organization, which operates on behalf of Hezbollah.”

The municipal council member was released Thursday night, but the other two remain missing, Abdel-Al said, as do four other residents of Halta taken in previous Israeli raids, including one in which a 15-year-old boy was killed.

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THE CLANCY CASE

Mistrial but no end in Clancy case

► **VERDICT**
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instructions on reasonable doubt. For four straight days the focus of the trial often rested as much on the motives of that one juror as it did on Clancy's culpability.

Sullivan set a Sept. 29 hearing to set a new trial date at the request of Clancy's attorney Kevin Reddington, who said he wanted an immediate retrial.

It was also an inconclusive end to a case that has captured international attention, drawn hordes of pink-clad Clancy supporters to Plymouth Superior court, and cast a spotlight on the treatment and diagnosis of women struggling with postpartum mental health issues.

Now it's up to Plymouth District Attorney Timothy Cruz whether to retry Clancy, 36, on three counts of first-degree murder, or pursue lesser charges, which would allow her to waive her right to another jury trial and let a judge decide the case.

Clancy, meanwhile, will remain at Tewksbury Hospital, where she has been held without bail for more than three years.

Clancy admitted to strangling her children — 5-year-old Cora, 3-year-old Dawson, and 8-month-old Callan — with exercise bands in the basement of their Duxbury home on Jan. 24, 2023, after sending her then-husband, Patrick, out to pick up medication and takeout for dinner.

But she pleaded not guilty to three counts of first-degree murder, asserting she should not be held criminally responsible because she was suffering from postpartum psychosis at the time and couldn't resist a man's voice in her head telling her to kill the children and herself. Afterward, she slashed her neck and wrists and jumped out a second-story window, leaving her paralyzed from the waist down. She appeared in court each day in a wheelchair.

Outside the courthouse Friday after the mistrial, Reddington said the jury worked incredibly hard, appeared to be 11-1 in favor of acquitting Clancy, and failed to deliver a verdict because it was "robbed by one man, for whatever his agenda was."

He cited a note sent to the judge by the jury foreperson Thursday, indicating that a lone juror had expressed doubt about the evidence, yet refused to follow the law regarding reason-

able doubt. Reddington described the legal saga as a "very sad case," adding that "Cruz knows that he was crushed. He doesn't have a case."

The trial showed "clearly and unequivocally, the woeful deficiency" in the care offered to mothers struggling with postpartum issues, Reddington said.

Asked if he would do anything different at a retrial, Reddington said, "Why would I? I won the case."

Speaking to reporters outside the courthouse Friday, Cruz said he has yet to make a decision about a retrial, but sought to keep the focus on "three children who died a violent, horrific death" at the hands of their mother.

Cruz said the case "is not about a health care system, or about how women are treated in it," but rather it's "about Lindsay Clancy, and what she did on January 24, 2023, and the cruel and calculated killing of three innocents."

As Cruz spoke, Clancy supporters behind him shook their heads, heckled, and made thumbs-down motions.

An attorney for Clancy's former husband, Patrick, released a statement Friday saying, "Patrick Clancy is grateful to the court and to the jurors for their hard work, their commitment, and their perseverance. The loss of Patrick's children is something from which he will never recover and from which there will never be closure. The prospect of reliving this tragedy through another trial is extraordinarily painful — for Patrick, for his family, and for all us."

Relatives of Clancy testified she was a devoted and loving mother who began struggling with anxiety, depression, and insomnia four months after the birth of her third child in May 2022.

She desperately sought help from doctors and nurse practitioners who prescribed more than a dozen medications; she was convinced the medications made her worse, according to evidence presented at trial.

Clancy complained to medical providers about intrusive thoughts and suicidal ideation, made two trips to emergency rooms, called suicide hot lines twice, and, weeks before the slaying had voluntarily checked herself into McLean Hospital for five days.

Reddington urged jurors to



State Troopers escorted Plymouth County District Attorney Tim Cruz away from the courthouse after the mistrial was declared. Below, Lindsay Clancy watched the jury. Defense attorney Kevin Reddington reacted to the judge's decision to declare a mistrial.



TOP: JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF; BELOW: PHOTOS BY GREG DERR/THE PATRIOT LEDGER/POOL

find her not guilty based on a lack of criminal responsibility, arguing her descent into mental illness was caused by "the damn medicine and the lousy medical care she got."

But prosecutors contended Clancy had control of her actions when she killed her children, planned the slayings in advance, and carried them out with extreme atrocity or cruelty.

Assistant District Attorney Jennifer Sprague said Clancy was depressed and unhappy with her life, and chose to kill herself and her children because "it was what she had to do to end her misery."

She argued Clancy premeditated the slayings, citing evidence that she Googled how long it would take for her husband to make the trip to a nearby pharmacy and a restaurant in Plymouth, then killed her chil-

dren during the half-hour he was gone.

During the trial, jurors were exposed to horrific evidence and contradictory opinions by mental health experts over whether Clancy was psychotic and unaware of what she was doing or depressed but still responsible.

During the trial, Patrick Clancy testified Lindsay was a devoted mother who did everything for their children.

He told jurors she got worse through December 2022, despite prescribed medications, as she talked about suicide and confided to him and her mother she was having "intrusive thoughts" about harming the children or of something bad happening to them.

He said he did not think the children were in danger because she said she found the thoughts disturbing and assured him she

did not have a plan to hurt them.

On the day Clancy killed her children, she "seemed happy" and "was having one of her best days," Patrick Clancy told jurors.

He testified that after Lindsay sent him to pick up the medication and takeout for dinner, he tried to call her from a nearby CVS to ask whether a generic version of their daughter's medication was acceptable, but she didn't pick up. She called back and it seemed as if she'd been "in the middle of something," and he guessed she was giving the children a bath, he said.

When he returned home, he found her lying in the backyard after a failed suicide attempt, then discovered the children in the basement.

Jurors heard a chilling 911 recording of Patrick Clancy's anguished call when he found his

children. Initially, he was unable to speak about the horrific scene as he howled uncontrollably. Then, he screamed, "She killed the kids!"

Patrick Clancy testified Lindsay called him from the hospital about a week after the killings and told him she killed the children because a man's voice in her head told her if she didn't "do it now, she would lose her chance."

Dr. Phillip Resnick, a forensic psychiatrist with expertise in postpartum disorders, evaluated Clancy for the defense four months after the slayings and testified he believed she was psychotic on the day she killed her children.

Resnick labeled Clancy's condition "postpartum psychosis," and said Clancy was not only hearing a "command hallucination," but felt what's known as a "delusion of influence" and couldn't control her actions.

"It was almost like she was a puppet and someone else was pulling the strings," he told jurors.

But several mental health experts called by the prosecution testified it was highly unusual for Clancy to claim she heard the male voice, or command hallucination, only once, while killing her children. She never reported hearing voices before or afterward.

"To put it mildly, that would be a very, very unusual pattern or manifestation of how this kind of thing comes about," Kirk Heilbrun, a forensic psychologist who evaluated Clancy for the prosecution, testified.

Clancy's mother, Paula Musgrove, testified about going to stay with her daughter when she was struggling.

In an early morning text from Oct. 20, 2022, that Musgrove read to jurors, Clancy begged her mother to drive up from Connecticut and stay with her.

"I'm really sick. Something is wrong," Clancy wrote. "I started taking the medicine my doctor prescribed for anxiety and I think it's made things worse. It's just really scary and I don't want to be alone."

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Legal experts unsurprised by decision not to intervene

► **ANALYSIS**
Continued from Page A1

ror and Sullivan himself of acting improperly. He filed an emergency petition to a single justice of the state's highest court, who elected not to intervene, and then sat with his client in court as Sullivan ended the trial without a verdict.

Legal observers said the result was not surprising in light of the jurors' repeated insistence they could not reach a unanimous verdict. The courts, including the Supreme Judicial Court, which rejected Reddington's emergency petition, do not like to insert themselves into active jury deliberations, said Chris Dearborn, a Suffolk University Law School professor.

"This whole process is really delicate when you're trying to ascertain whether a juror needs to be removed or is being fair or not, because the inquiry is not supposed to encroach on their deliberative process," Dearborn said.

That was the uphill battled Reddington always faced: arguing to disqualify the juror based on what happened during deliberations.

It's a fight Clancy will keep pursuing as she tries to avert a second trial.

Reddington said Sullivan's decision to declare a mistrial may have violated Clancy's right to a fair trial under the Fifth Amendment because the judge short-circuited a chance at acquittal by not digging further into the juror's position. And that could form the basis of an argument to block a second trial on



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Starfish and flowers adorn the plaque marking the vault for the cremated remains of Lindsay Clancy's children.

double jeopardy grounds, as she would face similar charges the jury was willing to acquit her on.

David Nathanson, a Boston attorney who specializes in appellate cases, said Sullivan could have questioned the juror to learn more.

"Why not do a little more work and try to find out?" Nathanson asked.

Clancy's defense lawyers laid out their case during an emergency hearing before a single justice of the Supreme Judicial Court.

Reddington and an associate alleged one juror refused to follow the judge's instructions. Notes from the jury foreperson, they said, indicated the holdout juror acknowledged harboring some doubt about Clancy's criminal responsibility. But that juror essentially ignored the judge's instructions on the standard of reasonable doubt required in

criminal cases, Reddington said the note alleged.

That left an 11-1 split among jurors in a complex case that asked them to weigh whether Clancy was guilty for the deaths of her three children — Cora, 5, Dawson, 3, and Callan, 8 months — or that she lacked criminal responsibility because she was in the throes of postpartum psychosis. The burden was on the prosecution to show she was not and so should be held criminally liable.

In a hearing Friday afternoon, Reddington and his associate Dana Goldblatt, argued before Supreme Judicial Court Associate Justice Dalila Argaez Wendlandt that Sullivan had erred by not removing the juror after receiving the jury's notes.

But to make that case, Dearborn said, the defense would have had to show there were personal factors, outside the de-

liberations, that rendered the juror unfit to serve.

There are precedents for removing jurors, but typically there must be damaging information that is unrelated to potential disagreements about the facts or how to apply the law.

In a 2008 murder trial, for example, the prosecution wanted a juror removed, asked the state's high court to intervene, and it worked.

In that case, Commonwealth v. Carnes, the jury was at a similar impasse: 11-to-1. Then prosecutors discovered that one juror had made material misrepresentations on her juror questionnaire. The trial judge initially declined to investigate the allegation. So the prosecution filed an emergency petition with the Supreme Judicial Court, which then said the trial judge had broad discretion to investigate the allegation. The trial judge then questioned the juror and removed her.

That is the kind of outcome Clancy's lawyers sought. But the facts were different, in a way that made them less likely to succeed. The Carnes juror had provided false information under oath. The controversy over the Clancy juror was directly related to deliberations about the case.

Assistant District Attorney Jennifer Sprague argued the foreperson's note gave no indication of any biased juror: Only that one disagreed on the definition of reasonable doubt.

Clancy's lawyers may have had an additional motivation for trying to avoid a mistrial Friday,

attorney Marsha Kazarosian said. Reddington may have wanted to determine whether the jurors could reach a unanimous verdict on some of the charges Clancy faced even if they could not agree on all of them.

Clancy's jury had the option to convict her on charges of first-degree murder, second-degree murder, and manslaughter in the deaths of each child. If the jury acquitted her of any of those offenses, prosecutors could not retry her on those counts. But those verdicts could only be rendered in open court and would not be possible after a mistrial is declared, said Kazarosian, a past president of the Massachusetts Bar Association.

After the first trial of Karen Read in 2024, some of Read's jurors said they had voted to acquit her on two charges in the death of her boyfriend, Boston police officer John O'Keefe.

But since those revelations only emerged after the trial was over and not in open court, prosecutors were still allowed to try Read again on each charge, the Supreme Judicial Court ruled. Read was retried and acquitted.

On Friday, Plymouth District Attorney Timothy J. Cruz said he would not immediately announce a decision about whether his office would bring Clancy to trial again.

Michael A. Bergeron, a criminal defense attorney in Marshfield, said Cruz has a reputation for pursuing prosecutions even when psychiatric experts consulted by his office have ques-

tioned whether defendants were criminally responsible for their actions.

He cited a 2017 case in which he represented a man with paranoid schizophrenia who was accused of gun offenses. A prosecution expert determined the man was not criminally responsible, but Cruz's office took the case to trial anyway, Bergeron said.

The man waived a jury trial, and a judge found him not guilty by reason of insanity, court records show.

"I can't wrap my arms around the strategy and decision-making that Tim Cruz has in mental health and criminal responsibility cases," Bergeron said.

In Clancy's case, first-degree murder charges require a trial before a jury.

That left the jury to choose among five possible outcomes including a first-degree murder conviction, lesser charges, not guilty by reason of insanity, and acquittal.

With so many options, the prosecuted faced an uphill climb to guilty verdicts, Bergeron said.

"It's a numbers game and [Cruz has] created his own numbers problem," he said. "They've clouded the picture too much by charging first-degree murder."

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THE CLANCY CASE



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Lawyer Kevin Reddington answered media questions after a mistrial was declared on Friday.

How crime and coverage became a media spectacle

► **MEDIA**
Continued from Page A1

als, the most famous example being the O.J. Simpson case, journalists have largely guided the conversation with context across different mediums.

But in our new age of media, that gap has not only widened, it has splintered.

Traditional journalists, long working within the confines of column inches or seconds of live TV, are now also tasked with delivering the news instantaneously online. And they are competing for eyeballs with anyone else who decides to use their phone, laptop, and social media accounts to create content.

“Historically ... you watch the documentaries, you watch the shows like ‘Forensic Files,’ and those are very neat, packaged. The stories are completed in some way,” Coduto added. “A difference now is that you have the social media angle. Not only

‘Not only can you watch this as it’s unfolding, but you can discuss it . . . with a really wide range of people.’

KATHRYN CODUTO, *assistant professor of media science at BU*

can you watch this as it’s unfolding, but you can discuss it, and you can discuss it with a really wide range of people. You can create your own audience.”

Nicole Moeder, a reporter at NBC 10 WJAR-TV in Providence who was waiting outside the courtroom Thursday, said her followers on Instagram have increased over the last few weeks from “300 or 500” to nearly 9,000, because of videos related to the Clancy trial that have garnered tens of thousands of views.

On Thursday, before court resumed session with a note from the jurors, the line of reporters to get in to the courtroom nearly doubled the line for the general public. More than 60 reporters ranging from Boston-area TV stations and newspapers to international publications The New York Times, NBC, and the Daily Mail were in Plymouth to cover the trial.

Registered media are permitted to bring electronics into the courthouse, but recording and photography are prohibited, with the exception of authorized courtroom photographers and videographers. Outside, it’s a different story. Among the sea of TV crew tents were individuals filming themselves with tripods and selfie sticks, and digital reporters filing stories from their laptops on concrete benches.

Reporters who were in Plymouth throughout the trial — which began July 20 — said the media spectacle had only picked up in the past three weeks, especially after the prosecution rested and the defense began its case.

Perhaps no one has drawn more attention from the media swarm than defense attorney Kevin Reddington, who has opted to give brief remarks while walking in and out of the courtroom, rather than responding

to questions at a podium set up by camera crews.

After proceedings ended Thursday afternoon, a mob followed Reddington all the way to a point behind the courthouse, where state troopers stood and told people to go no further. Dozens of people were huddled around him with almost no space between them.

Photographers were yelling at each other to stay out of their shot and other reporters repeatedly said to make space for Reddington and members of the press. At least one journalist dropped their mobile phone after a boom mic hit them, and another person fell to the ground.

Online, there has been nearly as feisty a digital fray about the case, with true crime blogs and TikTok accounts latching onto details and spinning their own theories.

The trial is the latest example of how, at a time when peo-

ple have access to more content than ever before, the lines between fiction and reality have blurred. Lindsay Clancy has attracted a legion of fans. Despite her admitting she killed her children, many people put forward claims that she was framed, perhaps by her then-husband Patrick Clancy.

Outside of the courtroom Thursday and Friday, Mimi Mejia, 34, was filming herself with a selfie stick for her true crime TikTok page, @mimionthecase. Mejia, from Worcester, said she also covered the Karen Read trial.

She’s among viewers who believe the Clancy case is an example of true crime. Her sympathies largely lie with Clancy, adding that the support for her among some members of the public at the courthouse has been “truly heartwarming.”

Mejia said she chooses the cases she covers based on what’s catching attention on social media, and believes there have been inconsistencies in the cross-examination. She also knows firsthand just how huge the audience has become.

“I’ve been getting over 100,000 views every video I post on my page,” she said, adding that there are viewers on her live page every day from 9 a.m. to 4:30 p.m. “I’m having about anywhere from 14,000 to 25,000 people watching.”

As networks were glued to news from Plymouth Friday while the public awaited the formal ruling of a mistrial, CNN anchor Pamela Brown began to cry as she discussed how the children were killed. Robert Hirschhorn, a legal analyst who spoke to CNN, even tried to pin a catchphrase on a moment that probably didn’t warrant one.

It was, he said, “the deadlock on Plymouth Rock.”

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ICE officer released in shooting case

Pled not guilty to lying to investigators

By **Valerie Gonzalez and Alanna Durkin Richter**
ASSOCIATED PRESS

MCALLEN, Texas — A US Immigration and Customs Enforcement officer was ordered released from federal custody Friday after pleading not guilty to lying to investigators about the circumstances that led to the shooting of a Venezuelan man during the Minnesota immigration crackdown last winter.

The federal indictment accuses Christian Castro of falsely telling investigators that he was attacked with a broom and shovel before he opened fire, injuring Julio Cesar Sosa-Celis in January.

Castro was shackled at his wrists, waist, and feet during a brief hearing in the federal court in McAllen after he turned himself into authorities Thursday evening. The judge ordered him released on a \$75,000 unsecured bond and with a GPS ankle monitor.

It’s the first Justice Department prosecution of a federal officer for actions taken during this year’s massive Operation Metro Surge, which brought thousands of agents to the Twin Cities and led to sweeping pro-

tests, arrests, and the fatal shootings of two US citizens by federal officers.

The allegations in the federal indictment mirror those brought by Minnesota officials, who have separately charged Castro with assault and false reporting of a crime related to the nonfatal shooting of Sosa-Celis.

According to the federal indictment, Castro told an FBI agent that a man grabbed a red broom off a front porch and began hitting him with it while Castro was trying to detain another man outside a Minneapolis home. Castro also claimed that another man hit him with a snow shovel and that he opened fire while on the ground as the men ran away.

The indictment alleges that Castro had a short “physical interaction” with Sosa-Celis and another man, before the two ran into a home with a 1-year-old child inside. Castro then fired a shot through the front door while standing as the men began to close it, hitting Sosa-Celis in the leg, the indictment says.

“No person struck” Castro “with a broom as he described, and no persons wielded the broom and snow shovel as he described,” the indictment says.

An attorney for Castro urged the public not to rush to judgment without learning all the facts and to let his client “have his day in court.” Castro

served in the military before becoming a federal immigration officer, the lawyer, David Lindenmuth, said after the hearing.

“His life has been that of public service to our country and to our nation, either through its military or protecting its borders and enforcing its laws,” Lindenmuth said.

Federal prosecutors had initially charged Sosa-Celis and the other man, Alfredo Alejandro Aljorna, with assault but dropped the charges after video evidence showed the officer may have lied about the encounter. Castro was suspended from ICE in February while authorities pursued an investigation.

The federal charges follow Castro’s release from jail last week after Texas’ governor refused to immediately sign an extradition warrant to hand him over to Minnesota authorities.

The federal investigation into Castro created turmoil inside the Justice Department, with a prosecutor on the case accusing higher-ups of blocking efforts to bring more serious civil rights charges.

In an email obtained by ProPublica, the prosecutor told lawyers for Sosa-Celis and others that Castro would be charged only with making false statements over his “strongest objections,” adding the decision

was “being directed by the Main Justice and the US Attorney.”

A person familiar with the investigation, however, told The Associated Press on Thursday that the civil rights probe is continuing and additional charges could still be brought.

The prosecutor, Matthew Evans, has since been fired and the Justice Department is now investigating whether he broke any laws during his handling of the case, said the person, who spoke on the condition of anonymity because they were not publicly authorized to discuss ongoing investigations.

An automatic email response from Evans’ Justice Department account said he was on leave, and other attempts to reach him were not immediately successful.

Sosa-Celis’ lawyer is pressing for Castro to face stiffer charges, saying in a statement on Thursday that Castro’s statements were made to “cover up the fact that he shot my client through the door of an occupied house without a self-defense justification.”

“Mr. Sosa-Celis wants Mr. Castro to be held fully accountable for his crimes,” said the attorney, Robin Wolpert. The American Civil Liberties Union of Minnesota said Thursday that Sosa-Celis also plans to seek damages from the federal government.



KENNY HOLSTON/NEW YORK TIMES/FILE

Senator John Fetterman’s texts reveal deep antipathy to the daily work of being a senator, a Wall Street Journal story said.

Group may reveal Fetterman messages

WASHINGTON — Senator John Fetterman, a Pennsylvania Democrat, has for years detested the day-to-day duties of his job, dismissing such tasks as going to hearings and casting votes as a “performative” waste of time.

Now, a group of his disillusioned former staff members — of which there are many — is threatening to reveal more about his private disdain for what is expected of him as an elected representative of 13 million constituents.

On Friday afternoon, a new account, @FettermanStaff, sprang up on the social platform X, threatening to publicize unflattering material about the first-term senator, including screen shots of his internal communications.

It came after The Wall Street Journal published fresh revelations highlighting Fetterman’s deep antipathy to the daily work of being a senator, including meeting with groups from his state and attending a funeral for fallen police officers.

“Why do I have to keep meeting with CHOP,” said a text message attributed to him that was published by The Wall Street Journal, but not independently verified by The New York Times, referring to the Children’s Hospital of Philadelphia.

After an aide explained that its representatives were concerned about vaccines and Medicaid cuts, he responded, according to the Journal: “Well, I’m not. I’m convinced they just want free trips to DC.”

The new social media account, which two former staff

members confirmed was authentic and described as a group effort, promised that communications like this were plentiful and would soon be on public display. The former aides spoke about the effort on the condition of anonymity.

“We’re a group of former campaign & Senate staffers for John Fetterman who are disgusted with what he’s become,” the group wrote in its first post, calling the Journal’s report “the tip of the iceberg.”

“It’s even worse than you thought.”

The anonymous account said the people behind it planned to share stories that would “show Pennsylvanians exactly who their Senator is.” It said the first “drop” of information would land on Sept. 14.

Fetterman did not respond to a text message seeking comment.

NEW YORK TIMES

Doctor who advises RFK Jr. to probe vaccine claims

The Department of Health and Human Services has hired an Army doctor with a history of questioning the safety of COVID vaccines to investigate unsubstantiated claims that more than 2,500 US service members died after receiving the shots.

The hiring of Lieutenant Colonel Theresa Long, who has no specialized training in vaccines or viruses, is part of Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr.’s campaign to explore baseless theories about the hazards of vaccines.

There is little evidence to support this latest investigation. More than 96 percent of service members were vaccinat-

ed against COVID before a mandate that they receive the shots was rescinded. A March report from the Pentagon, and one in July 2025, found no deaths from the vaccines.

Long said in an Aug. 14 legal deposition obtained by The New York Times that she is a senior medical military adviser to Kennedy but also reports to Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth.

She said in the deposition that she had been appointed to investigate 55,000 reports of adverse effects and 2,544 deaths among service members who received COVID vaccines, in the federal Vaccine Adverse Event Reporting System.

Long and HHS did not respond to requests for comment.

NEW YORK TIMES

Trump to fly to Ireland on plane donated by Qataris

WASHINGTON — President Trump is planning to take the Boeing luxury jet donated by the Qataris when he travels to Ireland next week, the first time he will use the plane overseas since questions were raised about its defensive capabilities, a senior administration official said Friday.

Trump had said several weeks ago that the plane would be taken out of service for roughly a month for new security upgrades.

The Washington Post reported earlier on Trump’s plans to use the Qatari plane. A senior White House official, speaking on background, would not comment on specific upgrades to Air Force One.

The plane was retrofitted quickly to be pushed into service for Trump to use during

his current term, after two new jets commissioned from Boeing for presidential travel were badly delayed. But those planes are intended as essentially flying presidential command centers, with extensive capabilities to fend off missile strikes, and they can take a long time to build.

Asked about his travel plans and whether the Qatari jet would still be “maxed out” for security, as he put it weeks ago, the president said on Friday, “Well, it has a lot of stuff, but to max it out, meaning you can go into any territory, it’ll take about 60 days and it’s being sent in October to be maxed out.”

The Qatari jet’s safety capabilities came into question after Trump last used it on a foreign trip, to the NATO summit in Turkey in July. Trump declared that he would fly on one of the older presidential aircraft for his departure, instead of the Qatari jet that he had flown on to Europe, for “old time’s sake.”

Multiple people with knowledge of the matter said that there had been a security concern about him flying aboard the Qatari plane. The New York Times reported that the Qatari jet lacked defensive capabilities that the older models have.

People briefed on the matter later said that officials had learned of a threat to the president and Air Force One while they were in Turkey.

Although he boarded the older plane at the airport in Ankara, Turkey, it later emerged that the president had been whisked off it and onto a military jet, leaving the older Air Force One aircraft as a decoy.

NEW YORK TIMES

New England’s forests are in trouble

By Phil Primack

Phil Primack was New Hampshire’s “Outstanding Tree Farmer” in 2024. He is a Medford-based writer.

Two historic copper beech trees — one on the Belmont Town Green and the other at Saugus Iron Works National Historic Site — were felled over the summer. These iconic trees had offered shade and beauty for generations, but they were high-profile losers in an arboreal battle against invasive pests and disease that is reshaping the look and feel of the New England forest.

The pest invasion is widespread. Microscopic roundworms cause beech leaf disease, also known as BLD. The aphid-like woolly adelgid attacks hemlocks. The southern pine beetle, an aggressive bug that reached Massachusetts in 2023, threatens Cape Cod’s signature pitch pine groves. Ash trees have been nearly wiped out by yet another invasive species: the emerald ash borer.

“I do think it’s going to become more obvious that the forest is being transformed,” David Orwig, senior ecologist at Harvard Forest, the 4,000-acre ecological research area in Petersham, owned by Harvard University, said in an interview. “We are losing more species, and trees are being killed off more quickly. Adelgid damage to hemlocks was rapid, but beech leaf disease could be even faster.”

The nation’s ever-increasing flow of imports may boost commerce, but all those ships also deliver unintended, six-legged consequences. Drought and other environmental factors wrought by climate change compound the creeping threats to the woods.

“Four years ago, we didn’t see BLD here and now it infects 90 percent of our beech trees,” Orwig said. “Half of our beech trees have maybe 10 leaves left on them.”

The Massachusetts Department of Conservation and Recreation’s 2025 forest health aerial survey confirms BLD’s rap-



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Rot is seen on a 150-year-old beech tree in the Belmont Town Green on July 30. The tree was cut down due to beech leaf disease.

id spread. In 2021, none of the state’s forest canopy was affected; just four years later, BLD had reached 21,582 acres. Not all beeches within those areas will necessarily die, but their prognosis is poor, especially since many are already weakened by beech bark disease, an insect-fungus combination.

The same damage is apparent in the 108-acre tree farm I manage in Epping, N.H. I see the tiny white dots that indicate woolly adelgid and the dark leaf striping that confirms BLD everywhere. The effect extends far beyond the loss of trees. With their thick branches, hemlocks affect the temperature of the ground, and their needles acidify the forest floor. Nutrient-rich beech nuts are a major food source for deer, bears, and other animals. Other trees will replace the lost species — black birch is proliferating in my forest — but they will alter light, temperature, and other conditions of the forest floor, which in turn impact plant, insect, and animal life.

While people like me who spend lots of time with trees are aware of what’s happening, everyone will soon notice. Eastern hemlock and beech comprised about 15 percent of the Massachusetts forest canopy in 2019, according to the US Forest Service. Without them, Robert Frost’s woods may remain lovely — but not nearly so dark and deep.

Tree species have been lost before. Billions of American chestnuts died in roughly five decades due to chestnut blight, an invasive fungus that arrived in the early 1900s. A half century later, tiny wood-boring beetles spread a fungus that devastated the American elm, a favorite street shade tree.

But the scale and spread of the current rapid, multi-species decline may be unprecedented. While some natural phenomena, like extremely cold winters, can slow the pests’ spread, researchers are also experimenting with chemical and biological controls, such as an insecticide that kills woolly adelgid. But such treatments are impractical in large forest stands, where the greater hope may lie with battling bugs. Two years ago, New Hampshire foresters released predatory beetles that feed on the adelgid into my woods. It’s too soon to know who is eating whom.

Because such biocontrols may not succeed, New Hampshire is taking proactive steps to prevent ash tree extinction. State foresters hope to protect and preserve the seeds from 100 stands of healthy, mature ashes. They are also investigating areas where most ashes have died to look for “lingering” ashes, trees that have managed to survive for genetic or other reasons. Material from these trees is then grafted to rootstock at the state forest nursery. The hope is that seeds and sprouts from healthy trees can produce a less vulnerable population.

Massachusetts does not have such an ash propagation program, according to a DCR spokesperson, though department staff regularly use biocontrols on healthy ash and hemlock, with priority given to significant areas like old growth ash trees in the Mohawk Trail area.

“You can say that nature will handle itself, and maybe it will,” said University of New Hampshire forester Greg Jordan, who helped manage my tree farm years ago as a private forester. “If you care about the forest, how do you not address a non-native invasion? In good conscience, we have to try to fight back against these things.”

Those old copper beeches in Saugus and Belmont are gone. Trees that are just sprouts today can offer similar calm and comfort to future generations — if the current one acts now.



ANTHONY CAMERANO/AP

Gloria Steinem in New York on Feb. 17, 1970.

Gloria Steinem taught us that our ambitions were valid

By Nancy Gertner

Nancy Gertner is a retired US district judge.

To understand Gloria Steinem’s extraordinary impact, you have to understand what life was like for women in the 1970s, when she came onto the national scene and cofounded Ms. Magazine.

This was a time when my college professor assigned Betty Friedan’s “The Feminine Mystique” but also told us to put an aspirin between our knees and keep them shut. The “Feminine Mystique” debunked the view that women were content with being wives and mothers. This was a time when few women attended law school. At my alma mater, Yale, there were 20 in a class of 165. (This was an improvement; the year before there were 8, and even less before that; today it is 50:50).

This was a time when my mother could say to me when I was accepted at Yale — seriously — that I had “priced myself out of the male market.” That I would never find a man. It was a time when a hypothetical case presented by a law professor began, “two members of the weaker sex.”

It was a time when the judge to whom I was applying for a clerkship asked me whether I planned to marry and have children; if I did, he said, the clerkship would be “wasted.” I lied; I told him I would never think of it. After I began working for him, he insisted that I use the “women’s entrance” at a local club where he was a member. I organized a demonstration; all clerks, male and female, would use that entrance.

It was a time when one law firm partner refused to consider my application because, as he told me, he didn’t think women could be trial lawyers. And prosecutors felt free to comment on my looks. One prosecutor admitted that he didn’t want to talk about my client; he just wanted to chase me around his desk. A judge mocked me when I introduced myself as “Ms. Gertner.” Another saw fit to comment on my “build.”

Steinem’s writings, speeches, the very example of her life, gave voice to what we — the second-wave generation of feminists, the generation after women’s suffrage — were trying to do with our lives. But more than that, she gave le-

gitimacy to what we were thinking about, our fears and our concerns.

She told us that our ambitions were valid, even though they didn’t look like our mothers’. Our discomfort with the status quo was understandable; it needed to be changed. That support from her and others in the nascent feminist movement, as well as from one another, was critical.

Consciousness-raising groups of women were like oxygen. “This happened to me,” you would say, sharing some incident of blatant sexism. “Did that happen to you?” Or even more important, what could be done about it? Describing Ms. Magazine’s significance, Steinem once said, “At last, we know we are not alone.”

The breadth of her work was stunning, about economic independence — in some states in the 1970s, a woman could not have credit in her own name — sharing the responsibilities of domestic life, including child rearing, then largely unheard of; reproductive rights just as Roe v. Wade was decided; domestic violence, which was too often tolerated or even excused; maternity leave, which was nonexistent; and a host of problems that had no name. “When we started, there was not even a term for sexual harassment,” she said. “It was just called life.”

The discussions she and other feminist leaders started seem normal today, but back then they were revolutionary. I met Steinem at a celebration for the revelatory book about women’s health, “Our Bodies, Ourselves,” in Boston. I was a federal district court judge in my forties and, candidly, I was starstruck.

To younger readers, one might say this is just past history, a relic of a long ago time. But they would be wrong.

As Kathryn Seelye wrote in The New York Times this week: “Women still earn less than men for the same work (81 cents for every dollar made by a man, according to the 2024 census). The Equal Rights Amendment, prohibiting discrimination on account of sex ... is still not part of the Constitution. The 1973 decision legalizing abortion, a central goal of the movement, was overturned in 2022. ... No woman has been elected president. Anti-female bias remains entrenched.”

Gloria Steinem’s work is as important today as it was then. And since too many are content with the status quo, perhaps more.

Alzheimer’s patients deserve to know their diagnosis

By Robert R. Redfield

Robert R. Redfield, former director of the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, is cofounder and associate director of the Institute of Human Virology at the University of Maryland School of Medicine.

In the 1980s, I was an Army doctor fighting on the front lines of the HIV/AIDS crisis before health officials fully understood the disease or how to treat it. I knew the way to combat the lack of research and understanding was to institute regular testing so that experts could diagnose the disease early. But federal medical authorities disagreed, advising doctors that since there was nothing to treat it, people had a right to remain ignorant.

Today, I hear the same argument about Alzheimer’s disease. Why tell people they have the disease if there is no cure?

The argument against early diagnosis is as absurd for Alzheimer’s as it was for HIV. Early diagnosis is good for patients because it opens up treatment options and spurs innovation; when a patient is diagnosed, they demand treatment, and the industry invests in treatment and cures when demand grows louder.

In the ’80s, patients progressed from HIV infection to AIDS and died soon afterward. Today, with treatment, they can live a natural lifetime.

But even before effective HIV therapies existed, officials who claimed there was “nothing we could do” were wrong. We could evaluate a patient’s immune system and identify who was most vulnerable. We could prevent opportunistic infections that

take advantage of the HIV patient’s weakened immune system. We could treat co-infections like tuberculosis and syphilis more effectively. We could stop people from unknowingly infecting spouses and partners.

Because of this, I found it unfathomable that efforts to diagnose HIV were being blocked. I remember the Red Cross testing donated blood for HIV to protect recipients, but there was a period, roughly between 1986 and 1988, when donors who tested positive were not necessarily informed of their results.

It was not until roughly 10 years later that the broader public health community, including the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention and Public Health Service, fully embraced routine HIV testing. That decade of insufficient testing undoubtedly cost many people their lives.

If we fail to start routinely testing for Alzheimer’s, we will fail another population of needy patients. More than 7 million Americans live with the disease, and that number is projected to nearly double by 2060. We owe it to those patients to arm them with answers and options as early as possible.

Just as undetected HIV yields the devastating symptoms of AIDS, Alzheimer’s has a silent phase that leads to the symptoms of cognitive impairment and loss of function. During this silent phase, which can last 20 years, amyloid proteins in the brain begin to misfold and clump into neuron-killing plaques.

Today, we have FDA-cleared blood tests that can identify these biological signs of Alzheimer’s disease before symptoms become severe. We have FDA-approved therapies that have been shown to slow disease progression if initiated while symptoms are

mild. We know that good exercise, sleep, and cardiovascular health can meaningfully influence cognitive outcomes.

That means Alzheimer’s patients who understand their risk can do something about it.

Every American over 50 should have access to Alzheimer’s screening as part of routine preventive care. Positive tests should be paired with standardized cognitive assessments so physicians can determine what stage of disease the patient is in and take action based on those results.

The good news is that our public health leaders are increasingly focused on early intervention. Health and Human Services Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. called it “regulatory malpractice” that America does not already have early Alzheimer’s screening.

These leaders have an opportunity to lean in further and do for Alzheimer’s what public health leaders eventually did for HIV: to stop treating diagnosis as something to fear and start treating it as the first step toward action. Lawmakers must modernize Medicare coverage so beneficiaries have reliable access to Alzheimer’s blood tests and therapies.

Americans want access to early diagnosis and interventions. New polling from the libertarian Market Institute shows that 4 in 5 say they are more likely to support candidates who prioritize better access to Alzheimer’s detection, diagnosis, and treatment.

When my critics argued that HIV patients had a right not to know, they were really denying patients the opportunity to act.

We eventually learned that ignorance was not compassion. We should not have to learn that lesson twice.

READERS’ FORUM

Grappling with the unknowable in the Clancy case

The conversations Gloria Steinem started

Among many other topics, she offered wisdom on aging and grief

Gloria Steinem, who died Wednesday, at 92, will be remembered for her advocacy for women’s rights and her determination to challenge conventions (“At Smith and beyond, her words resound,” Page A1, Sept. 4). She spent much of her life challenging us to talk openly about subjects that were often ignored, among them, particularly in her later years, aging and grief.

She celebrated aging when many tried to resist it. Her assertion, “This is what 40 looks like,” became a longstanding rejection of those expectations, even through her final decades of life.

She did not treat grief as a taboo topic either. She shared in a 2024 interview that grief is an expression of the love that we have for others in our lives. Grief and love are distinct emotions, but in this sense, they are al-



WIN MCNAMEE/GETTY IMAGES

President Obama awarded the Presidential Medal of Freedom to Gloria Steinem on Nov. 20, 2013.

so inseparable. This is an important lesson for us to remember as we reflect on Steinem’s life and influential legacy.

We have difficulty talking about aging and death as a society, and many families do not know how to approach end-of-life conversations. They often happen during medical crises when families are already overwhelmed with decisions. Grief support is such a significant part of hospice and palliative care because it is intended to support the family as they process the loss of a loved one, but we should not wait until the final days to have these conversations.

Steinem devoted her life to encouraging people to talk about the hard issues. Her passing offers another opportunity to do that.

DIANA FRANCHITTO
Foxborough

The writer is the president and CEO of HopeHealth, a Providence-based hospice provider.

She helped us imagine who we would become

“We are becoming the men we wanted to marry,” Gloria Steinem famously observed.

In my preteen years, working women were nurses, teachers, secretaries, or housewives. So I fantasized about marrying a writer, never imagining I might become one.

Steinem was only some 16 years older than I am, but she and her generation of second-wave feminists helped make my life possible.

WENDY KAMINER
Boston

Care providers need ways to talk openly about the challenges they face

Re “My book was found in Clancy’s kitchen. I’m here to set the record straight about intrusive thoughts” (Opinion, Sept. 4): The murder case against Lindsay Clancy, which ended in a mistrial Friday after the jury could not reach a unanimous verdict, has forced difficult questions about the behavioral health care she received. Karen Kleiman’s commentary underscores how complicated those judgments can be. Symptoms can be difficult to interpret, insight can change, and patients may withhold information because they fear what disclosure could mean.

Those questions matter. But as we scrutinize providers’ decisions, we cannot forget what it means to make them.

Every day, perinatal and mental health providers make extraordinarily consequential judgments with incomplete information, weighing the risks of unnecessarily escalating care against the devastating consequences of not intervening enough. They do so within imperfect systems they did not design and cannot individually fix.

Not only do we need to address the devastating systemic issues plaguing our maternal health care system, such as care voids, insufficient federal and state funding, and damaging policies, but

health care workers need meaningful, ongoing opportunities to talk openly about the challenges they face, including spaces with peers where they do not have to diagnose, treat, solve, or be the expert.

When outcomes are devastating, providers can carry grief, trauma, and moral injury. And still, they must walk into the next room, with the next patient, and make those difficult judgments again.

Supporting the mental health and moral injury of our health care workforce must be essential to strengthening our health care system, especially here in Massachusetts. If we expect providers to continue caring for all of us, we must build a system designed to care for them too.

LIZ FRIEDMAN
CEO and cofounder
GPS Group Peer Support
Northampton

The writer leads the MASStrong program administered by the Betsy Lehman Center for Patient Safety with support from the Massachusetts Behavioral Trust Fund.

How can psychiatrists call themselves ‘expert’ witnesses?

After 50 years in psychiatric practice, I



CHARLES KRUPA/AP

Defense attorney Kevin Reddington spoke to the media after the judge declared a mistrial in Lindsay Clancy’s murder trial at Plymouth County Superior Court on Sept. 4 in Plymouth.

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CHRISTOPHER WEYANT



Trump dilutes wetlands protocols

Moves to revoke federal protection

By Maxine Joselow

NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — The Trump administration on Friday took another step toward stripping federal protections from millions of acres of wetlands, which help filter drinking water for many communities and provide critical habitats for birds, fish, and other wildlife.

The proposed rule from the Environmental Protection Agency and the US Army Corps of Engineers would significantly narrow the definition of “waters of the United States,” or WOTUS, that are protected from harmful pollution under the Clean Water Act of 1972.

The new version is more sweeping than an initial proposal released in November, which would have removed federal protections from fewer wetlands nationwide. The plan would deliver a victory to farmers, ranchers, and rural landowners who have chafed at the protections, calling them an infringement on their property rights.

“Under President Trump’s leadership and the Army’s ‘Building Infrastructure, Not Paperwork’ initiative, we are overhauling sclerotic government overreach to remove friction from our economy,” Adam Telle, the official overseeing the Army Corps of Engineers, said in a statement.

President Trump said Thursday that he was appointing Telle to take over as the acting Army secretary, replacing Daniel Driscoll, who resigned after clashing repeatedly with Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth.

The Clean Water Act requires companies and individuals to obtain a permit from the EPA before releasing pollutants into the nation’s waterways. They must also receive a permit from the US Army Corps of Engineers before discharging any dredged or fill material, such as sand, silt, or construction debris.

A Supreme Court decision in 2023 set the stage for the Trump administration’s proposal by sharply curtailing the EPA’s power to police waterways. In the majority opinion in Sackett v. EPA, Justice Samuel Alito wrote that the Clean Water Act allowed the agency to regulate only “relatively permanent” bodies of water and wetlands connected to them.

But Alito did not explicitly define a “relatively permanent” body of water. The absence of a clear definition caused confusion for farmers and landowners, who were unsure whether they needed a permit before building on their properties near wetlands, lakes, and streams.

In the November proposal, the Trump administration defined a “relatively permanent” body of water as one that flowed either every day or during the “wet season.” The proposal Friday would define it as one that flowed every day except for temporary interruptions like droughts lasting less than 30 days.

That change may sound highly technical, but it could have far-reaching consequences, potentially stripping federal protections from 94 percent of US wetlands, according to the Natural Resources Defense Council, an environmental group.

“Finalizing this proposal would be declaring open season on the nation’s waterways,” said Jon Devine, the group’s director of freshwater ecosystems.

He added that very few wetlands about other bodies of water that flow every day, with the exception of a handful of coastal wetlands influenced by tides.

But Zippy Duvall, the president of the American Farm Bureau Federation, an agricultural lobbying group, said the new plan would end regulatory headaches for farmers and ranchers.

“The new WOTUS rule provides a clear understanding of federal jurisdiction, which is critical for farmers who may face severe penalties or even jail time for unknowingly violating the law,” Duvall said in a statement.

The EPA and the Army Corps of Engineers will solicit public comments on the proposal for 30 days before finalizing it.

Mass. Pike rest stops, there when you need them

►REST STOPS

Continued from Page A1

spect to these hidden-in-plain-sight landmarks. They’re not fancy. They’re fine. Mostly fine. They have everything you need, so long as you don’t need much. And for decades, they’ve been ours, as nondescript as the drive they service.

Let’s kick it off heading west out of the city at the Framingham Service Plaza. You’ve been holding it since the Central Artery, which makes you regret the little laugh you let out when you see a road sign, two miles out, informing you the coming rest stop has a Boston Market.

There’s a Starbucks in a satellite building that greets you on the off-ramp to get into the plaza. But your plumbing is too full to think about that, so you park near the sad dog walk area — grass, weeds, the smell of weed — and speed-shuffle through the parking lot, the double doors, past the creepy Ronald McDonald statue sitting on a bench, the food court, the claw machines, to the restroom.

Now that you can relax, you enter that gentle nowhere that is a Mass. Pike rest stop. Comfortable and distant. You know this place, but you’ve never needed or wanted to look at it. Each time you’ve come, the only objective was to get out as quickly as possible. You need to get back on the road. You need to make good time.

Not today. You count the claw machines. There are six, and hanging above one, incongruously, is one of those office motivational posters that were big in the ’80s and ’90s. This one is a photo of a zebra with a blue bird sitting on its back. “Team-mates” it says in large font. Has that always been here? Why is it here? Where *are* you?

You survey the food options, which consists of McDonald’s or McDonald’s. The rest of the food court is abandoned. Fresh City and Original Pizza of Boston are dark and deserted, and Boston Market is a ghost. You head toward the little convenience store for the Gulf gas station, then have a weird déjà vu feeling as you pause outside it in an empty area and want to say there used to be a sunglasses kiosk in this very spot. Then something else tells you it was a Beanie Babies kiosk. Then something else tells you to get fresh air and grab a cup of coffee at Starbucks, until you see the signs blocking off the parking spaces out front announcing that it is drive-thru only, and the drive-thru en-



PHOTOS BY SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

The Natick Service Plaza on the eastbound side of the Massachusetts Turnpike is one of those that is to be redone.



trance is back on the off-ramp.

On to Westborough, where you meet a woman so friendly it feels out of place. Her name is Chanthaly Pirdy and for 10 years she’s worked at the Cheesy Street Grill, which is tucked inside the cavernous and empty octagonal dining room that all these rest areas have. She offers you a sample, and a lesson on what’s great about this place.

“I’ve been to the big fancy rest areas in other states, and they’re nice and all, but for an old state like Massachusetts, this works for us,” she says. “Everything always has to be newer and better, but that’s not New England. We like an old-school

feel.”

Suddenly, you feel a weird anticipatory nostalgia, and after you get a coffee from Wong at Dunkin’ and she says that thing about its low-key likable dinginess, you find yourself appreciating the dingy orange tiles on the floor, the dingy bathroom, that strange empty space outside the convenience store that you’re now 96 percent certain used to have a sunglasses kiosk.

In Charlton, you stop for far too long at the pay phone — you read that correctly — and wish your kids were with you so you could bore them with stories about how a dime used to mean something.



You get off the pike, turn around, and hit the eastbound Charlton plaza, which is just like the one across the road, except now you’re having weird thoughts, like: Are these places charming specifically because of their utter lack of charm? They have food, gas, bathrooms, snacks. What more do you need? You see three people napping in their cars, so that’s a check on the “rest” in rest stop.

Heading back toward Boston, you see a sign for the Natick plaza with the notation “last services on Mass Pike,” and it gives the whole thing a funeral feeling as you pull in and park.

You go inside and find your-

self standing in appreciation before the familiar wooden sign, which they all have and which you’ve seen countless times but never really noticed, that reads “Restrooms” with a right arrow underneath.

“They don’t make signs like this anymore,” you say to a person who has stopped to watch you watch the sign, and is probably weighing whether to call an ambulance or the police.

You leave before they make up their mind, merge into traffic, and go back to trying to make good time.

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Blue Hill Ave. plan adds parking, trims bike lanes

►BLUE HILL AVENUE

Continued from Page A1

“worn and dated” thoroughfare desperately needs.

What it offers, Wu said, is “basically a full reconstruction that represents the biggest investment in this transportation corridor in decades.”

The redesign also includes what officials called beautification improvements all along Blue Hill Avenue, including newly repaved sidewalks, better street lighting, and 200 trees.

City officials and the T will host four public meetings on this proposal, starting Thursday through Sept. 30. They’re aiming to finalize the design by the end of 2027. Phased construction would begin the next year and last through 2030.

The layout marks the latest move to get the project underway since Boston launched the redesign seven years ago, and there’s \$95 million in federal funding on the line if it doesn’t move forward. The state, the city, and the T are committing another \$64 million altogether.

In other parts of Boston, the Wu administration has faced scrutiny for stalling bike and street safety improvement projects for years, before promising in July a slew of changes — including more concrete barriers on bike lanes — in the wake of the death of Boston city planner and cyclist Louisa Gag.

But the fine-tuning on bike lanes for Blue Hill Avenue does little to change the conversation around the issue that has generated the most pushback: the center-running bus lane.

And it comes as critics have complained about how City Hall



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Traffic filled in both sides of Blue Hill Avenue in Mattapan during an afternoon rush hour in June.

treats their input on neighborhood projects, as well as longstanding frustration about decades of neglect on the avenue dating to the 1950s, when the streetcar trolley along it was eliminated.

Another similar rapid bus transit project through Blue Hill Avenue died in 2009.

Earlier this year, Boston City Councilors Brian Worrell and Miniard Culpepper even recommended replacing the center-running bus lane with an extension of the Orange Line. The T vowed to study the option but suggested refocusing on “immediate improvements.”

Some of those are laid out in the newest design.

Roughly 11 of the 14 existing miles of roadway in either direction would be preserved for motor vehicles with two or more general-purpose traffic lanes.

That’s far more than a previous design in which 60 percent of the road would have had two

lanes in either direction.

Five blocks along Blue Hill Avenue would also be subject to rush-hour changes, in which parking lanes would transform into travel lanes during peak traffic times.

There are other special carveouts: The design proposes creating a separated “carriage-way” near Franklin Park to make boarding buses easier, while a section in Grove Hall would have a designated zone for safe school pickup and drop-off.

The new layout would increase the number of parking spaces to 717 from 675. Notably, the plan would cut the number of all-day parking spaces by 10, but offset those losses with 52 spots available outside of traffic-heavy windows.

Near the Morningstar Baptist Church, for example, cars would be allowed to park on the median on Sundays.

The bike lanes previously

proposed in both directions along Blue Hill Avenue and through Mattapan Square are gone in the new plan. Instead, officials suggested creating a two-way separated bike path on the avenue along Franklin Park, and another from American Legion Highway to Woodhaven Street.

And the proposed improvements extend well beyond the roadway itself. The design includes plans for six miles of rebuilt sidewalks with accessible curb ramps and 19 new walk signals.

Altogether, the addition of the center-running bus lane and bus boarding platforms is expected to reduce travel times for 40,000 daily bus riders by 10 to 15 minutes. Car traffic would be faster in the proposed layout than the previous design, officials estimate.

State Representative Russell Holmes, whose district covers much of the corridor, said the design is proof officials have “changed everywhere that we can” in response to community feedback.

“Everybody has their desires, and no one gets everything they want,” the Mattapan Democrat said. “But this is about balancing bikes, bus riders, cars, walkers, and students. It’s about everybody.”

But not everyone is satisfied with the latest layout.

Dianne Wilkerson, a former Massachusetts state senator and critic of the project, said the new design does not address her and other community members’ primary concern about the center-running bus lane.

“We will not be in the only community . . . that would re-

quire our elders and parents pushing baby carriages to run to the middle of the street and risk their lives to get on the bus,” said Wilkerson, who accused public officials of not giving the same credence to the objections from the Black community as they do from white, wealthier residents. “No’ can’t mean ‘no’ from every other neighborhood of the city except for the three places disconnected from the rest of the transit system for 40 years.”

Worrell, the city councilor who suggested extending the Orange Line, believes Boston still should study a rail expansion before locking Blue Hill Avenue into a “bus-only future.”

“Rail here has never been thought about seriously,” Worrell said. “Is this a transportation plan, or just a center-running bus lane plan? It doesn’t take into consideration the best way to provide public transportation to thousands of residents who use transit here.”

Kahlil Cooper, a program manager at the Mattapan Food and Fitness Coalition, lauded the new design for prioritizing local bus riders, who make up about half the travelers on Blue Hill Avenue on any given day.

“The city was able to effectively listen to the community and change pieces that people had gripes about,” Cooper said. “But at what point do you put your foot down and say we cannot make any more changes because of timeline constraints? At what point does the discussion end?”

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Activists aim to suspend law easing abortion rules

Want to halt implementation and put question on 2028 ballot seeking its repeal

By Chris Van Buskirk
GLOBE STAFF

Antiabortion activists in Massachusetts filed paperwork with the state launching a bid to suspend and eventually seek the repeal of a law that makes it easier for women to receive an abortion later in pregnancy.

That move sets up a potential ballot battle in 2028 and, more immediately, kick-starts a scramble to stop the law before it can even take effect.

Massachusetts Democrats have repeatedly stepped in to bolster the state's reproductive health care laws in the years after the Supreme Court struck

down the constitutional right to an abortion, including last month when Governor Maura Healey signed a measure making Massachusetts' abortion laws among the broadest in the country.

Sam Miele, the director of the conservative group Massachusetts Family Action, said his group is behind the repeal push, motivated by what he called the "audacity of our governor" to approve the abortion law in early August.

"Maura Healey, she took a political

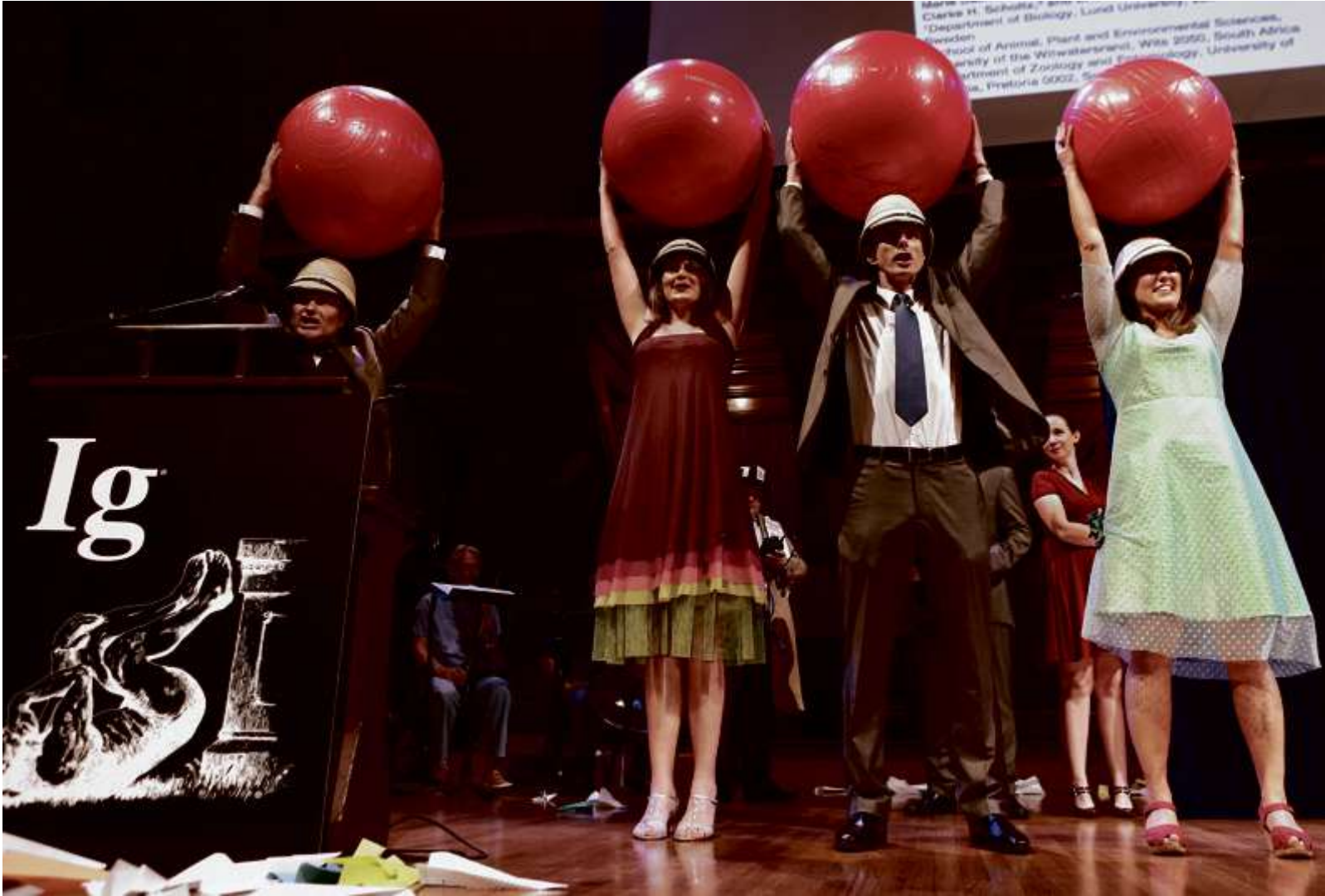
bet, and it went too far," Miele said Thursday.

The law reshapes the rules for how women can terminate their pregnancies at 24 weeks or after. State law used to allow abortion at that stage only under specific circumstances, including to preserve a patient's life. The new law, which takes effect in early November, leaves the decision to end a pregnancy entirely to "the professional judgment of a physician."

Healey, lawmakers, and advocates said the change was necessary, citing examples of women and families reported being forced to leave Massachusetts — and pay thousands of dollars — to seek abortion care despite the state being viewed as a haven for abortion access.

Reproductive Equity Now, an advocacy group, estimates that dozens of patients do so each year, and Claire Tey-

ABORTION LAW, Page B4



WINSLOW TOWNSON/ASSOCIATED PRESS

From left: Eric Warrant, Emily Baird, Marcus Byrne, and Marie Dacke celebrated winning the Biology/Astronomy Prize.

'You need to have the winners there'

The Ig Nobel Prizes have always been held in Mass. This year, they're in Zurich amid concerns about safety for international attendees due to US policies

By Allyson Chiu
GLOBE STAFF

It usually takes 10 minutes for Marc Abrahams, founder of the Ig Nobel Prizes, to walk from his home in Cambridge to the annual award ceremony — a world-renowned spectacle celebrating quirky scientific achievements.

But this year, Abrahams's trip involves an international flight.

For the first time since the awards — a satirical version of the Nobel prizes — were created in 1991, the ceremony, which draws hundreds of scientists and journalists from around the world, is not being held in Cambridge or Boston. Organizers said they decided to move the event to Zurich due to concerns that many international participants, including award winners, would not feel comfortable or be able to come to the United States amid the Trump administration's immigration crackdown and attacks on science.

"The situation here has been getting worse all the time," said Abrahams, who noted that he had spoken with many attendees from



FABRICE COFFRINI/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Ig Nobel prize winners gathered on stage during the awards ceremony in Zurich.

other countries who expressed concerns about news of people in the United States being detained and deported, or facing intense searches and questioning at airports. "They had no idea whether it was going to be safe for them or not."

A spokesperson for the US Department of Homeland Security

said it is committed to ensuring safety for everyone involved in major events.

"International visitors who legally come to the United States have nothing to worry about," the spokesperson said in a statement. "What makes someone a target for immigration enforcement is

whether or not they are illegally in the US — full stop. Speculation to the contrary is ill-informed."

Organized by the Annals of Improbable Research, a science humor magazine that spotlights offbeat research with the goal of making people laugh and then think, the Ig Nobels have a storied history in Massachusetts.

The inaugural ceremony was held at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology in front of a sold-out audience, said Abrahams, cofounder and editor of Annals of Improbable Research, who has emceed the event since its creation. Since then, the awards — a whimsical 90-minute show that involves actual Nobel laureates, a tradition of pelting winners with paper planes, and a mini comedic opera — have largely bounced between MIT and Harvard, and were most recently held at Boston University.

Each year, 10 prizes are awarded across different categories, including biology, physics, chemistry, medicine, and economics. Past winners earned recognition for docu-

NOBEL, Page B3

Yu's primary victory shook up state Senate leadership

By Kelly Garrity
GLOBE STAFF

For those following Tuesday's down-ballot races, Persis Yu's primary upset of state Senator Mike Rush came out of left field.

Her insurgent campaign flew largely under the radar outside of the district stretching from West Roxbury into Boston's southern suburbs, despite Mayor Michelle Wu coming to the moderate incumbent's defense in the very district in which she lives.

That was due, in part, to Wu's other electoral pursuits: The second-term mayor backed two first-time candidates who were trying to take down sitting senators, including one of Rush's fellow Senate leaders.

"People outside the district didn't know what was happening," said Rob Orthman, a Yu backer and co-director of Progressive West Roxbury/Roslindale. "And we were perfectly fine keeping it that way. We did not want to raise attention to this to suddenly start seeing, you know, all the money and support for the incumbent start to flow in."

Yu was one of a tiny percentage of candidates Tuesday to successfully take out an incumbent by running to their left.



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

'There was a dissatisfaction with the status quo.'

PERSIS YU (above)

With no Republican on the ballot in November, she effectively clinched the Norfolk and Suffolk seat with her primary victory, taking out not just an eight-term incumbent but also Senate President Karen Spilka's handpicked majority whip.

So who is this first-time candidate turned (likely) senator-elect — and how did she turn a quiet primary challenge into Tuesday's biggest down-ballot shocker?

Yu jumped into the race last year, motivated in part by President Trump's reelection in 2024. In the current political climate, "we need to have steadfast leaders who are protecting our rights, especially on abortion access, especially on LGBTQ+ issues, and especially on immigrant rights," she said.

But the campaign wasn't simply a referendum on social issues. Much of her pitch centered on affordability concerns, and, according to Yu, frustration with what voters saw as a Legislature that wasn't getting enough done. Lawmakers' resistance to a voter-approved law giving the state auditor the authority to probe the Legislature often came up organically on the trail, Yu said.

"There was a dissatisfaction with the status quo,"

YU, Page B4

Clancy case awaits DA's move after mistrial

Retrial, lesser charges, or plea deal among options

By John R. Ellement
GLOBE STAFF

Jurors in the Lindsay Clancy case were unable to reach a unanimous verdict after deliberating for 37 hours, leading Plymouth Superior Court Judge William F. Sullivan on Friday to declare a mistrial.

The declaration came after a last-minute effort by attorney Kevin Reddington to have a single justice of the state's highest court stay the ruling of a mistrial, so that Reddington could continue to argue that a juror who appears to be a holdout should be removed. The judge gave Reddington one hour to file the request, which was denied.

But that doesn't mean the case ends. Plymouth District Attorney Timothy Cruz must decide how to proceed, including whether to try Clancy again in a new trial. "He drives the bus," Reddington said recently. "The judge has no control over it. I have no control over it. It's entirely up to the DA."

Cruz on Friday said no decision has been made at this time.

Clancy, 36, has admitted to killing her three children, 5-year-old Cora, 3-year-old Dawson, and 8-month-old Callan, who she strangled with exercise bands in the basement of their Duxbury home on Jan. 24, 2023.

She has presented what is known as an insanity defense, claiming she is not criminally responsible, with her lawyer arguing that she was deep in the throes of postpartum depression and psychosis that made her unable to understand the criminality of her actions, or conform them to the law.

Cruz's office sought first-degree murder

CLANCY, Page B4

Judge rules State Police can't withhold camera locations

By Tonya Alanez
GLOBE STAFF

Locations of the state's automated license plate reader cameras must be shared with the public along with information about when Massachusetts State Police troopers search the system's database, a Suffolk Superior Court judge ruled Wednesday.

The decision comes amid a growing wave of controversy over law enforcement's use of electronic Flock Safety and other automated surveillance cameras. Several officers across the state are being investigated for alleged misuse of Flock Safety technology, and more than two dozen cities and towns have opted out of using the surveillance technology.

Tim McGuirk, a state public safety spokesperson, said Thursday Massachusetts State Police does not use the Flock Safety cameras.

Court filings state "MSP has acknowledged its use of the ALPR system provided by Vigilant Solutions."

The ACLU of Massachusetts filed the lawsuit,

CAMERAS, Page B4

INSIDE

South End incident

Boston City Councilor Ed Flynn is calling for a hate crime investigation after an elderly Chinese woman was shoved to the ground in the South End on Wednesday. **B2**

West Nile case

A man in his 70s is the sixth person to test positive for West Nile virus in Massachusetts this year. **B5**

WALK IN THE CLOUDS



JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

Two people enjoyed the weather with a stroll along Quincy Shore Drive.

Kratom advocates decry state ban on drug

Full prohibition went into effect late last month

By Chloe Craft
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

A full prohibition on a previously unregulated drug called kratom, including products sold at retail stores, will cause more harm to residents who use more natural forms of it for medicinal reasons, some advocates, users, and health care providers said.

Under the ban, which took effect on Aug. 28, kratom was placed in the drug class with the highest potential for abuse under Massachusetts law, on the same level as heroin and LSD — making it illegal to sell or possess any kratom products in the state.

Pills, gummies, drinks, and other forms of the drug marketed as kratom products previously had been widely available in gas stations, smoke shops, and convenience stores.

The ban on kratom, which is derived from a Southeast Asian plant, resulted from residents raising “serious concerns” about the sale of “dangerous” kratom products, according to the state Department of Health. Massachusetts joins at least 12 other states that heavily regulate or outright ban kratom.

Some kratom users, however, say the drug has helped alleviate chronic pain and severe anxiety, allowing them to better connect with the outside world again.

“A decision like this sounds very simple on paper. You just take it all away, no big deal,” said Lora Romney, a kratom advocate and president of the International Plant and Herbal Alliance. “But you’re not taking all of your people into consideration.”

At issue is a chemical known as 7-hydroxymitragynine, a



MARY ESCH/ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE 2017

People who use low-dose native leaf kratom to treat health conditions will face criminalization under the full ban.

component of kratom. The opioid-related ingredient has been increasingly added to consumer products, such as energy drinks.

The kratom plant has been historically consumed for pain relief because its active ingredients.

These high-dose extract products can cause significantly stronger and sometimes dangerous effects than products made from natural, native leaf kratom, according to published research. Researchers have found that native leaf kratom can occasionally have mild, but not severe, adverse effects.

In recent months, dietary supplement companies that sell kratom have been urging the Food and Drug Administration to crack down on the products containing 7-OH, portraying it as a dangerously concentrated, synthetic form of the original ingredient, the Associated Press reported.

The FDA action “is not focused on natural kratom leaf products,” according to a statement Tuesday by the US Department of Health and Human Ser-

vices.

Dr. Myles Jen Kin, a medical director at Recovery Centers of America in Massachusetts, said he has witnessed addiction to kratom-marketed products rapidly grow in detox centers like his.

“Three years ago, we might get a kratom case here and there, maybe a handful a year,” Jen Kin said. “But now, we probably get about a dozen, maybe 15 a week at all three sites of ours in Massachusetts.”

Jen Kin explained that at high doses, dependence on high-concentration kratom products requires the same treatment as dependence on opiates like heroin or fentanyl. He worries that, under the new restrictions, many who have formed a physical dependence on high-concentration kratom products will instead turn to illicit drugs like fentanyl or heroin to prevent withdrawal symptoms.

“If we have a massive increase [of patients], which is likely, facilities might be full and we may not be able to accommo-

date all of them,” Jen Kin said.

Jen Kin added that he has rarely, if ever, seen issues with users of low-dose native leaf kratom products, which is available primarily online as opposed to in convenience stores.

Romney, the low-dose kratom advocate, said people like herself who use native leaf kratom to treat health conditions will face unfair criminalization under the full ban.

For more than 13 years, Romney has suffered from a chronic condition that causes constant and severe facial nerve pain. After unsuccessfully trying pharmaceutical drugs, Botox, and a neurosurgical procedure for the pain, she said that native leaf kratom — which she takes as a powder dissolved in liquid — was the only thing that helped.

“After two or three days of use, I was like, ‘This is a miracle.’ ... I can work, I can function,” Romney said. “I mean, I’m going camping today, which I could have never done nine years ago.”

A DPH spokesperson said the ban protects residents, especially young people, “while making sure anyone experiencing dependence or withdrawal can get the care and support they need.”

The DPH spokesperson did not address a Globe question about the concerns of low-dose native leaf consumers who self-treat with kratom. Acknowledging concerns of a mass withdrawal crisis, the spokesperson said the department “is working directly with treatment providers to prepare for potential withdrawal-related needs.”

On Aug. 21, four Massachusetts retailers that sell kratom products filed a lawsuit to block the state ban. The matter is pending, court records show.

Chloe Craft can be reached at chloe.craft@globe.com.

Councilor seeks hate crime probe after attack on Chinese woman

By Nick Stoico
GLOBE STAFF

Boston City Councilor Ed Flynn is calling for a hate crime investigation after an elderly Chinese woman was shoved to the ground in the South End on Wednesday, officials said.

The woman, who is in her 80s, was crossing West Canton Street near Tremont Street shortly before 9 a.m. when another woman allegedly shoved her to the ground, according to a police report.

Security video showed the woman walk in front of the victim, stop, and “with what appears to be no reason at all,” shove her to the pavement before walking away, police said.

Passersby helped the woman back to her feet, police wrote.

The woman said she had knee pain and a cut on her thumb. She was taken to Tufts Medical Center for evaluation, police said.

Police later found a woman matching a description of the suspect and identified her as Kaitlyn Ann Quick, a 38-year-old who is homeless. She was arrested on two outstanding warrants and charged with assault and battery on a person over 60 or disabled with injury, according to the report.

Quick was arraigned Thursday in Boston Municipal Court and pleaded not guilty, court records show. She was ordered held on \$1,500 bail and is scheduled to return to court on Sept. 29.

In the report, police marked the incident as not a suspected hate crime. But Flynn said Thursday he wants the police department’s civil rights unit to investigate whether racial bias motivated the attack.

“We have a woman of color

and an immigrant woman,” Flynn said. “We have seen a lot of anti-Asian racism and hate crimes against the Asian community. I do believe we have to talk about it and investigate to determine if there was a hate crime.”

Flynn sent a letter Thursday to Mayor Michelle Wu and Police Commissioner Michael Cox requesting that police and the Boston Human Rights Commission investigate the assault as a possible hate crime and civil rights violation.

Melissa Lo, a member of Flynn’s staff, helped interpret for the woman, who speaks Toisanese, as she provided her account to police Wednesday.

Lo said the woman told her she was heading to redeem cans at Shaw’s when she was suddenly shoved while crossing the street. The woman hurt both her knees, she said, and needed help from two younger women to get up.

“She felt like, why, of anyone who was crossing the road, why did they push me?” Lo said the woman told her.

Flynn said anti-Asian violence is more common than many acknowledge and that some incidents go unreported.

“I think it’s important to acknowledge we have a problem in our city,” Flynn said. “Violence against any ethnic group should be taken seriously.”

Flynn said Thursday he had not yet received a response to his request from City Hall or police.

Police provided a copy of the incident report but did not comment on Flynn’s letter.

Travis Andersen of the Globe staff contributed to this report. Nick Stoico can be reached at nick.stoico@globe.com.

Antisemitic graffiti found in Newton, person charged

By Madyline Swearing
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

A person has been charged with defacement of property after two swastikas and a Nazi phrase were painted on playground equipment at an apartment complex in Newton, police said.

The person was identified and charged Thursday night, Lieutenant Hagai Brandon said in a statement.

Their name was not immediately released.

The graffiti was found at The Aven apartment complex in Newton Highlands at approximately 8 p.m. on Wednesday,

Brandon said in a statement.

Police said the graffiti appears to be an isolated incident and there is no threat to the public.

“We take these incidents of hate extremely seriously and we will continue to educate the public on both the effects these acts have on our citizens and that these acts of hate will not be tolerated in our community,” Brandon said.

The investigation is ongoing.

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	City	Retail	Other
7-day home delivery	\$70.00	70.00	70.00
Sunday-only home delivery	\$22.50	22.50	22.50
Daily single copy	\$4.00	4.00	4.00
Sunday single copy	\$6.00	6.00	6.00

Lottery

FRIDAY MIDDAY		0034	MILLIONAIRE FOR LIFE	
Payoffs (<i>based on a \$1 bet</i>)			Sept. 3	1-10-23-29-33
<u>EXACT ORDER</u>			Millionaire Ball 3	
All 4 digits	\$6,456		<i>Jackpot: \$1 million per year;</i>	
First or last 3	\$904		<i>no winners</i>	
Any 2 digits	\$77		MASS CASH	
Any 1 digit	\$8		Sept. 4	1-9-25-27-33
<u>ANY ORDER</u>			<i>Jackpot: \$100,000; no winners</i>	
All 4 digits	\$538		MEGA MILLIONS	
First 3	\$301		Sept. 4	6-26-34-59-61
Last 3	\$151		Megaball 24	
FRIDAY NIGHT	7110		<i>Jackpot: \$177,000,000</i>	
Payoffs (<i>based on a \$1 bet</i>)			PREVIOUS DRAWINGS	
<u>EXACT ORDER</u>			Midday	Night
All 4 digits	\$4,459	Thursday	1822	2966
First or last 3	\$624	Wednesday	7701	0554
Any 2 digits	\$54	Tuesday	6069	5205
Any 1 digit	\$5	Monday	4970	2645
<u>ANY ORDER</u>		Sunday	7657	5863
All 4 digits	\$372	FRIDAY NUMBERS		
First 3	\$208	AROUND NEW ENGLAND		
Last 3	\$208	Maine, N.H., Vermont		
		Day: 3-digit 779	4-digit 8091	
		Eve: 3-digit 787	4-digit 9005	
		Rhode Island	4997	

This day in history

Today is Friday, Sept. 5, the 248th day of 2026. There are 117 days left in the year.

Birthdays: Actor Lucille Soong (TV: “Fresh Off the Boat”) is 91. Actor William Devane is 87. Actor George Lazenby is 87. Film director Werner Herzog is 84. Singer Al Stewart is 81. “Cathy” cartoonist Cathy Guisewite is 76. Actor Michael Keaton is 75. Actor Rose McGowan is 53. Olympic gold medal gymnast Tatiana Gutsu is 50. Actor Carice Van Houten is 50. Mixed martial artist Francis Ngannou is 40. Olympic gold medal figure skater Yuna Kim is 36.

►In 1774, the first Continental Congress assembled in Philadelphia.

►In 1836, Sam Houston won the

first presidential election in the newly established Republic of Texas.

►In 1905, the Treaty of Portsmouth was signed, ending the Russo-Japanese war; for his efforts in mediating the peace negotiations, US President Theodore Roosevelt was awarded the Nobel Peace Prize the following year.

►In 1957, Jack Kerouac’s novel “On the Road” was published.

►In 1960, Muhammad Ali (as Cassius Clay) won the gold medal in the light heavyweight boxing division at the Olympic Games in Rome.

►In 1972, Palestinian militants attacked the Israeli Olympic delegation at the Munich Games, killing two and taking nine oth-

ers hostage; five of the militants, all nine hostages, and a German police officer were killed in the following 24 hours.

►In 1975, President Ford survived an assassination attempt by Lynette “Squeaky” Fromme, a disciple of Charles Manson, in Sacramento. (Fromme was released from prison on parole in 2009.)

►In 1977, NASA launched Voyager 1 to study Jupiter, several of its moons, and later Saturn; in 2012, the spacecraft became the first human-made object to leave the solar system.

►In 1986, four hijackers who had seized a Pan Am jumbo jet on the ground in Karachi, Pakistan, opened fire on the jet’s passengers; a total of 20 passengers

and crew members were killed before Pakistani commandos stormed the jetliner.

►In 1991, the 35th annual Naval Aviation Symposium held by the Tailhook Association opened in Las Vegas; during the four-day gathering, there were reports that as many as 90 people, most of them women, were sexually assaulted or otherwise harassed. (The episode triggered the resignation of Navy secretary Henry L. Garrett III.)

►In 2025, President Trump signed an executive order aimed at rebranding the Department of Defense as the Department of War. The move required formal approval by Congress, which showed no immediate interest in taking up the matter.

Safety concerns send the IG Nobel awards to Zurich

►NOBEL
Continued from Page B1

menting the “first case of homo-sexual necrophilia” in mallard ducks, explaining why banana peels are slippery, and exploring the mystery of how wombats produce cube-shaped poop.

At this year’s ceremony, held Thursday, prizes were given for a splash-free urinal (physics), research into kissing (biomechanics), and a study of milk from cockroaches (chemistry), among others.

The “magic” of the ceremony is having winners, who pay their own travel expenses, be physically present to receive their prize, Abrahams said. Typically, winners, who are secretly informed ahead of the ceremony and asked if they would like to accept the award, are not revealed to the public until they step out from behind a curtain during the event. A Nobel laureate then presents them with their Ig Nobel.

“It should be this utterly joyful, crazy moment and you need to have the winners there to have it happen,” he said.

Kees Moeliker remembers the excitement of receiving his Ig Nobel in 2003.

“I’d never won a prize,” said Moeliker, an ornithologist from the Netherlands who won for his research detailing a rare act of necrophilia, or sexual attraction to a dead body, between two male mallard ducks that he observed outside his office window at the Natural History Museum in Rotterdam.

The ceremony that year was held at Harvard, which Moeliker described as “the holy grail for academic freedom and spirit.”

He had read a bit about the awards beforehand, but didn’t fully know what to expect.

“It was like a mixture of Monty Python’s Flying Circus and the Muppet Show,” he said. “Then at the moment that you get the prize, a real Nobel laureate shakes your hand and gives you the prize.”

Moeliker said MIT physicist Wolfgang Ketterle, who won the



Miki Takahara spoke to the audience during the 2026 Ig Nobel Prize ceremony in Zurich.

Nobel Prize in physics in 2001, presented him with his award.

“It was a really nice experience,” said Moeliker, who is now the European bureau chief of the Annals of Improbable Research. “It’s free spirit. It’s filled with humor.”

Discussions about moving the awards out of the United States started months after last year’s ceremony when several winners from other countries did not attend, Abrahams said.

One group of researchers based in Europe and Africa, who accepted their award, told organizers early on that they would not come to the United States because of what they were see-

ing in the news about the Trump administration’s travel bans and immigration enforcement. Three other winners made travel plans, but pulled out last-minute, also citing concerns about their safety, Abrahams said.

Instead of being there in person, these winners sent the text of their acceptance speeches, which were read by Nobel laureates while a photo of the awardee was projected on a screen behind them.

The event’s organizers realized, Abrahams said, “If we try to do this here again, most of the winners are not going to be here and that’s going to change things so drastically in a bad way.”

“We can’t let that happen,” he said.

Over the years, Abrahams said he’s gotten offers from other places to host the awards, so he reached out. People in Switzerland swiftly stepped up, he said. This year’s ceremony was produced in collaboration with institutions of the ETH Domain, a network of Swiss federal universities and research institutes, and the University of Zurich.

Moving forward, the plan is for the awards to become a global event that will return to Zurich every other year, organizers said.

“It’s a big change,” said Dr. Thomas Michel, a cardiologist

and professor of medicine at Harvard Medical School, who has been involved with organizing the Ig Nobels. “It’s an acknowledgment that these are very difficult times for scientists in this country.”

While there will be a smaller event in Cambridge several weeks after the Zurich ceremony to celebrate this year’s prizes, Abrahams said it will likely be some time before the awards come back to the United States.

“Everything right now is falling apart,” he said. “Even the greatest hopes for all the crazy stuff stopping, repairing the damage is going to take awhile.” Still, Abrahams said he re-

mains optimistic, likening the situation to how nature can recover after a major natural disaster.

“It looks, for a time, like all life for hundreds of miles is wiped out,” he said. “Then, in a surprisingly short time, you start to see green things growing. Then, a year later, you come back, and there are all kinds of green things growing, and there are birds, and there are animals, and people. And you come back in 10 years, and everything is thriving.”

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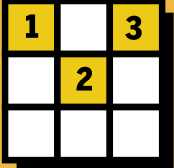


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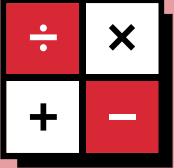
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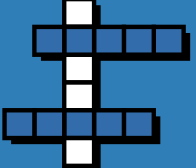




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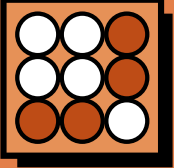
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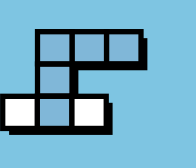
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Activists seek to suspend law easing abortion rules

► **ABORTION LAW**
Continued from Page B1

louni, the group's interim executive director, said the new law removed "an arbitrary barrier to care."

Miele's group, however, has called the law "radical." His group on Tuesday filed paperwork with Secretary of State William F. Galvin's office launching a referendum effort to put a repeal of the law on the 2028 ballot.

The law's opponents face a tight timeline. They must collect more than 37,000 signatures to put the question on the ballot in two years, and another 12,430 to force an immediate suspension of the law before it takes effect, according to Galvin's office.

The signatures are due Nov. 6, said Deb O'Malley, a Galvin spokesperson.

"We're simply trying to make the law go back to what it was," Miele said. "I truly believe that if given the opportunity, this state would vote to repeal this law."

In a statement Thursday, Marina Chafa, a spokesperson for Reproductive Equity Now, said the organization has long expected to "face extremist efforts to intervene in private medical decisions and reverse our progress."

"But reproductive freedom is a Massachusetts value, and our residents believe that there is no room for government interference in medical decisions," Chafa said.

The state Legislature in 2020 initially provided more access to abortions — over the veto of then-governor Charlie Baker, a Republican — after 24 weeks of pregnancy, and lowered the age at which someone could seek the procedure.

Beacon Hill Democrats then approved a measure last year that helped those seeking abortions and medical providers to protect their identities.

Abortion politics have also come into sharper focus in recent months amid the gover-

nor's race.

Michael Minogue, the Republican nominee, has said he is a "pro-life" Catholic who would "uphold" current laws. He also said he was "disappointed the governor is playing extreme politics with women's health" when Healey signed the expanded abortion law last month.

Healey, too, has woven into her reelection pitch the importance of protecting reproductive health care laws in the face of what she has said are attacks from national Republicans and President Trump.

In a statement to the Globe on Thursday, Healey said the law is for families "facing some of the most painful and devastating circumstances imaginable."

"It's about parents who were preparing to welcome a baby into their lives and then received a heartbreaking diagnosis late in pregnancy," Healey said. "These situations are incredibly rare, and the decisions should be

made between patients, their families, and their doctor — not by politicians and the government."

The effort to repeal the law faces other hurdles.

Before Miele's group can even collect signatures, Attorney General Andrea Campbell's office must first make a legal determination as to whether the abortion law is subject to the referendum process. If it is, it then must draft a "fair and concise" summary of the law, according to a Campbell spokesperson.

Campbell's office has also reached out to "interested parties" to solicit their input on whether the law is subject to a referendum and, if so, what a summary should look like, the spokesperson said.

Healey could use her executive authority to declare the abortion law an "emergency" measure, immediately putting it into effect and blocking any push to suspend it until 2028.

A spokesperson for Healey

did not address a question about whether Healey was considering that move.

There's precedent for such action. Second Amendment rights groups collected enough signatures in 2024 to immediately suspend and place on this year's ballot a referendum repealing some of the state's major gun ownership prohibitions.

But days before gun rights groups were due to turn in signatures to Galvin's office in 2024, Healey declared the law an "emergency," a move that drew intense backlash from those behind the repeal effort.

Miele said he "wouldn't be shocked" if Healey takes similar action with the abortion law, though he said emergency action would "not deter us in any way from going forward."

"I dare her to do it," he said.

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DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

A Flock camera on Winthrop Shore Drive in Winthrop.

Locations of state's cameras to go public

► **CAMERAS**
Continued from Page B1

putting up a five-year fight to obtain information about the locations of the cameras used to surveil drivers on roads across the state, the civil rights organization said in a statement.

The ACLU also sought and won access to when, why, and how often state troopers search the automatic license plate reader system's database, according to the statement.

"Over the past year, public outrage about secretive police surveillance has exploded across Massachusetts and the nation," Kade Crockford, director of technology and justice programs at the ACLU of Massachusetts, said in the statement.

"People from cities and towns across the state have been organizing to push back against local police adoption of Flock and other license plate readers," Crockford said. "But what many residents don't know is that the Massachusetts State Police maintains its own statewide network of license plate readers."

Sarah Burgess, a spokesperson for the State Police, said Wednesday night they were looking at the ruling and would have a comment Thursday.

She did not immediately respond to follow-up inquiries from the Globe on Thursday.

The agency had refused to disclose the records, invoking exemptions to public records law pertaining to critical infrastructure and ongoing criminal investigations.

According to court filings, automated license plate reader technology has been used in Massachusetts since 2008. Documents said State Police maintain 80 to 100 of the surveillance cameras across the state, which record license plate numbers, date, time, specific location at the time of the recording, as well as vehicle make, model, color, and distinguishing features such as bumper stickers.

State police argued that publicly disclosing exact locations of the cameras and other information was "detrimental to public safety" and "would prejudice the possibility of effective law enforcement," court documents said.

State Police said that if criminals or terrorists knew the precise locations of the cameras, it might assist them in attempts to cause harm, or prompt them to "alter their travel routes to avoid detection," according to court filings.

The ACLU applauded the court's ruling.

"For the past five years, the ACLU of Massachusetts has been trying to pierce the veil of secrecy surrounding these State Police surveillance operations," Crockford said. "Today, a court ruled that the public has a right to know basic details about where and how police are tracking motorists around the state."

"The first step towards accountability and oversight is transparency, so this ruling marks a critical moment in the fight for democratic control of police surveillance," Crockford said.

Officers in Revere, Lynn, New Bedford, and Stow are among those who have gotten into trouble for allegedly accessing databases to look up personal information about victims and ex-girlfriends. The technology is supposed to be used only for legitimate law enforcement purposes.

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JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Plymouth County DA Tim Cruz faced the media Friday after the Lindsay Clancy murder trial for killing her three children was called a mistrial by the judge.

After mistrial, DA to decide course of Clancy case

► **CLANCY**
Continued from Page B1

charges for the three deaths, which carry a sentence of life without the possibility of parole for each conviction. Under state law, only a jury can decide first-degree murder charges.

Now that judge has declared a mistrial, here's what happens next:

Cruz can choose to retry a first-degree murder case again, which would mean empaneling a new jury and marshaling the resources that went into the first trial.

Cruz, however, could also pursue lesser charges of second-degree murder that would allow for a bench trial, or a trial in which there is no jury and the judge decides the verdict. Such a trial would come with far fewer theatrics and resources than another jury trial. A defendant can waive their right to a jury trial, and would instead have a bench trial, in which a judge would decide the case.

A second-degree murder conviction also carries a life sentence but allows for the possibility of parole. Sullivan, who would decide on the punishment, could sentence Clancy to a minimum sentence ranging from 15 years to 25 years in prison for each conviction before she is eligible for parole.

Cruz could also seek manslaughter charges, which carry a sentence of up to 20 years in prison. There is no minimum sentence for a manslaughter conviction.

In another scenario, Reddington could seek to negotiate a compromise plea with Cruz, but the decision to agree to such a deal ultimately falls to the prosecutor.

If Cruz chooses to re-try the case, it could be months before a second trial is held, and the outcome is equally uncertain.

Clancy has been under 24-hour supervision at Tewksbury Hospital since the murders. She could be transferred to the Suf-

folk County Jail if doctors clear her medically, officials said. Female pre-trial detainees from Plymouth County are housed in Boston awaiting trial, officials said.

However, Sullivan would hold a hearing where Reddington and prosecutors could both argue over where they believe Clancy should be held awaiting the new trial.

Clancy has used a wheelchair since becoming paralyzed after attempting to take her own life after she killed her children.

The extent of the divide among jurors, and which charges they were considering, is not known. Jury deliberations are secret. But by state law, jury verdicts are required to be unanimous.

In the recent high-profile Karen Read case, jurors in her first trial in April 2024 reported that they were deadlocked, leading to a mistrial, after some 27 hours of deliberations. Her second trial was held 14 months lat-

er, and she was acquitted of charges that she murdered her boyfriend, Boston police officer John O'Keefe.

In another example, jurors in July 2023 reported that they were deadlocked in the trial of Emanuel Lopes, who faced charges of murdering Sergeant Michael Chesna and Vera Adams, of Weymouth, on the morning of July 15, 2018.

Then, in his second trial in February 2024, jurors twice told the judge in that case that they were deadlocked, leading to the judge to twice give what is known as a "dynamite charge," an instruction encouraging them to keep trying. They ultimately reached a unanimous verdict of guilty. Lopes was sentenced in August 2024 to life in prison.

In New York, another case similar to the prosecution of Clancy played out differently last month. Dimone Fleming, 22, faced first-degree murder charges for the 2022 deaths of her two

sons, by repeatedly stabbing Octavius Canada, 11 months, and Daishawn Fleming, 3, and then submerging them in a bathtub full of water.

But both prosecutors and Fleming's lawyer agreed she was in a state of psychosis at the time of the killings, and reached a plea deal that allowed the judge to decide her fate: He declared her not responsible by mental disease or defect, under New York state law. Fleming will avoid prison but will remain hospitalized for an indeterminate amount of time.

Tiffany Wichman, a Bronx assistant district attorney, told reporters that the plea deal was in the interest of justice.

"Prosecuting mothers does not and cannot prevent these crimes from happening, but public discourse might," Wichman said.

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Yu's primary victory shook up state Senate leadership

► **YU**
Continued from Page B1

the Hyde Park Democrat said. "And people want to know what is actually happening in the Legislature."

Yu, a Boston Public Schools parent and mother of two, had been active on Boston's Ward 18 Democratic Committee, but first popped up on Orthman's radar last spring, he said, as she met with progressive groups around the district to test the waters on a potential state Senate bid.

A consumer protection attorney, "she always likes to say [that] she's sued the last few presidential administrations on behalf of student loan borrowers, both Democratic and Republican," Orthman said.

Her campaign was up

against some early headwinds. While Rush started off with a cash advantage, Yu outraised him during the campaign, pulling in a little over \$156,000 since the start of last September, compared to Rush's roughly \$148,000.

Rush, an Iraq War veteran who first won his seat in 2010, also had some serious institutional support from both Wu and Governor Maura Healey.

The mayor's support for the more moderate Rush normally would've been somewhat surprising. But Rush helped shepherd Wu's closely watched property tax shift legislation on Beacon Hill, pushing an amendment that the Senate ultimately rejected in January.

That denial prompted Wu to

put her political power on the line by backing challengers to Senators Nick Collins and William Brownsberger, and turning those races into something of a proxy war. But her presence was less notable in Rush's region — and ultimately, didn't seem to sway voters in her city.

Yu outperformed Rush in Boston, according to unofficial results, earning 57 percent of the vote in the city while Rush carried parts of the district beyond.

"The kind of voter who is highly engaged and supports Michelle is unlikely to be swayed to vote for Rush by her endorsement," said Matt McCloskey, a Yu volunteer focused on elections data. The district itself changed as well when state law-

makers crafted new maps in 2021, McCloskey said.

"It's definitely an easier district for a progressive to win now than it would have been in 2020," he said.

Then there was another notable moment days ahead of the election: when Rush skipped a debate set up by the Dedham and Westwood Democratic town committees, apparently to present a check for state funding in another town in the district.

The move handed Yu and her supporters a ready-made cudgel to hammer Rush heading into the home stretch of the campaign.

Rush has not commented publicly since the loss, and efforts to reach him Thursday

were not successful.

Yu, however, said she spoke to Wu briefly Wednesday, and the mayor "was very gracious."

"It's a good place-starting conversation, and I definitely look forward to having further ones in the future," Yu said.

Wu, in a statement, said she offered Yu her "full partnership and support," and that she looked forward to "working with her as my new state senator to deliver on a shared agenda for the district and the city."

Notably, Yu isn't pitching herself as some type of Wu agitator. Case in point: She said that she, too, is supportive of the mayor's tax shift proposal.

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Man in his 70s is 6th human case of West Nile virus in Mass. this year

By Madyline Swearing
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

A man in his 70s is the sixth person to test positive for West Nile virus in Massachusetts this year, state public health officials said Friday.

The man was likely exposed in a part of Suffolk County outside of Boston, the state Department of Public Health said in a statement.

As a result, officials have raised the risk level for contracting the mosquito-borne virus to high in Chelsea, Malden, Revere, and Winthrop, the statement said.

The case is the third in Suffolk County this year. A man in his 50s and a man in his 70s were also exposed. The other three human cases were reported in Middlesex County — a man

in his 60s, a man in his 80s, and a man in his 90s, according to the state.

No further information was released about when or where the men were exposed to the virus.

“As we go into the holiday weekend, it is easy to think of backyards, barbecues, and fun. I also want people to think about mosquitoes,” Dr. Robbie Goldstein, the state’s public health commissioner, said in a statement.

“This is the time of year when people get exposed to the West Nile virus and Eastern Equine Encephalitis,” Goldstein said.

According to the DPH, 273 WNV-positive mosquito samples have been detected in every county in Massachusetts except

Nantucket. The state’s first positive samples this season were confirmed in June.

Eastern equine encephalitis has been detected in 13 mosquito samples this year, but no animal or human cases have been reported, public health officials said.

People are advised to avoid outdoor activities during peak mosquito hours, which are dusk to dawn, and to wear long sleeve shirts and pants, the statement said.

People should also drain standing water from gutters, birdbaths, and kiddie pools, to prevent mosquito breeding, officials said.

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Quincy to celebrate Labor Day, country’s 250th anniversary, with fireworks display

By Breanne Kovatch
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

The City of Presidents is preparing to celebrate Labor Day weekend and the nation’s 250th birthday with a fireworks display Sunday night over Quincy Bay.

City officials said the fireworks display will honor “the generations of working men and women who helped build America over the past 250 years,” according to a statement released this week.

Quincy is known as the City of Presidents because it is the birthplace of John Adams, the nation’s second president, and his son, John Quincy Adams,

the nation’s sixth president.

John Hancock, a Patriot leader of the American Revolution best known for his signature on the Declaration of Independence, was born in an area of Braintree that is now part of Quincy.

“We all know our history in Quincy is a vital part of the American story, and it goes beyond those Revolutionary giants Adams and Hancock,” Quincy Mayor Thomas P. Koch said in the statement. “From our granite industry to the shipyard workers spanning generations, to the thousands of our neighbors in the trades who still call Quincy home — this coun-

try was built by working men and women, and its future depends on them.”

The fireworks will shoot off from a barge in the middle of Quincy Bay shortly after 8 p.m., the city said in the statement.

The display is co-sponsored by The Quincy Foundation, the chief executive of the Lee Kennedy Company Lee Kennedy, and the chief executive and chair of Suffolk Construction John Fish, according to the statement.

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PHOTOS BY GABRIELA HERMAN/NEW YORK TIMES

Diane Clarke Streett has been moved by the assistance she receives from other Polar Bears getting into and out of the water when they gather at Inkwell Beach, near downtown Oak Bluffs on Martha’s Vineyard. Right: Polar Bears in the water. Below: Caroline Hunter (center) has been leading the group for the past 38 years.

By Sandra E. Garcia
NEW YORK TIMES

OAK BLUFFS — “Get in up to your shoulders!” Caroline Hunter shouted to the reluctant bathers inching into Nantucket Sound, off Massachusetts. “Trust me: Up to your shoulders, you *will* warm up!”

At 7:30 a.m., the sun was too low in the sky to offer any real warmth. But once in the water, the crowd of nearly 400 did their best to get their blood pumping as directed by Hunter, an 80-year-old former chemist and high school teacher whose raspy voice has been leading the group for the past 38 years.

Every morning from the Fourth of July through Labor Day, a loose coalition of Black bathers who call themselves the Polar Bears meet at Inkwell Beach, a short stroll from downtown Oak Bluffs on Martha’s Vineyard, and wade into the ocean to start the day. Of the many rites and rituals observed by those summering on the island, few have such a bracing Arctic bite.

This summer is the 80th anniversary of the group’s founding, by a wellness-minded innkeeper who “believed that an early morning swim was not only invigorating, but healthy,” an early Polar Bear recalled to The Vineyard Gazette in 2007. The gatherings have grown considerably since then; one dip last month drew 519 people.

Participants are instructed to arrive at 7:30 a.m., though latecomers are only lightly admonished. There is one requirement to become a part of the group: that you participate for the entire two hours it takes to do aerobics, honor ancestors, count off in the water, and perform a secret ritual.

Membership confers a card granting access to the Facebook group as well as bragging rights. Every wader becomes part of a historic congregation that has plodded its way to the same part of the beach since the days when the island was segregated, and Black swimmers were not allowed in parts of the 5-mile beach, according to Hunter.

“This is the only space we could get,” she said. “We are keeping it.”

According to the Gazette, the tradition was started in 1946 by Black seasonal workers who were staying nearby. They wanted a place to exercise, swim, and build community during a

The Black Polar Bears of Martha’s Vineyard mark 80th anniversary



time when segregation limited where Black Americans could comfortably gather, especially in bodies of water. Every summer, those members met in the morning for swimming, water exercises, conversation, and plain old fun before heading to work.

That Tuesday morning in August, Hunter parked her car alongside the boardwalk by 7 a.m. Her trunk was filled with sandy water

shoes she lends out to the underprepared. The swimmers meet rain or shine, but they draw the line at thunder or lightning, she said.

“It is a wonderful way to start the day,” Hunter said of the group water aerobics. “It’s the community, it’s a fellowship. I tell people I hate getting up early and I hate cold water, but I come for what else happens here.”

“You can’t chitchat in the water, though,” she

added. “You got to listen to the instructions.”

Those instructions are fairly simple: Kick up. Make circles with your shoulders. Twist at your waist.

“This preserves life,” said Tracé Gaskin, 66, who has been a Polar Bear since the 1970s. “My mother is 90 years old. She’s the oldest active Polar Bear right now. Getting in the ocean every day is healing. Every day that you go into the water, you are healed.”

For every Inkwell Beach veteran like Gaskin there was a newcomer to the water. Melissa Hinckson, 63, a fifth grade teacher from New York City’s Brooklyn borough, said she was thrilled to become a first-time Polar Bear.

“It’s exciting!” she said, before joining everyone in the water. At the session, she became overwhelmed with emotion and started to cry.

“There is something about being with my people in the water,” Hinckson said as she tow-eled off. “This is part of my ritual now.”

Diane Clarke Streett, 76, gets in the water as much as she can during the summer, even if she needs to use her walker or enlist the help of her fellow Polar Bears. Slowly, while holding on to two friends, she trudged through the sand and into the ocean. Streett, a retired Delaware state judge, has spent 20 summers in Oak Bluffs — the traditional center of Black life on the island — and as a Polar Bear.

“It’s fun,” she said. “You get a thousand kisses here. But the way that people help other people, and the way the people have helped me get to the water’s edge and get in the water and come out of the water, just the support of people. ...” She trailed off. “It carries you through the day, and it carries you though the year. A lot of people are here for a week or two on their vacation and they have to go back to work. They can be sustained by the thoughts and the memories of the Inkwell and the experience of the Polar Bears until they come back the next summer.”

There is something about returning. Several compared the morning gatherings to a family reunion.

“You see some of the same people year after year after year,” Streett said. “You see them grow and develop and age, including myself, and then you see the children and the grandchildren, and so it’s generations. It’s almost like a family.”

It’s official, one of the best female ‘ninjas’ on the planet lives in Massachusetts

By Lauren Daley
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

At the start of this season of NBC’s “American Ninja Warrior,” Boston.com predicted a big season for Pembroke’s Addy Herman.

She proved us right.

Herman, 21, placed third for women this season, finishing behind powerhouse Isabella Folsom, 22, and teen machine Taylor Greene, who repeated as women’s champ.

But “ANW” was not Herman’s only ninja competition this year. Not by a long shot.

Herman, who trains in Fall River, has competed in some 20 ninja competitions in 2026, placing in the top three in Japan, France, and Barbados. She says her goal is to “keep advancing the sport.” And she’s doing it not just through her performances, but by training the next generation of little Massachusetts ninjas at her gym.

We caught up with Herman to talk all things ninja — including her new ninja sneaker — and how deep the women’s field has grown.

The woman leading the New England pack

We caught up with Herman during a break, as she set obstacles for a ninja competition at Fall River’s Vitality Obstacle Fitness, where she trains under the guidance of Jordan Thurston.

Of season 18, Herman said, “Overall, I’m really happy with my season. I do think it was the best overall season I’ve had — excluding the women’s championship.”

The ’24 women’s champ was going for gold.

Placing third “was a little disappointing. I got to the last obstacle faster, but rushed into it without taking any rest. I think if I had taken a little more rest, a little time to shake out, I think I could’ve gotten it. But honestly, getting third is motivation for next season. I want to train harder and come in even stronger.”

Herman marked a personal record in season buzzers — meaning a course completed without falling — with three.

At one point in the season, Herman raced — and beat — her former coach, Lucas Reale, of Bridgewater. NBC made a feature segment of it, showing footage of 10-year-old Herman at the Weymouth gym, training under Reale.

“The first gym I ever went to was TA Fitness in Weymouth,” Herman said. “Lucas had just started coaching there. He coached me for my first five or six years. Even though I switched gyms, he’ll still coach me at competitions when Jordan’s not there. Lucas has always been there for me, and has really gotten me to the point that I am today.”

In June, Herman was in Japan to compete for Team USA on “Sasuke” — the original Japanese ninja TV show that birthed “American Ninja Warrior.” She said four American “Ninja Warrior” alumni/athletes were selected to compete for Team USA: Herman, Josh Levin, Daniel Gil, and Vance Walker. And if you watch the show, you know that’s like the ‘92 Dream Team.

They won. (It only aired in Japan.) “That was the coolest thing I’ve ever gotten to be a part of,” Herman said. “‘Sasuke’ paved the way for the entire sport — and [the] life I live now.”

“It was super crazy because I flew to

Japan, competed, flew home to Massachusetts for one day, and then flew out to compete in the World Ninja League Championships in North Carolina. I was definitely nervous about the jet lag.”

Still, she placed third.

Pushing it forward

The women’s field has grown wildly in depth and strength since the early days.

“There are 13- to 15-year-old girls who are just *pushing* it — *leagues* above where I was at that age,” Herman said. “To see them coming up and training *that* hard and growing the sport in general in the direction that all of us wanted to go in — it’s awesome to be a part of that. The women’s field in ninja is just getting better and better.”

Herman is furthering the sport gear-wise. For years, we watched competitors slip and slide in Chuck Taylors or Vans, but now her ninja shoe from Ollo will go into production this fall, she said. Also, she’s creating obstacles for future warriors, working with Connecticut-based DGS, a major obstacle manufacturing company. (Many obstacles seen on the NBC show were designed by competitors.)

Recalling her childhood days at a Weymouth gym, it’s been a wild ride.

“It’s cool that ninja went from my hobby to my sport to my full-time career.”

Lauren Daley is a freelance culture writer. She can be reached at ldaley33@gmail.com. She tweets @laurendaley1, and Instagrams at @laurendaley1.



SCOTT EVERETT WHITE/NBC

Addy Herman of Pembroke is pictured competing on “American Ninja Warrior.” Herman, who placed third for women this season, says her goal is to “keep advancing the sport.”

TV HIGHLIGHTS

Tennis: US Open, 11 a.m., ESPN2; 7 p.m., ESPN2
College football: BC-Cincinnati, 3:30 p.m., Fox
Baseball: Red Sox-Orioles, 7:05 p.m., NESN
Baseball: Yankees-Padres, 7:15 p.m., Fox
MLS: Revolution-Galaxy, 9:30 p.m., Apple TV
Listings, C7

Sports

C

THE BOSTON GLOBE SATURDAY, SEPTEMBER 5, 2026 | BOSTONGLOBE.COM/SPORTS

Thirteen ideas for WNBA’s next boss

Engelbert’s retirement offers myriad options

By Emma Healy and Katie McInerney

GLOBE STAFF

Cathy Engelbert will leave her position as commissioner of the WNBA in December.

Engelbert was the league’s first commissioner — previously, its top leader had served as president. She assumed the job in 2019 and oversaw the most transformational growth the women’s sports league has undergone since it was founded 30 years ago.

The WNBA has benefited from unprecedented viewership and soaring team valuations in seven years under Engelbert’s leadership. The league will expand to 18 teams by 2030 after nearly two decades as a 12-

team league, and the WNBA’s media-rights deals are worth \$3.1 billion. The average value of a WNBA franchise in 2026 is \$460 million, up from \$10 million in 2019.

Engelbert and the players’ association came to the most lucrative collective bargaining agreement in league history this offseason, resulting in the WNBA’s first million-dollar player salaries.

But the commissioner’s term has not been without criticism. Lynx star Napheesa Collier said during an explosive exit interview last season that Engelbert was a “negligent” commissioner and the WNBA had the “worst leadership in the world.”

The commissioner has drawn ire for failing to resolve some of the WNBA’s ongoing crises, including persistent officiating problems and harassment of players.

Who might replace her?

Swin Cash, Naismith Basketball Hall of Famer

One way the NBA and WNBA could make its players happy? Hiring a former player. Hall of Famer Cash, 46, has been floated as a strong option. Cash won two titles at UConn and spent 15 years in the WNBA, winning three titles.

She also has a front-office background, having run basketball operations for the Pelicans from 2019-25 as one of few women in the high-ranking role across the NBA.

Jennifer Rizzotti, Connecticut Sun president

Rizzotti has basketball bona fides working in her favor. An NCAA champion at UConn, a two-time WNBA champion, and a member of the Women’s Basketball Hall of Fame, Rizzotti has served as president of the

WNBA, Page C2



FILE/NAM Y. HUH/ASSOCIATED PRESS

The WNBA grew exponentially while Cathy Engelbert was commissioner, a post she plans to retire from in December.

BEN VOLIN

ON FOOTBALL

Gonzalez getting negative message

Robert Kraft hasn’t said anything publicly about Christian Gonzalez’s contract negotiations since the first day of training camp. Mike Vrabel and Eliot Wolf have done their best to say as little as possible about it, too.

“I love coaching Christian. He’s a valuable member of this football team,” Vrabel said Thursday. “We’ll continue to have discussions, and I don’t have anything else to add about the contract.”

But the Patriots have been sending messages to Gonzalez throughout the preseason. Really, since March. The message is unspoken, but loud and clear: *We don’t care if the rest of the NFL or the Madden video game thinks you’re the best cornerback. We don’t value you the same.*

As he prepares for Wednesday’s season opener against the Seahawks, Gonzalez told MassLive on Thursday that he’s “still frustrated” to not have a new contract yet. He has every right to be. Ten other first-

ON FOOTBALL, Page C2

Roster building not as planned

BC football needed to adjust

By Julian Benbow

GLOBE STAFF

Boston College football coach Bill O’Brien had a vision for the way he wanted to bring talent to the program when he introduced his first recruiting class in December 2024.

In an ideal world, the Eagles would approach recruiting the way the Houston Texans and New England Patriots did when he was in the NFL. He saw high school recruiting as the draft, the transfer portal as free agency, and BC as a program rooted in recruiting and development.

“We’re not going to be swapping 30 guys out and bringing 30 guys in,” O’Brien said that December. “That’s not who we are. We’re going to develop the guys we have in our program, build a culture with those guys, and then try to [fill] where we have some needs.

“We’ll see if it works. We have a strong belief in it and we’re going to make it work.”

The dilemma O’Brien has faced with BC’s 2026 roster is that the team-building model he envisioned has become increasingly uncommon in modern college football.

Based on roster analysis via College Football Data,

BC FOOTBALL, Page C6



FILE/MATT KELLEY/GETTY IMAGES

BC lost 26 transfers after a 2-10 season, so coach Bill O’Brien brought in 28 to restock the roster.



STEPHANIE SCARBROUGH/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Mickey Gasper continued his hot swinging with another first-inning solo homer Friday in Baltimore, his eighth long ball in 16 games.

Suarez back to sensational

He twirls seven shutout frames to silence Orioles

By Alex Speier

GLOBE STAFF

Red Sox 1 **Orioles 0** BALTIMORE — How difficult is it to run a relay race on a tightrope? On Friday, the Red Sox provided an answer.

After a solo homer by Mickey Gasper in the

top of the first inning, the team couldn’t score again against the Orioles. Three Sox pitchers thus spent the entire night trying to guide the most delicate of leads to safety.

Across 112 pitches, Ranger Suarez (seven shutout innings), Garrett Whitlock (scoreless eighth), and Aroldis Chapman (perfect ninth for his 32nd save and 399th of his career) did just that, allowing the Sox to secure a 1-0 victory in Camden Yards.

The team’s AL-leading 15th shutout came

with a high degree of difficulty.

“You feel [throughout the game] like, ‘Man, they’re just one swing away,’ ” said interim manager Chad Tracy. “[It makes a win] all the more impressive.”

With one out in the first, Gasper ambushed a first-pitch fastball from Baltimore starter Shane Baz, rocketing a solo homer down the right-field line to put the Sox ahead. The longball was the eighth for Gasper in 16

RED SOX, Page C4

New football Super 8 more a salve than solution

MATT PORTER

ON HIGH SCHOOL SPORTS

It irks some — parents, coaches, and the professionally argumentative — when teams made up of one town’s players competing on a public school’s budget have to play teams with no enrollment boundaries and private school endowments.

It’s not fair, they say. Not safe. Not the way to decide state titles.

And it tees off a good round of squabbling, arguably our state sport, when public schools get trounced by private schools. I’ve never covered a game where half the crowd was chant-

ing, “You recruit!” and the other, “Prove it!” But when rival fans talk, the allegations and denials fly.

Somehow, those schools keep getting the best players. Proof always seems to vanish before the light.

Since the postwar boom of babies and school choices, Catholic and other private schools have asked for evidence of wrongdoing while winning more than their share. The head of one North Shore public school system recently acknowledged to the Globe the challenge of convincing top athletes to stay home, because those private schools “have what students are looking for.”

The trend of players reclassifying — repeat-

ing a grade when they transfer to schools outside the MIAA — plus the arrival of specialized training centers, such as Masters Academy International, could make it harder for Massachusetts public schools to keep up.

In a state where Xaverian football is going for its fourth consecutive Division 1 title, and Catholic Memorial is dominating Division 2, we have arrived at a solution.

The Super 8 was first established in 1991, mostly to help schools besides CM win at hockey. It handpicked the top eight teams to play in a postseason tournament of their own, opening spots on the stage for other teams. Private schools usually managed to keep top billing.

ON HIGH SCHOOL SPORTS, Page C7

NFL NOTEBOOK

Hall of Fame election process gets facelift

Voters will have fewer categories to pick from

ASSOCIATED PRESS

The Pro Football Hall of Fame is overhauling the selection process by eliminating a separate category for senior players, cutting the selection committee nearly in half, and returning to in-person meetings.

The procedures were approved by the Hall of Fame board following discussions with Hall of Fame staff, members, and people on the selection committee. The changes announced Friday will be in place for the Class of 2027 and come after the voting process came under scrutiny for the most recent class, when six-time Super Bowl winning head coach **Bill Belichick** didn't get enough support for induction.

"The Hall of Fame's selection process has always been guided by integrity, thoughtful deliberation, and a commitment to honoring those most deserving of football's highest individual honor," Hall of Fame president **Jim Porter** said. "We believe these changes both augment what has worked well while addressing opportunities to further strengthen a tradition that means so much to the game and everyone who loves it."

The Hall is cutting the selection committee from 50 people to 28, with 25 eligible to vote each year and the other three participating in the discussion of each candidate. The nonvoters will rotate each year. Instead of a panel of one representative for all 32 teams, 17 at-large voters, and one representative of the Pro Football Writers of America, there will be 27 at-large members and one PFWA representative.

The 28-person selection committee will follow a similar process as in the past, reducing the initial list of nominees in the player category to 50 players, then 25 semifinalists and 13 finalists. There will also be one coaching candidate and one contributor picked as a finalist who will be considered with the players.

Players are eligible for the Hall after five years of retirement, but there no longer will be a split between modern era candidates and senior candidates, who previously moved to a separate seniors category after they had been retired for 25 years. That will reduce the player finalists from 18 — including three seniors — to 13 no matter when they retired.

Modern era players **Willie Anderson**, **Marshall Yanda**, and **Terrell Suggs** will no longer automatically advance to the finalist stage after reaching the final seven in the Class of 2026.

Finalists will be reduced to 10 and then seven with all 15 in the same category instead of one group for modern-era players and another with coaches, contributors, and senior players. Voters can vote for six people, with 80 per-

cent needed. The past two years, voters could vote for five of the seven modern-era candidates, and three of five from the coach, contributor, and seniors. Previously, the committee had a final up-or-down vote on the final modern-era candidates, as well as seniors, coaches, or contributors who were finalists. That led to most of those getting into the Hall, but that has now gotten more difficult.

Jacobs court date moved up

Packers running back **Josh Jacobs**'s initial court appearance on two misdemeanor charges stemming from a May altercation with his girlfriend was moved up two months to Thursday.

Jacobs's hearing originally was scheduled for Nov. 17, but now will be three days before the Packers open the season at Minnesota.

The NFL has placed Jacobs on the commissioner's exempt list, which prevents the three-time Pro Bowler from playing or practicing, but allows him to keep receiving a paycheck. The NFL made that move Sunday, three days after Brown County (Wis.) district attorney **David Lasee** said Jacobs was being charged with battery and criminal damage to property.

The NFL is investigating Jacobs's situation and could suspend him. Any games he misses while on the exempt list would count toward his suspension, but he would have to repay the money he earned during that time.

Jacobs was arrested May 26, three days after Hobart-Lawrence police officers came to his home to investigate a disturbance. Police said Jacobs's girlfriend told them she had a lump on her head as a result of Jacobs's actions.

Historic touchdown under

The 49ers arrived Friday morning in Australia for their season opener against the Rams at the Melbourne Cricket Ground Thursday night. It's expected to be the first of many games in front of a growing Australian fan base.

The 49ers' 200-member traveling party touched down after a 15-hour chartered Qantas flight, and will spend time acclimatizing before playing in front of an expected sold-out crowd.

Injured stars **George Kittle** and **Nick Bosa** returned to practice recently and are hoping to play in the game. San Francisco will be without defensive end **Sam Okuayinonu**, who was placed on injured reserve with a foot injury and will miss at least four games.

The Rams are scheduled to arrive about 24 hours before the game, which will be played Friday morning in Australia. The team's plan was to attempt to stay as close as possible to its West Coast time zone to avoid jet lag. Coach **Sean McVay** said the entire roster will travel to Australia, but he isn't sure whether retired defensive tackle **Aaron Donald** will play.

Knocks." "I'm secure with the team. I know where I'm going to be for the next few years. It means a lot to me that they think that highly of me to allow me to continue my career here."

From Gonzalez's perspective, every day that the negotiations drag on, and every dollar the Patriots try to save, sends the opposite message. *I'm not secure with the team. There's a lot of stress. I don't know where I'm going to be in the future. Apparently, they don't think that highly of me.* Gonzalez's teammates hear that message, too.

The Patriots likely see it this way — Gonzalez is under contract for two more years at approximately \$21 million, and are under no obligation to bust their budget now. It's who they have been for the last 25 years. They have opened their checkbook for outside free agents such as Stephon Gilmore and Milton Williams, but not really for their own guys.

The players that lasted a while in Foxborough — Tom Brady, Rob Gronkowski, Julian Edelman — pretty much hated their contracts. And the list of players shipped out of Foxborough over contract disputes reads like a Pro Bowl roster — Adam Vinatieri, Richard Seymour, Asante Samuel, Randy Moss, Wes Welker, Logan Mankins, Jamie Collins, Malcolm Butler, Brady, Gilmore, and on and on.

We used to think it was Bill Belichick's tight-fisted cap management forcing the players out. But he's not around to take the blame this time — it's all on the Krafts.

They do seem willing to come close to Gonzalez's asking price. White said on the radio that he noticed Gonzalez in a better mood recently and thinks a deal can get done before the season opener.

"We want him here. He's an elite player," Wolf said. "I've been on record saying that before, and we're continuing to work with his representation to find a resolution that works for everyone."

Gonzalez may ultimately accept a less-than-stellar deal just to get the payday and put the negotiations behind him. But is it really worth it to the Krafts to save \$10 million-\$15 million and "win" the negotiations, yet create bitter feelings with their star defender? If they're willing to give Gonzalez a large contract, they need to go all the way.

Otherwise, every day the negotiations drag on creates negative vibes and sends the message that the Patriots don't value Gonzalez as a franchise player.

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EBRAHIM NOROOZI/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Caitlin Clark had 14 points and 11 assists to help the US defeat China, 94-61, in its World Cup opener in Berlin.

WNBA's Engelbert set to retire

By Doug Feinberg

ASSOCIATED PRESS

WNBA commissioner Cathy Engelbert is retiring at the end of the year, bringing to a close her seven-plus years at the helm of the league and a stewardship that has been transformative and, at times, tumultuous.

Engelbert is the second-longest tenured WNBA president or commissioner, and she helped negotiate a lucrative collective bargaining agreement this past spring that resulted in the league's first set of million-dollar player salaries.

"Cathy has presided over the WNBA through the most significant period of growth in the league's 30-year history," NBA commissioner Adam Silver said Friday when announcing Engelbert's decision. "We are grateful for Cathy's leadership and unwavering commitment to the advancement of women's basketball."

Engelbert, who turns 62 in November, told The Associated Press that she has been thinking about retiring for months.

"When I first came to the league I intended to do this for 3½ years," she said in a phone interview. "The 7½ years exceeded that time. This is a really good time given the financial transformation jour-

WOMEN'S WORLD CUP BASKETBALL

US overcomes tall order to win

ASSOCIATED PRESS

BERLIN — Caitlin Clark had 14 points and 11 assists to help the United States beat China, which was led by 7-foot-3-inch Zhang Ziyu, 94-61, in its women's basketball World Cup opener Friday.

Rhyné Howard also scored 14 points and Jackie Young added 12 for the Americans, who have now won 31 consecutive World Cup games dating back to a loss in the semifinals of the 2006 tournament.

This is a period of transition for the US with a young roster that includes the trio of Clark, Paige Bueckers, and Angel Reese. None of them were in the starting lineup, but they were on the court together to close out the opening quarter, which the Americans dominated to go up, 27-14.

China fought back at the start of the second quarter behind Zhang. The 19-year-old, who was making her first World Cup appearance, towered over the Americans. On defense, she stood under the basket, making it difficult for the Americans to score inside or get second shots off misses. On offense, the Americans constantly double-teamed her when she caught the ball.

Zhang's first basket of the game got China within 33-25 with 6:21 left in the half. The US then went on a 16-4 run to close the first half up, 49-29. Young had a three-point play and Breanna Stewart scored the final four points.

China paired Zhang (13 points) with 6-10 Han Xu in the third quarter, presenting an even more potent defensive wall against the US. China got within 53-37, but no closer.

ney we've been on. Getting the collective bargaining agreement done, getting a long-term media rights deal done, getting expansion done."

Engelbert insists that the decision to leave was solely her own, and that she did not feel any pressure to step down from NBA or WNBA stakeholders.

The commissioner said she has been working on a succession plan over the last few years. While she didn't give any specifics on who might be considered for the position, Engelbert did say there are both internal and external potential candidates on the league's radar.

"It's a good time to hand it off to the next leader to take the 'W' into a better phase," she said. "I'm proud of the team we built and everything we accomplished. A leader knows when it's time to drop the mic and move on after building a powerhouse team in the league office."

Engelbert said she has mixed emotions about leaving.

"I love women's basketball and am not going anywhere yet. We'll run a real succession process in the remaining four months. If we don't find someone, I'll stay on," she said. "I had no transition. I walked in the door and I was by myself as no one transitioned me into this role."

Future leadership choices abound

► **WNBA**
Continued from Page C1

Sun since 2021 but will likely be out of a job at the end of this season when the franchise relocates to Houston.

She's been outspoken in discussing league issues, including the abuse of players online. And after five years of having to navigate a unique market, Rizzotti has taken on the added challenge of overseeing (and handling with grace) the Sun's final season.

Micky Lawler, commissioner, Unrivaled

Lawler was named the first commissioner of the player-owned three-on-three offseason league in 2024, and has overseen tremendous growth — just last week, the league said it had a \$650 million valuation entering Year 3 this winter. Lawler, who oversees the day-to-day operations, strategy, and revenue, previously served as president of the Women's Tennis Association. Her background in one of the oldest women's sports organizations — and one of the only sports that offers equal pay for men and women — combined with her proximity to the league's talent could vault her into the mix.

Renie Anderson, NFL executive vice president and chief revenue officer

Anderson's work at the nation's most powerful league focuses on sponsorship, media sales, and new business — key areas for the WNBA's growth. She has been at the NFL since 2006, and more recently has focused on integrating the league's largest brand partners into marquee events such as the Super Bowl and the draft. She also handles some of the NFL's sports betting partnerships.

Maura Healey, governor of Massachusetts

Up for reelection in November, it's unlikely Healey is ready to leave politics on such short notice. But the move isn't without precedent: Former Massachusetts governor Charlie Baker has been the president of the NCAA since 2023, and former mayor of Boston and US Secretary of Labor Marty Walsh is now the executive

director of the NHL Players' Association.

Healey, a onetime captain of the Harvard women's basketball team, has long been a vocal proponent of professional women's basketball in her home state. In recent years, she has advocated for bringing a WNBA team to Boston.

When reached by the Globe for comment, a spokesperson from her office did not address the possibility.

"Governor Healey loves her job and is committed to serving as Governor of Massachusetts," the spokesperson said. "She is honored every day to serve the people of Massachusetts, and that is her only focus."

Suzanne Abair, Atlanta Dream co-owner and CEO

Abair bought into the Dream when former Senator Kelly Loeffler sold her stake in 2021. Abair had not worked in professional sports prior to the purchase. She also serves as the team's lead governor.

Abair, who lives in Massachusetts, was a partner at a Boston law firm before joining Newton-based Northland, a real estate private-equity firm, as its general counsel in 2004, before being promoted to COO and later president. Experience in a sprawling, national company — one with a workforce that is 44 percent women and 35 percent people of color — gives Abair the background to manage a complex entity such as the WNBA.

Nadia Rawlinson, Chicago Sky co-owner and operating chairman

Rawlinson brings high-level human resources experience; she was an executive at Slack Technologies and Live Nation. She also is an adviser for venture capital outfit Google Ventures. The Harvard MBA grad sits on a number of high-profile boards and could give the WNBA access to new spaces such as Silicon Valley.

Jess Smith, Golden State Valkyries president

Smith's career in sports took her to Major League Baseball, the NHL, MLS, then the WWSL's Angel City Football Club, where she

helped launch the franchise as its head of revenue. In 2024, she landed the job of president of the Valkyries, the WNBA's expansion franchise that began play in 2025. The team made an instant splash; it has sold out every game at the Chase Center in San Francisco and after just one season was named the most valuable WNBA franchise by Sportico.

Other names to watch:

■ Nneka Ogwumike: The WNBA players' union president and Los Angeles Sparks icon announced she will be retiring at the end of this season. Could a larger leadership role be in her future? At 36, she may not have the business experience to take over — at least not yet.

■ Keia Clarke: As CEO of the New York Liberty, Clarke has turned the team into one of the league's model franchises. Her ability to negotiate more sponsorship revenue and sell more tickets in one of the league's most sports-saturated markets has earned her accolades across the industry.

■ Kelly Krauskopf: The president of the Indiana Fever since 2025, Krauskopf previously served as the team's general manager for 17 years before joining the NBA's Pacers as an assistant GM. Early in her career, she had a brief stint as the WNBA's director of operations in the late 1990s. Her mix of NBA and WNBA experience — as well as her role in capitalizing on Caitlin Clark's star power — makes her a unique candidate.

■ Kamala Harris: She could run for president in a few years . . . or the former vice president and US senator could bring her advocacy and political acumen to the WNBA.

■ Michelle Obama: The former First Lady has hosted WNBA players on her podcast and has long been an advocate for women. While it is unclear if she wants the job, the star power alone would make her a compelling commissioner.

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Baseball

Story’s doubts have been erased

PETER ABRAHAM
ON BASEBALL

BALTIMORE — It was here at Camden Yards a little more than four months ago when Trevor Story stood at his locker and questioned the management of the Red Sox in the wake of manager Alex Cora and six coaches being fired.

“It’s kind of up in the air what the true direction of the franchise is,” he said that day.

Story, Garrett Whitlock, and other veteran players felt the brief explanation they received from chief baseball officer Craig Breslow wasn’t adequate. They also were upset that other senior team officials didn’t take their questions.

Their concerns proved well founded when the Red Sox were still buried in last place near the end of June before an unprecedented turnaround that has them poised to return to the postseason as a wild-card team.

Standing in front of that same locker on Friday, Story offered no apologies or retractions. But he is grateful for how it turned out.

“It feels like a lifetime ago,” Story said before a 1-0 victory over the Orioles on Friday night. “It was what you would hope would happen, but obviously the odds weren’t great, and that’s why this season has been so special.

“It’s pretty crazy to think of where we are now.”

In April, Breslow said he felt the team had underachieved in relation to the talent on the roster, which was true. But within a few weeks, both Roman Anthony and Garrett Crochet were on the injured list.

Anthony did not return until last week, and Crochet is still weeks away, if he returns at all this season.

Jake Bennett, Mickey Gasper, Nick Sogard, and Anthony Seigler were among the players who unexpectedly



STEPHANIE SCARBROUGH/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Blaze Alexander (left) had words for Nick Sogard (right) after a slide led to the benches clearing in the eighth.

helped fuel the comeback.

“It’s incredible the way guys stepped up and filled the void,” Story said. “They did great. That just kind of speaks to their character and the depth of our team.

“That’s what we said in spring training — that it takes a lot of us. It’s way more than the 26 players we had on Opening Day. I think we’ve shown that many people deserve credit for this.”

Story had his own unexpected journey, getting off to a slow start and undergoing surgery on May 22 to repair a sports hernia. He returned last week and is 8 of 20 with four doubles and four RBIs in his first five games.

“Every day feels a bit better,” said Story, who was back in the lineup after getting a day off. “I feel like I should be able to help us.”

Story, while still a believer in what Cora brings to a team, gives a lot of credit to interim manager Chad Tracy and how he handled the turbulence. Tracy’s day-to-day consistency resonated with the players.

“He steadied the ship,” Story said. “Just what we all needed. Can’t say enough about what he has done.

“He’s the same guy every day; that’s one of his strengths. He’s been around the game a long time. He knows who he is and how things can land or not land. He’s just being himself.”

Story and Tracy were in spring training together with the 2012 Colorado Rockies. Story was a first-round pick preparing for his second season in pro ball, and Tracy a career minor leaguer looking for an opportunity.

“I really got to know him from playing for Worcester throughout some of my rehabs and spring training,” Story said. “He was the perfect choice.”

Tracy said Friday that one of his priorities on the day he took over for Cora was to sit with Story alone and hear him out about the change.

“I knew coming in the level of communication is different when you’re dealing with guys who have been around for a really long time,” Tracy

Red Sox 1, Orioles 0

At Oriole Park at Camden Yards, Baltimore

BOSTON	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.		
Kinney dh	4	0	0	0	1	1	.259		
Gasper 1b	4	1	2	0	0	1	.283		
Kiner-Falefa 2b	0	0	0	0	0	0	.272		
Rutschman c	4	0	0	0	0	2	.237		
Abreu rf	2	0	0	0	2	1	.257		
Sogard 2b-1b	3	0	0	0	1	0	.262		
Durbin 3b	4	0	0	0	0	2	.248		
Duran lf	4	0	1	0	0	1	.204		
Story ss	4	0	1	0	0	2	.227		
White cf	4	0	1	0	0	1	.262		
Totals	33	1	5	1	4	11			
BALTIMORE	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.		
Alexander rf	4	0	3	0	0	0	.316		
Mayo dh	3	0	1	0	0	0	.222		
a-Basallo ph-dh	1	0	0	0	0	0	.228		
Robert Jr. cf	3	0	0	0	1	0	.182		
Alonso 1b	4	0	0	0	0	1	.267		
Henderson ss	4	0	1	0	0	1	.221		
EncarnacionStrnd 3b	4	0	1	0	0	0	.269		
Holliday 2b	3	0	0	0	0	0	.236		
Narvaez c	2	0	0	0	0	0	.162		
Taveras lf	3	0	0	0	0	2	.217		
Totals	31	0	6	0	1	4			
Boston.....	100 000 000						1	5	0
Baltimore.....	000 000 000						0	6	2
a-filed out for Mayo in 8th. E—Holliday (6), Taveras (6).									
LOB—Boston 10, Baltimore 6. HR—Gasper (8), off Baz. RISP—									
Boston 0 for 7, Baltimore 0 for 3. DP—Boston 2 (Durbin, Sogard, Gasper), (Story, Sogard, Gasper).									
Boston	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	NP	ERA	
Suarez W 6-4	7	5	0	0	1	3	91	3.44	
Whitlock	1	1	0	0	0	0	10	1.91	
Chapman S 32	1	0	0	0	0	1	11	2.08	
Baltimore	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	NP	ERA	
Baz L 5-15	6½	4	1	1	2	6	95	3.91	
Hoppe	⅔	0	0	0	1	0	15	4.23	
Walker	1	1	0	0	1	2	22	2.05	
Sanders	1	0	0	0	0	2	14	3.00	
Inherited runners-scored—Hoppe 1-0. HBP—by Suarez (Narvaez), by Hoppe (Gasper). Umpires—Home, Adrian Johnson; First, Ramon De Jesus; Second, Dexter Kelley; Third, Paul Clemens. T—2:31. A—19,821 (42,455).									

HOW THE RUN SCORED

FIRST INNING

RED SOX — Anthony flied to center. Gasper homered to right. Rutschman struck out. Abreu flied to left.

RED SOX NOTEBOOK

Hitters get nice lift with Gedman on trip

By Alex Speier
GLOBE STAFF

BALTIMORE — **Chad Tracy** had a surprise for his players.

In the middle of the daily pregame hitters’ meeting before Wednesday’s game against the Mariners, an unexpected guest arrived at Fenway Park: Longtime Red Sox player and minor league coach **Rich Gedman**.

His presence didn’t go unnoticed. “You should have seen the reception when he showed up,” said Tracy before Friday’s 1-0 victory over the Orioles. “[The players] thought he was there for the day. I said, ‘By the way, he’s going to Baltimore? You should have seen the reaction to *that*. . . . They love him.”

Gedman is with the Sox for the four-game series. The 66-year-old Worcester native, who signed with the Sox out of St. Peter-Marian High School 49 years ago, became a two-time All-Star with the team during a 13-year big league career, and has been coaching in the system for the last 21 years.

Before Tracy became interim big league manager, he leaned on Gedman for five years in Worcester. So did several current Sox players, including **Jarren Duran**, **Ceddanne Rafaela**, **Roman Anthony**, **Wilyer Abreu**, **Mickey Gasper**, **Nick Sogard**, and others.

“I thought they were messing around with me the last day at Fenway when he was here. They said he was in there, and then I went in the cage, and there he was,” said Gasper. “I’m so happy to see him here. He’s earned it. He’s paid his dues. He played this game for such a long time, coached this game for such a long time, and for him to be back in the big leagues is exactly where he belongs.”

For Gedman, the opportunity to spend time with the big league club provided joy, not for the personal opportunity, but the chance to be around players living a dream he’d watched them chase.

“[The big leaguers] just kept getting a little better, kept understanding the game, kept understanding themselves,” said Gedman, who is in both the Red Sox and WooSox Halls of Fame. “If they’re in Triple-A, they’re big leaguers in the making, or they’ve been here and are trying to get back. It’s wonderful to see them in the upper level.”

The feeling was mutual.

Houck hucking again

Thirteen months removed from Tommy John surgery, righthander **Tanner Houck** took another step toward positioning himself as a bullpen option

down the stretch. He threw two simulated innings against hitters in Fort Myers on Friday, working at 93-95 miles per hour.

Barring a setback, he’ll head to Double-A Portland for a one-inning rehab game on Tuesday. If he can build to roughly two innings and 45 pitches in the minors, he could become a candidate to return to the big leagues.

“Having guys of that caliber with big, big talent available, if you can get him there would be important down the stretch,” said Tracy.

Johan Oviedo, out since April with an elbow strain, also faced hitters in Fort Myers, and could start a rehab assignment late next week.

Lefthander **Garrett Crochet** threw a 16-pitch bullpen session (all fastballs) at Fenway, his first bullpen session since May. He’ll throw another Tuesday.

“The fact that he got on the mound today and threw is a really, really good sign,” said Tracy. “It’s hard to say at this point [if he has time to become a bullpen option], but I think the fact that he’s throwing sides right now, the goal by the end of the season is to get him out there if we can. But, we’ve got more boxes to check.”

Righthander **Tyron Guerrero** (shoulder inflammation) resumed throwing, but **Justin Slaten** (elbow inflammation) is still experiencing soreness and isn’t throwing.

Rafaela sits again

Outfielder **Ceddanne Rafaela** reported improvement in his tight right quad, but sat for a second straight day. He expected to resume swinging Saturday and trying to run on Sunday, but didn’t expect a lineup return before the Sox play at Fenway on Monday . . . In Rafaela’s absence, **Eli White** started a second straight game in center field, and had one of the Sox’ five hits on the night. White grew up near Greenville, S.C., attending Greenville Drive games at Fluor Field. What Sox prospects does he remember watching? “**Will Middlebrooks** was there! I definitely saw him play,” White said of the WEEI/NESN analyst. “That was back when I could run a little bit, but I still couldn’t run like Eli White,” chuckled Middlebrooks, who played for Greenville in 2009. “Hopefully he saw a couple cool homers onto the apartment buildings [in left].”

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GREG FIUME/GETTY IMAGES

Ranger Suarez turned in his longest outing since April 27, throwing seven innings in a 1-0 win over the Orioles.

Gaspar’s HR stands up for Suarez in win

►RED SOX
Continued from Page C1

games, a span in which he’s hitting .378/.500/1.000.

“I’m running out of words,” Tracy said of the Merrimack Masher. “What he’s done in his opportunities and what he’s doing over the course of the last two weeks, he’s helping us big-time win baseball games.”

But Baz (5-15, 3.91) recovered, settling into a groove that carried him through the remainder of his 6⅓ innings. Still, his early misstep proved costly, on a night when Suarez — who’d struggled to a 5.40 ERA in his last eight starts — snapped back into All-Star form.

Suarez (6-4, 3.44) didn’t miss bats so much as he turned them to noodles. Though he got just three swings-and-misses in 91 pitches, he limited the hosts to five singles with a combination of precise location (especially on his sinker), movement, and unpredictable sequences that produced a grass-manicuring succession of groundballs and mishits.

“Literally, I’ve been waiting for this start for a while,” Suarez said via translator. “To be able to have a start like tonight and have a strong end of the year, that’s what I’m looking for.”

Though the first and seventh innings were his only ones without base

runners, Suarez remained unflappable. With runners on the corners and two outs in the third, he induced an inning-ending line out to center by Luis Robert Jr. With two on and two out in the fifth, he got a routine groundout from Coby Mayo to end the frame.

And after he issued a leadoff walk to Robert in the sixth, Suarez left Pete Alonso shaking his head after a called strike three on a sinker, then quickly deleted the next two hitters to keep the shutout intact.

Alonso, the longtime Met, is 3 for 24 with eight strikeouts and no homers in his career against the southpaw.

“He’s a true master of his craft, an artist,” said second baseman Nick Sogard.

With the postseason in view, Suarez — one of the best October pitchers this decade — viewed his first outing of seven-plus innings since April as a meaningful springboard.

“Obviously it helps your confidence even more when you’re a month away from the playoffs,” he said.

A near-dustup occurred in the eighth inning, after Orioles leadoff hitter Blaze Alexander singled off Whitlock. On an inning-ending double play, Alexander — whom Jahmai Jones wiped out on a potential dou-

bled. “I started chipping away at that pretty early to have a pretty good understanding.”

The Sox have only 20 games left before the postseason. The tumult of April has shifted to the idea of contending for a championship. The American League is down this season and there for the taking.

“The playoffs are all about pitching and defense, and those are our strengths,” Story said. “We feel very confident about who we are as a team. We’ve shown we can overcome a lot.”

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Baseball



SUE OGROCKI/ASSOCIATED PRESS

It was an ending befitting a bodacious bat flip, as Brayan Rocchio celebrated his walkoff home run as the Guardians beat the Tigers in Cleveland.

AL

EAST	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Tampa Bay	84	57	.596	—	—	6-4	W 1
*New York	80	60	.571	3½	—	6-4	W 2
Boston	77	65	.542	7½	—	4-6	W 2
Toronto	71	71	.500	13½	1	7-3	W 3
Baltimore	69	73	.486	15½	3	5-5	L 4

CENTRAL	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Chicago	74	67	.525	—	—	6-4	W 1
Cleveland	72	70	.507	2½	—	6-4	W 2
Minnesota	67	74	.475	7	4½	4-6	L 2
Detroit	64	77	.454	10	7½	3-7	L 2
Kansas City	63	79	.444	11½	9	5-5	L 1

WEST	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Houston	73	69	.514	—	—	7-3	W 3
Texas	70	72	.493	3	2	4-6	L 1
*Seattle	66	75	.468	6½	5½	4-6	L 1
*Athletics	55	86	.390	17½	16½	4-6	W 2
Los Angeles	53	88	.376	19½	18½	1-9	L 3

NL

EAST	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Atlanta	84	57	.596	—	—	8-2	W 2
Philadelphia	79	62	.560	5	—	6-4	L 2
Miami	71	71	.500	13½	3	4-6	L 2
*Washington	67	75	.472	17½	7	6-4	L 1
New York	64	77	.454	20	9½	5-5	W 2

CENTRAL	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Milwaukee	88	54	.620	—	—	7-3	W 1
Chicago	80	62	.563	8	—	4-6	W 2
St. Louis	71	71	.500	17	3	5-5	W 1
Pittsburgh	70	72	.493	18	4	7-3	W 2
Cincinnati	67	74	.475	20½	6½	5-5	L 1

WEST	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
*Los Angeles	83	57	.593	—	—	4-6	W 1
*San Diego	73	67	.521	10	—	3-7	L 2
Arizona	74	68	.521	10	—	5-5	L 1
San Francisco	58	84	.408	26	16	4-6	L 2
Colorado	54	87	.383	29½	19½	4-6	L 1

* — Not including late game

RESULTS									
FRIDAY									
Boston 1	at Baltimore 0	At Chi. White Sox 4	Minnesota 1						
1st: At Cleveland 7	Detroit 6	Tampa Bay 7	at Texas 6						
2nd: At Cleveland 4 (10 inn.)	Detroit 3	At Houston 3	Arizona 1						
Milwaukee 10	at Cincinnati 7	Toronto 9	at Kansas City 2						
Atlanta 5	at Philadelphia 2	St. Louis 7	at Colorado 6						
At Pittsburgh 1	LA Angels 0	NY Yankees	at San Diego						
Chi. Cubs 6	at Miami 1	Athletics	at Seattle						
At NY Mets 10	San Francisco 6	Washington	at LA Dodgers						
THURSDAY									
Boston 6	at Baltimore 5	At Kansas City 7	Miami 3						
At Pittsburgh 5	San Francisco 2	At Texas 6	Tampa Bay 0						
Toronto 6	at Cleveland 3	Athletics 7	at Seattle 4						
At Houston 6	Chi. White Sox 2	At LA Dodgers 3	St. Louis 2						
At Chi. Cubs 2	Milwaukee 1								

SATURDAY'S GAMES									
	Odds	2026 W-L	ERA	Team rec.	2026 W-L	vs. opp. IP	ERA	Last 3 starts W-L	starts..... IP ERA
BOSTON AT BALTIMORE, 7:05 p.m.									
Gray (R)	-140	16-4	2.82	18-7	0-0	0.0	0.00	2-1	18.0 3.00
Bassitt (R)	-120	6-4	4.97	8-6	0-1	3.0	9.00	2-0	18.0 4.50
CHI. CUBS AT MIAMI, 4:10 p.m.									
Holmes (R)	Off	6-6	2.09	7-7	0-0	0.0	0.00	1-1	18.1 0.49
Gusto (R)	Off	1-3	3.86	8-6	0-0	0.0	0.00	1-0	14.0 0.64
SAN FRANCISCO AT NY METS, 4:10 p.m.									
Molina (R)	+155	2-0	3.77	1-0	0-0	1.0	9.00	1-0	5.0 5.40
Thornton (L)	-185	3-4	2.93	4-7	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-1	16.0 3.38
ATLANTA AT PHILADELPHIA, 6:05 p.m.									
Pérez (L)	+135	8-8	3.05	12-10	1-0	6.0	0.00	0-2	14.2 3.68
Wheeler (R)	-160	11-5	3.31	16-7	0-0	5.0	3.60	1-1	15.0 6.60
DETROIT AT CLEVELAND, 8:10 p.m.									
Valdez (L)	+135	8-10	4.36	11-16	0-2	10.2	6.75	1-2	17.2 5.09
Messick (L)	-160	11-8	2.46	15-12	0-1	10.2	3.38	2-1	18.2 1.45
LA ANGELS AT PITTSBURGH, 6:40 p.m.									
Kikuchi (L)	+150	0-5	5.65	1-8	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-2	14.0 4.50
Ashcraft (R)	-180	14-5	3.59	19-8	0-0	0.0	0.00	2-0	19.0 1.89
MILWAUKEE AT CINCINNATI, 6:40 p.m.									
May (R)	-165	6-9	4.69	12-14	0-0	6.0	1.50	0-2	6.2 14.85
Abbott (L)	+140	6-10	4.49	13-15	0-0	5.0	3.60	0-3	15.1 7.63
TAMPA BAY AT TEXAS, 7:05 p.m.									
Rasmussen (R)	-110	14-5	2.95	17-9	0-0	0.0	0.00	2-0	17.0 4.24
deGrom (R)	-110	10-9	4.00	14-12	0-0	0.0	0.00	2-1	16.2 4.32
MINNESOTA AT CHI. WHITE SOX, 7:10 p.m.									
Bradley (R)	+100	10-7	3.85	16-11	0-1	4.2	7.71	1-1	18.2 2.89
Kay (L)	-120	9-7	4.28	15-11	1-0	6.0	1.50	0-2	15.1 6.46
TORONTO AT KANSAS CITY, 7:10 p.m.									
Scherzer (R)	-110	2-7	6.16	4-9	0-1	5.0	3.60	1-2	16.0 5.06
Lugo (R)	-110	6-8	5.03	14-14	1-0	5.0	1.80	1-1	14.2 9.20
ARIZONA AT HOUSTON, 7:15 p.m.									
Pfaadt (R)	-110	7-2	3.49	12-3	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-1	18.1 5.40
Pecko (R)	-110	1-0	6.23	3-0	0-0	0.0	0.00	1-0	13.0 6.23
NY YANKEES AT SAN DIEGO, 7:15 p.m.									
Rodón (L)	-105	4-3	3.20	7-5	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-1	12.2 2.84
Ray (L)	-115	11-7	3.14	15-11	0-1	5.1	3.38	1-0	17.1 2.08
ST. LOUIS AT COLORADO, 8:10 p.m.									
Liberatore (L)	-125	5-13	5.41	13-14	0-1	0.1	5.00	0-3	15.2 8.04
Adams (R)	+105	0-0	3.00	1-1	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-0	9.0 3.00
WASHINGTON AT LA DODGERS, 9:10 p.m.									
Cavalli (R)	+190	12-5	3.12	15-14	0-0	0.0	0.00	2-0	16.0 1.13
Glasnow (R)	-235	4-0	2.79	7-2	1-0	6.0	3.00	1-0	13.0 3.46
ATHLETICS AT SEATTLE, 9:40 p.m.									
Springs (L)	Off	3-13	6.37	8-17	0-1	5.0	3.60	0-2	15.0 7.80
Kirby (R)	Off	9-10	4.19	12-14	0-0	0.0	0.00	1-1	16.0 6.75

Team rec. — Record in games started by pitcher this season

NOTEBOOK

Braves get first blood

Sale, Atlanta open big series with win

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Atlanta's **Chris Sale** outdueled **Cristopher Sánchez** in a matchup of two of MLB's best pitchers, and the Braves beat the Phillies, 5-2, Friday night in the opener of a key four-game series in Philadelphia to extend their lead in the NL East to five games.

Ronald Acuña had three hits and drove in a run, and **Mauricio Dubón** homered for the Braves, who won for the ninth time in 11 games. **Alec Bohm** homered and doubled, and drove in both runs for the hosts.

Sale (14-9) allowed two runs in six innings with seven strikeouts and a walk. He entered second in the NL in ERA, which rose slightly to 2.10. Sánchez (16-5) remained stuck on 16 victories after surrendering three runs in six innings.

PCA, Cubs stay red hot

Shota Imanaga allowed three hits and one run in six innings, and **Pete Crow-Armstrong** doubled and stole his 33rd base as the Cubs beat the Marlins, 6-1, in Miami.

Imanaga (9-10) struck out four and improved to 4-2 in nine starts since the All-Star break. **Aaron Civale** pitched the final three innings for his second save. Armstrong continued to bolster his case for NL MVP with a walk, two runs, and a leaping grab at the wall to rob Miami's **Heriberto Hernández** of a hit in the sixth.

But the Brewers remained eight games up on the Cubs in the NL Central thanks to a 10-7 win in Cincinnati. **Cooper Pratt** tripled and drove in four, and **Brice Turang** added a two-run double for the Brewers (88-54), who need 10 more wins to set a franchise record.

Another Rays rally

Jonathan Aranda and **Richie Palacios** homered, and the Rays overcame the first grand slam of the season by Texas in a 7-6 victory to end a 10-game road losing streak against the Rangers. **Elias Díaz**, who had five RBIs, hit his fourth career slam to get Texas within a run in the seventh inning.

In Kansas City, Mo., **Alejandro Kirk**, **Ernie Clement**, and **George Springer** drove in two runs apiece to lead the Blue Jays to a 9-2 win over the Royals for their sixth win in the last seven to get back to .500 for the first time since June 22.

Double trouble

Brayan Rocchio hit a walkoff homer in the ninth after connecting on a tying grand slam in the fourth, rallying the host Guardians to a 7-6 comeback victory over the Tigers in the first game of a doubleheader.

Travis Bazzana pulled a similar two-homer trick in the nightcap, erasing a two-run deficit in the eighth with a tying home run, then hitting a walkoff single in the 10th to beat Detroit again, 4-3.

Rocchio became the sixth player in MLB history with a grand slam and a walkoff in the same game. The last was Boston's **Jack Clark** on July 31, 1991. With the wins, the Guardians remained in the final AL wild-card position.

Montys power Chicago

Colson Montgomery hit a two-run homer, and **Erick Fedde** pitched five sparkling innings to lead the White Sox over the Twins, 4-1, in Chicago.

Miguel Vargas and **Braden Montgomery** also went deep for the AL Central leaders, who had lost four of five. Catcher **Kyle Teel** went 0 for 3 in his return to the lineup after being sidelined by a sprained left ankle. . . . **Yainer Diaz** hit a solo shot in a three-run third, **Cristian Javier** combined with four relievers to limit Arizona to three hits, and the host Astros beat the Diamondbacks, 3-1, to move a season-high four games over .500 and expand their AL West lead to three games over Texas. . . . **Shohei Ohtani** got a second straight day off while the Dodgers star deals with assorted injuries (right biceps, neck, and left knee). . . . **Francisco Alvarez** hit two of New York's five bombs, leading **Nolan McLean** (6 IP, 6 hits) and the host Mets to a 10-6 win over the Giants despite a homer and five RBIs for **Rafael Devers**.

BRAVES 5, PHILLIES 2

ATLANTA	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Acuña Jr. rf	5	0	3	1	0	0	.249
Baldwin dh	5	0	1	0	0	1	.275
Albies 2b	4	0	0	0	1	1	.507
Olson 1b	4	0	0	0	0	1	.252
LaneThomas lf	2	1	0	0	1	1	.184
Yastrzemski ph-lf	0	1	0	0	0	1	.225
Dubón cf-ss	4	2	2	2	0	0	.268
SeaMurphy c	2	0	0	0	2	1	.234
Riley 3b	4	1	1	1	0	1	.223
Kim ss	2	0	0	1	0	0	.117
Harris II ph-cf	2	0	0	0	0	0	.294
Totals	35	5	8	5	4	6	

PHILADELPHIA	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Schwarber dh	4	0	0	0	0	1	.238
Turner ss	4	0	1	0	0	0	.239
Harper rf	4	0	0	0	0	2	.273
Arraez 2b	4	1	2	0	0	0	.316
Bohm 1b	4	1	2	2	0	1	.248
Sosa 3b	3	0	1	0	0	2	.239
De La Cruz lf	3	0	0	0	0	2	.333
Marsh ph	1	0	0	0	0	0	.268
Reimuto c	2	0	0	0	1	1	.221
Hill cf	2	0	0	0	0	0	.263
Crawford ph-cf	1	0	0	0	0	1	.265
Totals	32	2	6	2	1	10	

CHAD FINN

Season might end like last one



Playing nine innings while wondering when and where the 15-year retrospective on the 2011 Sox “Chicken and Beer” collapse is dropping . . .

1. Considering the unexpected good times that these feisty Red Sox brought to Fenway this summer after the season’s seemingly hopeless start, I’d prefer not to be thinking this while peering into the red-seamed crystal ball on my desk.

But recent developments have me suspicious that this season, which doesn’t have much in common narratively with last season, is going to end precisely the same way: with a wild-card round loss to the Yankees in the Bronx.

Those troubling developments include a weary pitching staff that entered Thursday’s series opener with the Orioles having allowed at least eight runs in four straight games; 14 losses in their last 26; and a disheartening four-game set in New York in which they were outscored, 25-3, over the last two games — which may or may not have been some bizarre Yankee tribute to Ron Guidry’s 1978 season.

The Red Sox look like a safe bet to make the postseason, but their 29-5 stretch this summer made us daydream of more.

They blew their chance to catch the Yankees in the wild-card race last weekend. They almost certainly made their path to a sustained postseason stay more treacherous. This season, at the moment, feels like it’s trending toward a final scene in New York.

But hey, should they surprise us and stick around a while into October, it wouldn’t be the first time they’ve surprised us this season.

2. A smattering of mea culpas have begun filtering into my inbox from fans who gave up on the idea of Roman Anthony coming back from his finger injury to help the Sox this season. All right, fine, the smattering is actually two readers, but that dual smattering is appreciated. Sox fans should have remembered that Anthony truly looked like a future superstar, and one with that brilliant future *very* near, when he came up last season. But sports radio and social-media gossip poisoned too many minds during this season’s long absence.

3. Think about it: That Yankees playoff series might have gone differently had Anthony — who was their most dangerous offensive player from early July until suffering a season-ending oblique injury almost exactly a year ago — not been absent. From July 4 (the occasion of just his 22nd major league game) through Sept. 2, Anthony slashed .326/.428/.513 with seven home runs and 20 extra-base hits in 222 plate appearances over 50 games, a good-sized sample.

4. I’m glad to remind you short-memories cynics, skeptics, and Felger parroters that Anthony did that in his age-21 season. (You probably should have remembered.) The fortunate thing — and a necessary one during this recent stretch of turbulence — is that he’s performed like the force that he was last season. Tiny sample size, sure, but he has 10 hits in 22 at-bats in five games since returning, raising his season OPS from .675 to .797.

5. I’m not sure many of the new Caleb Durbin fans around here have noticed, but Alex Bregman — the backup third baseman to Adrian Beltré on the Red Sox’ One-And-Done All-Stars — is going to end up with excellent numbers in his first season as a Cub. It probably shouldn’t be called an excellent *season* per se, as he slashed a mediocre .248/.340/.380 in 107 games through July 31.

6. But Bregman’s August was downright helacious: .296/.364/.661 with 12 home runs in 28 games. That includes a pair of three-homer games. On the season, he has 24 homers and a .790 OPS, and his 4.7 bWAR is good for a sixth-place tie among National League position players. Might as well ask the question: Would you have preferred the Red Sox allocated the brunt of their offseason free agent funds to re-signing Bregman, who got five years and \$175 million, with a full no-trade, from the Cubs?

7. Or do you prefer the alternative that played out, which was signing former Phillies lefthander Ranger Suarez for five years and \$130 million, and then filling the third-base vacancy by acquiring Durbin, Andruw Monasterio, Anthony Seigler, and a competitive-balance pick from the Brewers for pitchers Kyle Harrison and Shane Drohan, and infielder David Hamilton? I think my decision comes down to how Suarez pitches down the stretch and in the postseason. (He has a 1.48 ERA in 11 playoff appearances, including eight starts.)

8. Presuming the Red Sox do make the postseason, I have no intention of trusting Brayan Bello in important situations once they get there. Bello was a debacle in his one playoff start last year, continued to be one as a starter this season, got sent to Worcester in early June, came back in mid-July, and was excellent in a multi-inning role out of the bullpen. In his first eight relief appearances, he posted a superb 1.23 ERA, with 24 strikeouts and just six walks in 29½ innings. But in his last two? Eight earned runs in 7½ innings, with just two K’s. Do. Not. Trust.

9. The other recently returned regular, Trevor Story, has been a help on offense, with seven hits in 16 at-bats, including a walkoff single in the 10th inning Monday against the Mariners. But at shortstop, he looks like he should be playing second base. Where has his fastball gone?

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CALEB BOWLIN/GETTY IMAGES

Taylor Townsend exulted after setting up a fourth-round meeting with Aryna Sabalenka.

US OPEN

Williams sisters lose in doubles

Collapse dooms comeback

By Brian Mahoney

ASSOCIATED PRESS

NEW YORK — Serena and Venus Williams were once again the main attraction at the US Open. Carlos Alcaraz sure wasn’t going to miss it.

“I think there is no better plan [than] to watch the doubles, the Williamses once again, while getting a treatment,” the defending men’s champion said after winning his match. “I’m going to be ready for that.”

The match was a thriller, with the sisters battling back to force a 10-point match tiebreaker, but blowing a 5-0 lead and losing, 6-3, 6-7 (6-8), 7-6 (10-7), Friday night to Hao-Ching Chan and Maya Joint.

It was their first US Open match since 2022 at the Grand Slam tournament the sisters won twice. They battled back from 4-1 down in the third set to tie it, but then faltered late in front of disappointed fans desperately rooting them on.

“I think the crowd is pretty much what we expected. We expected a full stadium, everyone cheering for them, which, pretty much was that,” Joint said. “But the atmosphere is something that, yeah, it’s super special. Not really going to get again with many other players.”

Serena came back to tennis this year at 44. Venus has continued to play on tour at 46.

Perhaps it was their ages, could have been Serena’s long layoff, or maybe it was nerves. But both double-faulted during the tiebreaker after they had played so brilliantly late in the third set and then in the first few points.

The US Tennis Association said the sisters would not be available for comment.

Earlier, Alcaraz won easily, but two-time defending champion Aryna Sabalenka was finally challenged — by her opponent and by the smell of marijuana — in her victory.

Sabalanka beat Kamilla Rakhimova, 6-3, 6-4. The No. 1 seed was pushed in a second set that lasted 54 minutes — a minute longer than her entire previous match.

Trying to become the first player to win three straight US Open titles since Serena Williams from 2012-14, Sabalenka will face Taylor Townsend in the round of 16.

Alcaraz returned to the round of 16 by beating Wu Yibing, 6-3, 6-4, 6-1. Back for this tournament after missing four months because of a right wrist injury, the two-time champion will face No. 20 seed Tommy Paul, who edged No. 15 Alexander Bublik in five sets.

Sabalanka was serving in the third game of her match in Louis Armstrong Stadium when she tossed the ball but then let it fall to the court. She did the same thing on the next point, with something clearly bothering her.

She then approached the chair umpire to ask for help because she smelled marijuana.

“I was like, guys, you can do whatever, you can smoke whatever, you can relax as much as you can, but please, do not do it around the tennis courts,” Sabalenka said, when asked what she was thinking at the time. “It’s a bit tricky to handle that smell while you’re trying to compete at your best.”

Pegula, the No. 3 seed, fought back to beat 2021 runner-up Leylah Fernandez, 1-6, 6-4, 6-3. Pegula, who lost to Sabalenka in the 2024 final and again last year in the semifinals, put only 5 of 16 first serves in during the first set.

Pegula advanced to face Sorana Cirstea, the 36-year-old from Romania who is contemplating retirement after this season. Townsend reached the round of 16 for the second straight year by knocking off No. 15 seed Diana Shnaider, 6-2, 6-7 (3-7), 6-3 and seemed eager for the matchup with Sabalenka.

“I’m so excited. I feel like I thrive in these moments,” the American said. “I’m built for these moments and so now is my time.”

SportsLog

Simmons returns with Kings

SOCCER

Late goal lifts Legacy

The Legacy managed more late magic on Friday night, **Aleigh Gambone’s** diving header in the 86th minute good for a 2-1 win over the contending Royals in Sandy, Utah. Boston (6-12-5, 23 points) had been a defensive disaster of late, allowing 15 goals in losing four straight matches. Utah (12-8-3, 39 points) hardly seemed the team it would turn that around against — its 40 goals are tied for the most in the NWSL. Instead, the Legacy took an 11th-minute lead through leading scorer **Afssata Traoré**, held Utah to just nine shots, and scored the second road win in franchise history.

Madrid, PSG are surprised

Real Madrid and Paris Saint-Germain were dealt their first losses in their domestic soccer leagues when **Kylian Mbappé** had an injury-time penalty saved in La Liga and PSG coughed up a lead in Ligue 1. Madrid fell at Real Betis, 1-0, for its first defeat since the return of coach **Jose Mourinho**. PSG fell at home to Monaco, 2-1, on the same day that coach **Lu-is Enrique** agreed to stay at the European champion through 2030.

COLLEGES

Court says IU duo can play

Indiana will have two starting defensive linemen from its national championship team, **Stephen Daley** and **Kellan Wyatt**, on the field Saturday for its opener against North Texas following a court ruling Friday night. **Kara Krothe** of the Monroe Circuit Court in Bloomington issued a temporary restraining order barring the NCAA and its conferences from prohibiting any of the case’s seven plaintiffs from competing in Division 1 athletics in 2026-27. Daley and Wyatt each were granted a fifth year of eligibility in a previous court decision. Neither player was drafted and neither signed with a pro football team as undrafted rookies.

MISCELLANY

Buium gets new contract

The Canucks signed defenseman **Zeev Buium** to an eight-year contract extension worth \$9.38 million a season. The 20-year-old offensive-minded defender was acquired from Minnesota in December in the blockbuster trade that sent **Quinn Hughes** to the Wild . . . **Wout van Aert** won his fourth career stage at the Vuelta a Espana in Loja, while **Enric Mas** kept the red jersey . . . Alpine’s **Pierre Gasly** was stripped of his third-place finish at the Monaco Grand Prix and **Isack Hadjar** reinstated to third position, the FIA’s International Court of Appeal ruled.

Roster moves not O’Brien’s ideal

► **BC FOOTBALL**
Continued from Page C1

about 44 percent of all newcomers this season were transfers, and 40 programs had transfers account for at least half of their new players — including freshmen and walk-ons.

Losing 54 players after a 2-10 season — 26 of them transfers — forced Boston College to become one of those programs.

The result is a locker room with more than 40 percent new faces for the second straight season. The Eagles made 53 additions this season, 28 of them transfers.

“I don’t think we want to live in a world of bringing in 20-plus transfers every year,” O’Brien said at the ACC Kick-off in July. “I felt like we had to do that based on who left the program, who graduated, all that. I just felt like that’s something we had to do.

“I think eventually starting this coming year, you want to be about 75 percent high school recruiting, bring these guys in, develop them, watch them grow over two, three, four years and get better as players, and then maybe 25 percent portal. You never want it to be 50/50. But we’ll have to see how it goes.”

Of the 138 FBS teams, only 13 had transfers account for 25 percent or less of their newcomers. Three were Army, Navy, and Air Force — service academies where transfers are rare.

Stanford was the only Atlantic Coast Conference program at or below O’Brien’s preferred threshold, bringing in 32 newcomers but just six transfers.

As the transfer portal has evolved since its introduction in 2018, roster continuity looks starkly different from even five years ago.

O’Brien praised Indiana for its continuity after the Hoosiers won the national championship in January.

But that team was built after losing 23 transfers and bringing in 24. Even after winning the title last season, Indiana lost 12 transfers and brought in 17.

Players are leaving winning teams and losing teams alike.

Seeing 20 players leave Georgia State after a 1-11 season might not be surprising, but Miami lost the same amount after winning 13 games.

After a second straight losing season under coach Mike Norvell, Florida State lost 61 players. Thirty-six transferred — by far the most of any ACC school.

Cal finished 7-6 last season, then essentially went shopping around the country to replace 52 players it lost. The Bears brought in 32 transfers.

In the wake of former Patriots coach Bill Belichick’s 4-8 first season at North Carolina, the Tar Heels lost 59 players, including 25 transfers.

Even after a 9-4 season and three straight bowl appearances under coach Jeff Brohm, Louisville lost 65 players, including 22 transfers.

Boston College’s 26 transfer exits ranked seventh in the conference, tied with California and Louisville. Its 28 transfer additions ranked fourth in the conference behind Louisville (34), California (32), and Virginia (30).

As recently as 2022, the Eagles lost 15 players who transferred to other programs, but they brought in only five transfers and otherwise filled the void through conventional recruiting.

Four years later, the landscape has changed.

“The whole era that we’re in, you can’t retain everybody,” O’Brien said. “You just can’t pay everybody. So you have to do the best job you can of wishing those guys the

best that did leave.”

Newcomers comprise 43.1 percent of the Eagles’ roster this year — another historic spike for the school, but relatively compared with their ACC and national peers. The greater challenge to O’Brien’s philosophy may be that BC already has had to replace several players his staff added just a year earlier.

Eight players on the 2025 roster — Dylan Loneragan, Semaj Fleming, Shaker Reisig, Stevie Amar, Sterling Sanders, Omarion Davis, Jayden Fry, and Ty Lockwood — transferred after just one season.

Six were freshmen. All eight were brought in by O’Brien and his staff.

“In this day and age of college football when guys leave, you have to be able to replace experience with experience,” O’Brien said. “It’s hard to replace a guy who leaves that’s very experienced with a rookie. It’s hard to do that. So hopefully we can get that back to where it’s more of high school recruiting because that’s what BC’s really been built on. But again, we have to do what’s best for the team every year.”

In just two recruiting cycles, O’Brien is confronting how difficult it may be to execute his ideal recruiting philosophy in a landscape defined by constant player movement.

“I think it’s more the reality of what we’re in,” O’Brien said in January. “Some guys decided to leave. And I wish all those guys the best. There was not one guy that left that was, what you’d say is a bad departure.

“But at the end of the day, they decided to leave. We had to replace them . . . So I think it was more of a necessity relative to where we were at the end of the season.”

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HIGH SCHOOL CROSS-COUNTRY NOTEBOOK

Racing for greatness

Cambridge boys chasing first state title in 35 years

By **Matty Wasserman**
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Leon Ibanez-Fraile remembers the first time he saw **Thomas Dewitt** run.

It was Oct. 6, 2024. Ibanez-Fraile and many of his Cambridge cross-country teammates were volunteering at the Cambridge Fall Classic 5K, an annual community road race.

That’s when they spotted Dewitt blazing past older runners. In a race with 2,898 participants, Dewitt placed 15th in 16 minutes, 54 seconds.

“We were like, ‘Wow, this guy is really, really good,’” recalled Ibanez-Fraile. “We went up to him after and were like, ‘How old are you?’”

He was 13.

Two years later, Ibanez-Fraile, a senior, and Dewitt, a sophomore, have formed a close training partnership and one of the state’s premier 1-2 punches.

Both finished in the top 20 at last year’s All-State meet, leading Cambridge to a fifth-place finish in Division 1. With the Falcons’ top five runners returning, the team opens the season at No. 1 in the Globe’s Top 20 boys’ cross-country rankings.

“[Adding Thomas] is one of the things I’m most thankful for in this world,” said Ibanez-Fraile. “Having someone who is so talented and so young just kind of pop up has been really, really helpful. We mutually push each other, and we make each other better.”

Like Dewitt last season, Ibanez-Fraile was thrust into a big role as a freshman in 2023, earning a top-seven spot on a veteran Falcons squad that placed fourth in Division 1.

Cambridge took a step back in 2024, but the potent class of 2027 began to take shape around Ibanez-Fraile. **Liam Eldridge**, **Kieran Eichler**, and **James Selvittella** emerged as key contributors.

“We always knew that their senior season was going to be really special if they could all kind of keep it together and be in the right place,” said coach **Ian Woodhouse**. “Leon’s been competitive at the state level for a while now, and I think they all kind of just took their time to catch up to him.”

The arrival of Dewitt last fall immediately elevated the program’s ceiling. He broke the school’s freshman 5K record in his debut at the Bay State Invitational (15:55.2) and finished 17th at All-States (16:12), the highest finish of any underclassman in the state.

Dewitt has excelled ever since he joined Cambridge’s middle school track program in sixth grade, but handling the pressure of major high school meets was a learning process.

“The goal this year is really trying to not put as much pressure on myself as I did last season,” said Dewitt. “I feel like now that I’ve gone through not just cross-country, but indoor and outdoor track as well, I actually have the mental skills. It’s not so much the physical fitness, but the mental skills that make the difference.”

Ibanez-Fraile and Dewitt both consider themselves highly aerobic runners who thrive on

training with fast tempo runs, which they typically complete at the same pace.

In addition to the six days they practice or compete in team-based activities each week, Ibanez-Fraile and Dewitt have begun meeting up on Sundays for a recovery run.

“They’re taking the attitude that there’s not too many races that they think they shouldn’t win,” said Woodhouse. “As they go through the season, they’ll see if that shakes out or not. But it’s really about working on putting yourself in position to be as far up to the front as you can, and they’ve done that.”

Cambridge perennially fields strong boys’ and girls’ cross-country programs, but last won a state championship in 1991.

With four seniors in the lineup, the runners know the opportunity in front of them.

“It’s quite exciting to know that we have everyone returning,” said Ibanez-Fraile. “Everyone on the team supports each other, knowing that all of us are really talented. It’s really exciting that we can push each other forward.”

Hitting the trails

■ After flying under the radar en route to the program’s first Division 2 title in 2024, the Westwood girls encountered heightened expectations last season — both internally and externally.

The Wolverines fell just shy of a repeat bid, an unbeaten regular season followed by finishing third at both the Division 2A race and Division 2 All-States.

But with its top five runners returning, Westwood knows it once again has championship potential.

Seniors **Susannah Rockers**, **Hailey Cashman**, **Elyse Boger**, and **Cara Sullivan** will headline the squad, along with junior **Ryan Colleran** and numerous depth pieces.

“We were humbled a little, but we also matured,” said Westwood coach **Jen Teahan**. “I think it’s a gift now, because we want it, but we also understand the big picture of what it takes to get there.”

■ Lexington and Billerica enter the season firmly atop the girls’ Division 1 hierarchy, but Newton North also brings back significant talent.

The Tigers, who won the Bay State Conference and placed third at All-States last season, return four of their top five finishers and feature strong depth on their 52-deep roster.

North is led by seniors **Esty Dudnik** and **Maggie Abely**, both of whom finished in the top 20 at All-States. Other key pieces include sophomore **Casey Costello** and senior **Adelle Dupere**.

During track season, Dudnik is a 2-miler and Abely excels in the 800, with each notching top-10 finishes at the Division 1 outdoor championship.

“They each bring different strengths during the track seasons, and we’ve really tried to lean into those over the past year,” said Newton North coach **Joanna Mantell**. “Cross-country is where they meet in the middle and form a great partnership.”

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Super 8 doesn’t solve everything

ON HIGH SCHOOL SPORTS

Continued from Page C1

In the last 35 years, we had it for hockey, then baseball, then things went on hiatus. In 2027, it will be introduced in baseball, football, boys’ hockey, and girls’ hockey.

Now chosen algorithmically, the Super 8 is described by several MIAA committee members as a good start. It’s more of an ongoing thing, not unlike an old coach changing their defensive scheme a few times over a career.

Entering this new era, the same idea applies: lop off the elite schools that win the most, and let the rest of the best have at it. It’s a compromise that has worked, and should work again.

It’s also a lot of fun when a public school wins the whole thing.

Why now? In Division 1 football, publics have won three of the last 12 state championships. The outliers: Springfield Central in 2021, and Everett in 2016 and 2017.

Last year in football, Xaverian and CM were the only two private schools to win state titles; the other six champions were public. Both would have been Super 8 teams had it been in place.

Across all MIAA sports last year, private schools won 19 of 127 state titles. All but four of those were in Division 1, giving private schools nearly half (15 of 33) of all of the D1 share.

That is a huge slice of the pie when considering that statewide, according to the MIAA’s membership information, 342 public schools and 39 private schools compete in all sports. And that private and parochial schools are already playing up one classification spot.

Barring some major push, the MIAA won’t create separate public and private state tournaments. Executives point to this: The organization follows its membership. If the private schools wanted their own tournament, or enough publics suggested they should have one, it would be up for debate.

Nationally, a handful of states — Texas and Maine among them — separate public and private on the field. The last time the idea of splitting the state tournaments in Massachusetts made it to a vote was the mid-1980s, thanks to the efforts of the Middlesex League.

But the debate rages on. Alabama decided earlier this year that, after 104 years of everyone under one tent, the public and private schools should have their own tournaments. The Pennsylvania legislature is debating the same idea.

In Nevada, an entire county of football teams declared themselves independent rather than be forced to play national powerhouse Bishop Gorman, a private school that has won 17 of the last 18 state titles — the last three by a combined 169-25 score. A similar scene played out in central New York last spring, where five large schools dropped out of their league to avoid three-time defending state champion Christian Brothers Academy.

Massachusetts introducing the Super 8 in football won’t solve the overall competitive disparity issue, but it could make the playoffs more exciting.

“This is a step in the right direction. What would be the next step? It’s not easy for me to prognosticate that at all,” MIAA associate executive director Richard Pearson said. “It’s the best step forward right now. Let’s see what it looks like.”

As for the other MIAA business recently decided, I’m not crying foul over the reduction of the playoff field from 16 teams in a division to eight. I feel more strongly about consolation games, in that I was glad to see them cut from two to one.

If we’re going to play, let’s make it mean something.

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Schools

GOLF	
BOYS BI-COUNTY	
Franklin Cty. 146.....Mohawk Trail 200	McCann Tech 167.....Pioneer Valley 189
HOCKMOCK	
King Philip 150.....	Oliver Ames 157
MID-WACH	
Bromfield 170.....	Quabbin 181
SUBURBAN	
Chicopee 170.....	Chicopee Comp. 230
Chicopee Comp. 170.....	S. Hadley 184
NONLEAGUE	
Rockport 155.....	Danvers 149
Tantasqua 150.....	Shepherd Hill 166

■ For updated scores and highlights, go to bostonglobe.com/sports/high-schools.

Latest Line

COLLEGE FOOTBALL		
Saturday		
Favorite	Pts.	Underdog
At W. Virginia.....	21	Coastal Carolina
At Alabama.....	28	East Carolina
At Jas. Madison.....	6	Liberty
At Indiana.....	40½	North Texas
At Nebraska.....	23½	Ohio
At Houston.....	21	Oregon St.
At Ohio State.....	50½	Ball State
At Pittsburgh.....	16½	Miami (Ohio)
At Penn State.....	23½	Marshall
At Texas.....	29½	Texas State
At Duke.....	13½	Tulane
Oklahoma St.....	72	at Tulsa
At Iowa.....	31½	No. Illinois
At Colorado St.....	3	Wyoming
At Memphis.....	11	Arkansas St.
At S. Florida.....	14½	Fla. International
At Texas A&M.....	40½	Missouri St.
At Troy.....	16½	Sam Houston
At LSU.....	10	Clemson
At Miss. St.....	28½	La.-Monroe
At Michigan.....	27½	W. Michigan
At Florida.....	26½	Fla. Atlantic
At New Mexico.....	10½	Central Mich.
UNLV.....	3	at Hawaii
UCLA.....	2½	at California
At Nevada.....	1½	Western Ky.
Sunday		
At Washington.....	23	Washington St.
At Mississippi.....	6½	Louisville
At Notre Dame.....	20½	Wisconsin
Monday		
SMU.....	3	at Florida St.

College football

FRIDAY’S RESULTS	
EAST	
At Marist 27.....	Franklin Pierce 18
SOUTH	
At Georgia St. 59.....	NC A&T 10
MIDWEST	
San Jose St. 27.....	at E. Michigan 21
At Purdue 44.....	Indiana St. 19
At Kansas St. 51.....	LIU Brooklyn 6
At Michigan St. 30.....	Toledo 20
SOUTHWEST	
At Oklahoma St. 51.....	UTEP 0
FAR WEST	
At Southern Cal.....	Fresno St.
Miami.....	At Stanford

Transactions

BASEBALL	
Arizona: CF Jorge Barrosa designated for assignment. SS Tommy Troy recalled from minors rehab. SS Tommy Troy removed from 10-day IL.	
Chi. White Sox: C Drew Romo sent to minors. C Kyle Teel recalled from minors rehab. C Kyle Teel removed from 10-day IL.	
Cincinnati: SS Ivan Johnson sent to minors. LB Michael Toggia transferred to 60-day IL. CF Carlos Jorge purchased from minors.	
Cleveland: P Logan Allen sent to minors. P Austin Peterson, P Daniel Espino called up from minors. P Carlos Hernández designated for assignment. P Colin Holderman placed on 15-day IL. P Slade Cecconi removed from 15-day IL. P Slade Cecconi recalled from minors rehab.	
Colorado: P Hayden Harris sent to minors. P Hayden Harris acquired off waivers.	
Houston: P Bryan King called up from minors. P Steven Okert placed on 15-day IL.	
Kansas City: CF Drew Waters outrighted to minors.	
Pittsburgh: P Braden Elsert sent to minors. P Isaac Mattson called up from minors. CF Kyler Fedko signed to a minor league contract. C Christian Bethancourt designated for assignment. SS Konnor Griffin removed from 60-day IL. SS Konnor Griffin recalled from minors rehab.	
San Francisco: C Joel Kuhnel acquired off waivers. C Jesus Rodríguez transferred to 60-day IL.	
Seattle: P Troy Taylor called up from minors. P Hoby Milner placed on bereavement/family medical emergency list.	
St. Louis: P Ryan Fernandez sent to minors. P Andre Pallante removed from 15-day IL.	
Tampa Bay: P Alex Cook called up from minors. P Shane McClanahan placed on 15-day IL.	
Toronto: P Ricky Tiedemann sent to minors. RF Daz Cameron outrighted to minors. P Jameson Taillon removed from 15-day IL. P Jameson Taillon recalled from minors rehab.	
Washington: P Max Kranick designated for assignment. P Tom Cosgrove outrighted to minors. P Jack Sinclair purchased from minors.	

NBA	
Brooklyn: Center Grant Nelson signed as free agent.	
NFL	
Atlanta: LB Bralen Trice pract. squad add. LB Khalid Kareem pract. squad add.	
Buffalo: LB Demetrius Flannigan-Fowles off IR. LB Demetrius Flannigan-Fowles cut.	
Chicago: WR Ray-Ray McCloud III off IR. WR Ray-Ray McCloud III cut.	
Kansas City: G C.J. Hanson, QB Chris Oladokun, RB EJ Smith off IR. G C.J. Hanson, QB Chris Oladokun, RB EJ Smith cut.	
Las Vegas: WR Chase Roberts off IR. WR Chase Roberts cut. WR Ronnie Bell, T Evan Neal, LB Azeez Ojulari pract. squad add. DE Jahfari Harvey, T Kamar Missouri, TE Albert Okwegbun Jr. pract. squad del.	
LA Chargers: LB Kyle Kennard off IR. LB Kyle Kennard cut.	
Minnesota: LB Jacob Roberts off IR. LB Jacob Roberts cut.	
Washington: DE T.J. Maguranyanga off IR. DE T.J. Maguranyanga cut.	

NHL	
Anaheim: G Devon Bobak signed as free agent.	
Chicago: G Jackson Bernard signed as free agent.	
Columbus: G Reid Robertson signed as free agent.	
Dallas: G Jack Williams signed as free agent.	

Men's singles Third Round	
Daniil Medvedev (7), def. Arthur Rinderknech (26), 6-4, 6-4, 6-4;	
Tommy Paul (20), def. Alexander Bublik (15), 6-4, 3-6, 6-7 (4), 6-1, 6-3;	
Carlos Alcaraz (2), def. Yibing Wu, 6-3, 6-4, 6-1; Stefanos Tsitsipas, def. Jiri Lehecka (18), 2-6, 6-1, 7-6 (3), 6-1;	
Tomas Martin Etcheverry (27), def. Mariano Navone, 6-4, 6-3; Alex Michelsen, def. Daniel Merino (76), 6-4, 6-3; Frances Tiafoe (11), def. Valentin Vacherot (22), 6-4, 6-2, 6-4.	

Women's singles Third Round	
Aryna Sabalenka (1), def. Kamilla Rakhimova, 6-3, 6-4; Marta Kostyuk (11), def. Ekaterina Alexandrova (18), 6-3, 6-2; Sorana Cirstea (16), def. Jasmine Paolini (19), 6-3, 6-3; Jessica Pegula (3), def. Leylah Fernandez (31), 1-6, 6-4, 6-3;	
Taylor Townsend, def. Diana Shnaur (15), 6-2, 6-7 (3), 6-3; Emma Navarro (26), def. Karolina Muchova (7), 6-3, 7-5; Linda Noskova (6), def. Ann Li (29), 6-2, 6-7 (6), 6-2;	
Anna Kalinskaya (21), def. Elina Svitolina (9), 6-3, 2-6, 6-3.	

Scoreboard

	SAT 9/5	SUN 9/6	MON 9/7	TUE 9/8	WED 9/9	THU 9/10	FRI 9/11
	BAL 7:05 NESN	BAL 1:35 NESN	LAA 1:35 NESN	LAA 6:45 NESN	LAA 6:45 NESN		KC 7:10 NESN
						SEA 8:20 NBC	
	LA 9:30 Apple TV					NYC 8:00* Apple TV	
							

Home games shaded

On the radio, unless noted: Red Sox, WEEI-FM 93.7; Patriots and Revolution, WBZ-FM 98.5. * — WBZ-FM 98.5-HD2.

ON THE AIR

AUTO RACING

7:30 p.m. O'Reilly: Fleetio 200 CW

BASEBALL

4:10 p.m. Chicago Cubs at Miami MLB

6 p.m. Double-A: Reading at Hartford NESN+

7:05 p.m. Boston at Baltimore NESN

7:15 p.m. NY Yankees at San Diego Fox

COLLEGE FOOTBALL

12 p.m. Bryant at Army CBSSN

12 p.m. Coastal Carolina at West Virginia TNT

12 p.m. East Carolina at Alabama ABC

12 p.m. Liberty at James Madison ESPNU

12 p.m. North Texas at Indiana Fox

12 p.m. Ohio at Nebraska FS1

12 p.m. Oregon St. at Houston ESPN

12 p.m. Stonehill at New Haven NESN+

12 p.m. UNH at Syracuse ACC

12:30 p.m. Ball State at Ohio State Big Ten

12:30 p.m. Miami (Ohio) at Pittsburgh CW

12:45 p.m. Kent State at South Carolina SEC

3:30 p.m. Baylor at Auburn ABC

3:30 p.m. Boise St. at Oregon CBS

3:30 p.m. BC at Cincinnati Fox

3:30 p.m. Marshall at Penn State FS1

3:30 p.m. Texas State at Texas ESPN

3:30 p.m. Towson at Navy CBSSN

3:30 p.m. Tulane at Duke ACC

3:45 p.m. Oklahoma St. at Tulsa ESPNU

4:15 p.m. No. Illinois at Iowa Big Ten

4:15 p.m. North Alabama at Arkansas SEC

6 p.m. Wyoming at Colorado St. USA

7 p.m. Abilene Christian at Texas Tech FS1

7 p.m. Idaho St. at Utah State CBSSN

7 p.m. Missouri St. at Texas A&M ESPN

7:30 p.m. Clemson at LSU ABC

7:30 p.m. La.-Monroe at Mississippi St. ESPNU

7:30 p.m. VMI at Virginia Tech ACC

7:30 p.m. W. Michigan at Michigan NBC

7:45 p.m. Fla. Atlantic at Florida SEC

8 p.m. Hampton at Maryland Big Ten

9:30 p.m. Portland St. at San Diego St. USA

10 p.m. Central Mich. at New Mexico FS1

10 p.m. UNLV at Hawaii CW

10:30 p.m. UCLA at California ESPN

10:30 p.m. Western Ky. at Nevada CBSSN

GOLF

6:30 a.m. DP World: European Masters CNBC

9 a.m. Walker Cup Golf

3 a.m. (Sun.) Walker Cup Golf

HORSE RACING

4 p.m. Nashville Derby NBC

SOCCER

7:30 a.m. Premier: Bournemouth at Newcastle USA

9:55 a.m. English: Bristol City at Burnley CBSSN

10 a.m. Premier: Coventry City at Man City USA

10 a.m. Premier: Tottenham at Nottingham NBCSN

12 p.m. Serie A: Napoli at Inter Milan CBS

12:30 p.m. Bundesliga: Bayern Munich at Schalke USA

12:30 p.m. Premier: Aston Villa at Hull City NBC

6:30 p.m. NWSL: Angel City at Louisville Ion

9:30 p.m. MLS: New England at LA Galaxy AppleTV

TENNIS

11 a.m. US Open ESPN2

7 p.m. US Open ESPN2

■ For updates, go to bostonglobe.com/tvlistings

Soccer

MLS

FRIDAY’S RESULT

Nashville 0..... at NYFC 0

SATURDAY’S GAMES

New England at LA Galaxy.....9:30

Colorado at Columbus.....7:30

Chicago at Toronto.....7:30

Montreal at Philadelphia.....7:30

San Diego FC at Orlando.....7:30

D.C. United at Cincinnati.....7:30

Atlanta at Miami.....7:30

Houston at Charlotte.....7:30

Spokane at Dallas.....8:30

NY Red Bulls at Seattle.....8:30

San Jose at Austin.....8:30

LAFc at Real Salt Lake.....9:30

St. Louis at Vancouver.....9:30

Minnesota at Portland.....10:30

NWSL

FRIDAY’S RESULTS

Remembered

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BY CITY AND TOWN

ARLINGTON LANDERS, John Gregory Jr.	WEYMOUTH SMITH, Richard W.
BOSTON CONCANNON, Anne Naomi LANDERS, John Gregory Jr.	OUT OF STATE
MARLBOROUGH KELLEIGH, Catherine Solenberger	MAINE CONCANNON, Anne Naomi
NATICK WADNESS, Gerald H.	NEW YORK SMITH, Richard W.
WAYLAND KELLEIGH, Catherine Solenberger	

CONCANNON, Anne Naomi



Age 82, passed away peacefully, at her home in Cape Neddick, Maine, on August 31, 2026, surrounded by her three children. Naomi was born in Boston, Massachusetts, on September 4, 1943, to William J. and Anna M. (Fitzgerald) Mulkern. A Celebration of Naomi's Life will be held at First Parish Cemetery, in York, ME, on Thursday, September 10, 2026, at 11:30 a.m. For a full obituary, visit www.lucaseatonfuneralhome.com

KELLEIGH, Catherine Solenberger

Age 97, born in Winchester VA, passed away peacefully, on Sunday, August 23, 2026, in Troy ID, with family at her side. She is survived by her children, Beatrice Kelleigh of Seattle, WA, Catherine Kelleigh (Dan Ostman) of Troy ID, Stanley Kelleigh (Lori Kelleigh) of Liberty, MO, and Nancy Rausher (Mark Donovan) of Worcester, MA; eight grandchildren and 13 great-grandchildren. She was preceded in death by her children, John Kelleigh, Elizabeth (Betsy) Olson and Hugh Kelleigh; and her brothers, John Solenberger and Robert Solenberger. A private family service will be held at a later date.

LANDERS, John Gregory "Jack" Jr.



Born January 12, 1954, in Chelsea, MA, passed away at home, in Boston, on August 28, 2026.

Jack was the beloved husband of Anne FitzGerald for 42 years. Their story began on a beach in Evanston, IL, in 1978. For Anne it was love at first sight. Together, they built a wonderful life. Jack was an incredible father and hero to his children, Luke and Daisy. He was a proud and loving grandfather to Jack, Vivian and Jay, who affectionately called him "Big Jack." He treasured time with his grandchildren and they adored every moment spent playing and laughing together. Jack grew up in Arlington, MA, with his four sisters, Marie, Beth, Jean and Janet. He attended the College of the Holy Cross, where he played football and formed friendships and memories that stayed with him over the years. He graduated in 1976, then began working at Norton Company, later Saint-Gobain, where he remained throughout his career. Jack was a devoted husband, father, grandfather, brother, uncle and loyal friend. He will be deeply missed and lovingly remembered by all who were fortunate enough to know him. His family will always be grateful to the Dana-Farber caregivers who gave Jack hope, compassionate care and lovingly guided him to peace. A Wake and time of reflection will be held on September 10, 10:00 a.m. to 12:00 p.m., at DeVito Funeral Home, 1145 Mass Ave., ARLINGTON, MA. In lieu of flowers, the family requests that donations be made to Dana-Farber Cancer Institute, in memory of Jack Landers, to support Dr. Marlise Luskin's Research Fund, Dana-Farber Cancer Institute, P.O. Box 849168, Boston, MA 02284.



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Life Book memoirs

SMITH, Richard W. Jr.



Of Weymouth, originally from Staten Island, NY, passed away on August 27, 2026, at the age of 79. He was the beloved husband of the late Mary Jane Sullivan Smith. He was born in New York City, on December 4, 1946, to the late Richard W. Smith, Sr. and Mary Gloria (Cooke) Smith.

Richard graduated from Xaverian High School in Brooklyn, NY, Marquette University in Milwaukee, WI and Western Carolina University in Cullowhee, NC. He was a local business owner, working for many years as an investment counselor. He was incredibly dedicated to his faith and was an active member of St. Francis Xavier Parish. He also served as a volunteer with the Metropolitan Tribunal of the Archdiocese of Boston. He found much strength and comfort in his faith and church community.

Richard had a lifelong love of sports, from playing and coaching basketball and baseball, to being an avid golfer and enjoying swimming. He also enjoyed spending time with his family and many friends, especially cherishing his time in Hulets Landing on Lake George. As a natural storyteller, Richard loved regaling others with tales, both old and new, to anyone willing to listen. He was an avid reader of history books and enjoyed sharing his latest discoveries with others. He will be remembered for his sense of humor and his unyielding support to others.

Richard is survived by his children, Deirdre Smith and her husband, CJ Congrove of Tiverton, Rhode Island and his son, Patrick Smith of Vermont. He was predeceased by his daughter, Shannon Smith. He is also survived by his younger siblings, Margaret Hamilton, Colleen Giddings, Michael Smith, Kevin Smith and Gregory Smith.

Relatives and friends are invited to attend Visiting Hours on Tuesday, September 8, from 4:00 to 7:00 p.m., at C.C. Shepherd Funeral Home, 134 Pleasant Street, WEYMOUTH.

A Funeral Mass will be celebrated on Wednesday, September 9, at 10:00 a.m., at St. Francis Xavier Church, 234 Pleasant Street, Weymouth. Burial will follow at St. Francis Xavier Cemetery, 726 Washington Street, Weymouth.

WADNESS, Gerald H.

Age 88, of Natick, Sept. 3, 2026. Beloved husband of Margery (Geri) Wadness. Dear son of Julius and Rose (Starr) Wadness. Devoted father of Michael Wadness and his wife, Cindy, Amy Wadness Welch and her husband, Bill. Dear grandfather of Molly, Julia, and Robert Welch, and Ezra and Levi Wadness. Loving brother of Naomi Wadness Lerman. Graveside Service Sunday, Sept. 6, 2026 at 10:30 am at Framingham Natick Hebrew Cemetery, 40 Windsor Ave., Natick. Shiva will be at the home of Geri Wadness on Sunday, Monday, and Tuesday from 2:00-4:00 pm and 7:00-9:00 pm. In lieu of flowers, remembrances in his memory may be made to Natick Service Council, A Place to Turn, Natick or Friends of the Natick Library. For complete obituary, please visit www.brezniakfd.com

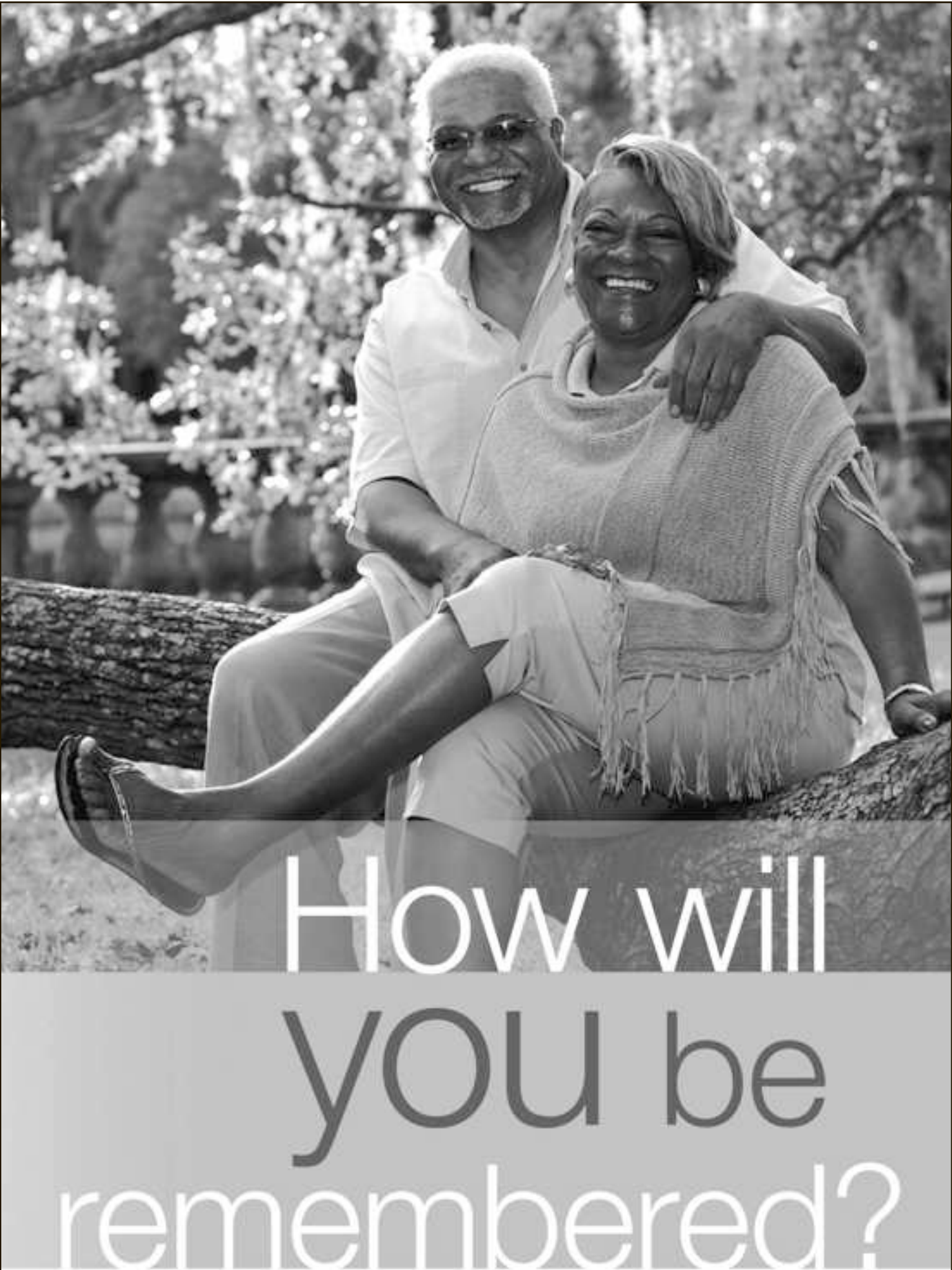


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Obituaries

Gene Bertoncini, 89; jazz guitarist dazzled with subtlety

By Will Friedwald
NEW YORK TIMES

Gene Bertoncini, a prolific jazz guitarist celebrated for his bountiful lyricism and driving swing, for accompanying celebrated singers including Tony Bennett and Lena Horne, and for performances and arrangements that blurred the line between jazz and classical music, died last Saturday at the Actors Fund Home in Englewood, N.J. He was 89.

His niece Nina Collins confirmed the death.

Throughout a career that began in a duo with his older brother, Renny, an accordionist, playing in restaurants and catering halls near their childhood home in the Bronx, N.Y., Mr. Bertoncini was heralded as a sensitive accompanist and innovative leader.

In a sideman role, he worked with many of the greatest jazz singers of the 20th century, including Bennett, Horne, and Nancy Wilson, and with instrumentalists as varied as Benny Goodman, Wayne Shorter, and Michel Legrand.

As a bandleader, Mr. Bertoncini forged a groundbreaking partnership with bass virtuoso Michael Moore that, over roughly 15 years and six albums, was credited by The New Yorker's jazz critic Whitney Balliett with redefining the concept of the jazz duo.

He praised the Bertoncini-Moore duet, one of the first and most enduring guitar-bass duos in jazz, for “brevity, gracefulness and subtlety” that is “harmonically up-to-date and acoustically old-fashioned,” featuring arrangements by Mr. Bertoncini that “point up the melodic beauties of its repertoire.”

Mr. Bertoncini was equally at home with the Great American Songbook, the European classical repertoire, and, in advance of his fellow jazz guitarists, Brazilian works in the bossa nova style composed by such colleagues as Antonio Carlos Jobim and his close friend João Gilberto.

Mr. Bertoncini was in his early 20s when he played his first major date with a nationally known headliner, Buddy Rich, and passed muster with the notoriously temperamental drummer and bandleader.

“Buddy really liked the way I played rhythm with him,” Mr. Bertoncini said in an interview last year. “He liked that he didn’t have to tell me anything. I was able to lock into the beat with him, which was amazing, because he was such a dominant force.”

In the early 1960s, Mr. Bertoncini found plentiful work in New York studios, not least because his facility with nylon-string classical guitar technique lent itself to bossa nova at a time when few established guitarists could play it.

During those years, he played on Ahmad Jamal’s 1963 album “Macanudo”; formed a trio with pianist Monty Alexan-

By Ishani Desai
and Mark Walker
NEW YORK TIMES

Carla Jeffery, a former child actor who became best known for the cheerful cheerleader Bree in Disney’s “Zombies” films, died Tuesday. She was 33.

Her death was confirmed by her agent, Carla Alexander, in a social media post. She did not specify a cause or say where Ms. Jeffery had died.

Ms. Jeffery spent two decades onscreen, appearing in Disney Channel and Nickelodeon series and playing a recurring role on “Curb Your Enthusiasm.” But she became best known as Bree in the “Zombies” franchise, which introduced a generation of Disney viewers to a high school populated by cheerleaders, zombies, and other supernatural characters.

Carla Jeffery was born July 10, 1993, in Houston. She followed her twin brother, Carlton, into acting after they moved to California. Her brother’s agent, Alexander, soon discovered Ms. Jeffery as well. Ms. Jeffery recalled in an interview with AfterBuzz TV Red Carpets & Interviews, a YouTube channel.



RICHARD TERMINE/NEW YORK TIMES/FILE

Mr. Bertoncini (pictured in New York in 2008) played thousands of studio dates over several decades and was a regular in the “Tonight Show” band until the show moved to Los Angeles.

der and bassist Bob Cranshaw; performed on two albums by the trumpeter Clark Terry; and became a regular in the “Tonight Show” band until that late-night program moved to Los Angeles from New York in 1972. (Mr. Bertoncini said he helped teach the host, Johnny Carson, an amateur guitarist, how to play the jazz standard “Here’s That Rainy Day.”)

Over several decades, Mr. Bertoncini played thousands of studio dates. They included pop hits like B.J. Thomas’s recording of “Raindrops Keep Fallin’ on My Head” and jazz projects, including several dozen albums for producer Creed Taylor’s CTI label, many of which teamed him with bassist Ron Carter. Mr. Bertoncini gave his last major performance in New York, at Mezzrow, with Carter in December.

In a 2008 review of Mr. Bertoncini at Le Madeleine in Manhattan, Ben Ratliff in The New York Times lauded Mr. Bertoncini for an improvisational style that was unshowy, deliberate, and delightful, in a set that mixed jazz standards by Billy Strayhorn and Bill Evans with works by Gilberto and even an aria by Giacomo Puccini.

“He could afford to pause after a phrase and think where he wanted to go next, how he might add or subtract a note,” Ratliff wrote. “This was background music only by virtue of its softness. So long as you listened, you heard a great musician trying to be better.”

Gene Joseph Bertoncini, the younger of two sons, was born in the Bronx on April 6, 1937, to Italian immigrants Mario and Anita (Ori) Bertoncini.

Mario Bertoncini, a waiter who later owned and operated a diner called Joe’s on Third Avenue in Manhattan, also taught his sons to play the music of the old country, with Renate (known as Renny) on accordion and Gene on guitar.

Around the time Gene was 12 and Renny 15, they were regulars on the TV program “The Horn and Hardart Children’s Hour.” While at the NBC studios, Gene first met jazz guitar virtuoso Johnny Smith, who became his first mentor. A few years later, he studied classical technique with the British-born Julian Bream.

Growing up, Mr. Bertoncini also became enamored of jazz guitarists Charlie Christian, an early practitioner of the electric guitar who came to fame in Benny Goodman’s bands, and Oscar Moore, a key member of the Nat King Cole Trio.

At 17, Mr. Bertoncini accepted a scholarship to study architecture at Notre Dame, which seemed like a safer career bet than the itinerant life of a musician. During the five-year program, he also played in student ensembles and directed the school’s swing band.

Upon returning to New York after graduating in 1959, Mr. Bertoncini took an entry-level position in the architecture firm of David Henken, a disciple of Frank Lloyd Wright, and moonlighted in big bands. During a show with a dance band led by Richard Maltby, Mr. Bertoncini later said, he had an epiphany after he hit a wrong note, which was a shock to his system at the time.

“Probably nobody noticed but me, but I couldn’t live with

that,” he said. “I attributed it to the fact that I hadn’t been practicing enough.” He decided to quit his day job and commit full time to the guitar.

The most difficult part was telling his parents, who had supported him through college. Sixty-five years later, he still teared up when he described how his father responded, saying, in Italian, “Son, whatever you want to do, I’ll support you 100 percent.”

Mr. Bertoncini taught at the Eastman School of Music in Rochester, N.Y., for more than 50 years, as well as at William Paterson University in New Jersey and the New England Conservatory of Music in Boston; many of his students became successful professional guitarists, such as Peter Bernstein, Roni Ben-Hur, Paul Meyers, and Paul Ricci.

Mr. Bertoncini also played at every opportunity in guitar duos and trios with Bucky Pizzarelli, whom he considered a mentor and best friend. “They shared the same love of harmony and melody, but each in their own style,” Pizzarelli’s son John said in an interview.

Discographer Glenn Broadhead compiled a listing of 188 known albums featuring Mr. Bertoncini — 32 as leader and 156 as sideman — but even that was far from an exhaustive list, considering the guitarist’s work on thousands of sessions for pop albums and singles, and film and TV soundtracks.

In the jazz world especially, it’s largely acknowledged that Mr. Bertoncini — who never married and left no immediate survivors — influenced legions of guitarists through his music.

Carla Jeffery, actress in Disney’s ‘Zombies’ films, 33



CHRIS PIZZELLO/ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE

Ms. Jeffery (pictured in Los Angeles last year) played a recurring role on “Curb Your Enthusiasm.”

Her twin brother was “the one who really got us started,” Ms. Jeffery said. “I was so shy, but when I started going to acting classes with him, acting seriously just made me feel like a completely different person.” She knew immediately that she loved transforming into another character, she said.

Information on survivors was not immediately available.

Ms. Jeffery’s first film role was in the 2006 comedy “Phat Girlz,” starring Mo’Nique. Ms. Jeffery soon landed a recurring

role in the sixth season of Larry David’s HBO series “Curb Your Enthusiasm.” She played Keysha Black, a child whose family is displaced by a hurricane.

In that season’s first episode, “Meet the Blacks,” from 2007, a welcome party goes awry when David’s friend unknowingly brings a cake from an erotic bakery shaped like male genitalia.

In a 2025 interview on The Tokens podcast, Ms. Jeffery said she found the show’s improvisational format challeng-

ing. “I’m still just a kid,” she said. “So, I’m like, should I just let the grown-ups talk here or what should I do?” She described David as “beyond hilarious.”

Ms. Jeffery made guest appearances on Disney Channel shows including “Good Luck Charlie” and “Shake It Up.”

In 2018, Ms. Jeffery made her debut as Bree, Addison’s best friend, in the first “Zombies” film and returned for two sequels. The hit movies logged nearly 250 million streaming hours on Disney+.

In the podcast interview, she discussed the pressure and responsibility she felt representing plus-size Black women, as well as the gratification of knowing viewers could see themselves in her character. “I’d never thought I’d see myself as somebody’s inspiration,” she said.

It hit home when Disney released costumes based on the franchise and Ms. Jeffery saw young girls dressing as Bree. “You’ve got young Black girls looking up to you,” she said. “That’s what I want to keep doing.”



ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE

Mr. Smith (left) suffered a traumatic brain injury from being beaten as a Freedom Rider in 1961.

Jerome Smith, 87; Freedom Rider who challenged RFK

By Penelope Green
NEW YORK TIMES

Jerome Smith, who, as a young Freedom Rider in 1961, was jailed and beaten for his efforts to desegregate transportation in the South, and who exonerated Attorney General Robert F. Kennedy for not doing enough to protect him and the other riders during that harrowing year, died Aug. 21 at his home in New Orleans. He was 87.

His daughter Farin Smith said the cause was cancer.

When the first Freedom Riders set forth in early May 1961, Mr. Smith was 21 and had dropped out of Southern University in Baton Rouge, La., to devote himself to the Congress of Racial Equality, the civil rights organization known as CORE.

It had been 15 years since the Supreme Court had ruled that segregated seating on interstate buses was unconstitutional. Yet the Southern states had largely ignored the decision. CORE organized a series of Freedom Rides — beginning with teams of Black and white activists who would travel by bus from Washington to New Orleans — to put the ruling to the test, challenging the federal government to finally enforce it.

Mr. Smith — who was stuck in jail in New Orleans, having been arrested after participating in a lunch-counter sit-in — was unable to join the first ride. That journey ended in bloodshed in Alabama, where the young riders were beaten and one bus was firebombed. Senior CORE organizers urged a halt to the rides, but the activists regrouped, and by the end of the month, participants from all over the country were once again heading into the South.

On May 24, Mr. Smith, finally released from jail, boarded a Greyhound bus in Montgomery, Ala., for a ride to Jackson, Miss., where he was promptly arrested. “Breach of peace” was the charge, a coy workaround to flout the law.

Mr. Smith’s second ride was more perilous. On Nov. 29, he and four other CORE members from New Orleans, including 18-year-old Doratha Smith-Simmons, rode a bus to McComb, Miss., a fiercely segregationist community.

The Justice Department had ordered the removal of Jim Crow signs from McComb’s bus terminal. Although the mayor complied, he declared that “our local people are going to respect the color line whether the signs are there or not,” as Raymond Arsenault recounted in “Freedom Riders: 1961 and the Struggle for Racial Justice” (2006).

When Mr. Smith and his group walked into the bus terminal, they were ambushed, beaten with brass knuckles and sticks, and kicked to the pavement outside.

“I thought we would die that day,” Smith-Simmons said in an interview.

Mr. Smith suffered a traumatic brain injury from his beating, and for the rest of his life he was bedeviled by headaches and mood swings. Yet he kept working with CORE, traveling the country to raise funds and going through the rural South to register Black voters.

In May 1963, he was in New York City being treated for his lingering injuries when celebrated Black author James Baldwin invited him to a meeting that Kennedy, the attorney general, had asked Baldwin to organize with other civil rights advocates, including playwright Lorraine

Hansberry, musicians Lena Horne and Harry Belafonte, and actor Rip Torn.

The topic was racial justice in Northern cities. But when Kennedy began to speak about the Justice Department’s efforts, things took a turn.

Mr. Smith began to weep. He angrily declared that he had seen federal forces do little more than stand around as he and his friends were beaten nearly to death. He said that he thought it was hypocritical for the government to ask for his patriotism in supporting the war in Vietnam when it would not protect him and other Black Americans. He added that he would rather die than raise a gun against the Vietnamese people, but that his pacifism was being put to the test at home: He was, he said, “close to the moment where I’m ready to take up a gun.”

Enraged, Kennedy turned away, at which point Hansberry and the others lit into him.

“You’ve got a great many very, very accomplished people in this room, Mr. Attorney General,” she said, as Arthur Schlesinger Jr. reported in “Robert Kennedy and His Times” (1978). “But the only man who should be listened to is that man over there,” meaning Mr. Smith.

The meeting devolved from there. Kennedy seemed incapable of understanding the passion and frustration of the group, and after three hours, the activists left. “They seemed possessed,” Kennedy later told Schlesinger.

But, Schlesinger wrote, Kennedy “began, I believe, to grasp from the inside the nature of Black anguish.”

Mr. Smith said in a 1988 oral history for the Kim Lacy Rogers Collection at Amistad Research Center in New Orleans that the meeting was a pivotal moment for everyone in the room.

“I remember sitting here and Robert Kennedy sitting there,” he recalled, “and seeing him tremble from the impact of what that struggle gave to me to bring to him.”

Jerome Smith was born on May 21, 1939, in New Orleans. His father, Walter Smith, was a merchant seaman. His mother, Leona (Juluke) Smith, was a seamstress who also worked as a domestic.

He came by his activism naturally; his parents practiced a resolute defiance of Jim Crow laws in their daily lives. Mr. Smith liked to tell the story of how, after seeing his father move a “whites only” barrier on a streetcar to claim a seat, he did the same while riding alone one day when he was 10.

He said he was scooped up by an older Black woman who berated him for his foolhardiness — but, once she hustled him off at the next stop, she threw her arms around him and cried, “Don’t you ever stop doing that!”

Later in life, he remained a stickler for racial justice, forbidding his children to recite the Pledge of Allegiance in class because, as his daughter Farin recalled him telling her principal, “My kids will not honor the American flag because the American flag does not honor Black children.”

In addition to Farin Smith, Mr. Smith leaves his daughters Kami and Saidah Smith; his son Jerome Jr.; his brothers, Walter Smith Jr. and Archie Sampier; his companion, Cynthia Thornton; and 11 grandchildren. His sons Juden, Tarik, and Taju Smith predeceased him, as did grandson Tarik Jr. His marriage to Betty Watler ended in divorce.

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More than 1,000 workers at Encore Boston Harbor went on strike at 7 a.m. Friday following months of failed contract negotiations.

Members of two unions at Encore casino in Everett go out on strike

By Karyna Cheung
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

EVERETT — More than 1,000 workers at Encore Boston Harbor went on strike Friday morning, just before the Labor Day weekend began.

Contracts for two unions representing roughly 1,300 employees at the Everett casino expired Monday night, after months of contract negotiations that have seemingly made minimal progress. Earlier this week, they set a strike date of Friday morning, and walked off the job at 7 a.m.

Shortly after, roughly 300 people were crowding the entrance to the casino on Broadway in Everett, preventing cars from moving in and out. Some held handmade signs, beat buckets, and chanted. A Teamsters tractor-trailer circled outside, honking loudly alongside other cars and trucks driving past.

Leadership of UNITE HERE Local 26 and Teamsters Local 25 say their members — who range from housekeepers, cooks, and slot attendants to delivery drivers and grounds staff — are pushing for a \$10 per hour wage increase over three years for non-tipped employees and \$5 per hour for tipped workers, rates they say would bring their pay in line with other unionized hotels downtown. They say Encore has countered them with increases less



than half that much.

“It’s not like we are asking for much,” said Icylyn Whittaker, a groundskeeper and Local 26 shop steward. She said she makes \$31 an hour, and has worked at Encore since they opened. “What we are asking for is the Boston standard.”

Workers also claim Encore is attempting to forgo job security protections and health care benefits established in their previous contract, including measures that ensure a certain number of staff are working on the floor for a given number of hours. They additionally allege the casino resort is pushing to have health care costs come out of wage increases.

Encore, which opened to great

fanfare in 2019, has reiterated a desire for an agreement “grounded in financial reality,” and claims that union workers’ wage growth has outpaced inflation and revenue.

The casino has been subject to growing competition in neighboring states, as well as the rising presence of online sports betting and gaming options. Encore’s profits and revenue have slightly declined since 2024, though its operator, Las Vegas-based Wynn Resorts, is better positioned than many brick-and-mortar casino operators in the gaming industry.

Negotiations began in April, workers say, and official communication has been sporadic throughout the past several months. The unions claim the workers and the casino re-

sort continue to be far from an agreement.

Encore plans to remain open and operational even as hundreds of workers take to picket lines outside.

“We are committed to finding common ground that is fair, financially sustainable, and protects jobs for the long term,” the company said in a recent statement. “And we stand ready to service our guests while we continue negotiations.”

Everett Mayor Robert Van Campen wrote in a statement to the Globe that he “stand[s] with the workers.”

“Encore is an important part of Everett,” Van Campen said. “But so are the people who show up every day and make it successful.”

Some of the picketers, like cocktail server David Hernandez, came straight from their overnight shifts.

“All that we make here stays in the community,” said Hernandez, who lives in Everett and left the furniture industry five years ago to work at the casino. “We’re here to win. We’re asking for a fair demand.”

Union leaders said they expected other labor groups from around Greater Boston to join the picket line later in the day to support the Encore workers.

Karyna Cheung can be reached at karyna.cheung@globe.com.

Springfield mayor, MGM in fight over sale of casino

City sues Vegas operator for breach of agreement

By Jon Chesto
GLOBE STAFF

MGM Resorts says it has a buyer lined up for its Springfield casino — but Mayor Domenic Sarno is getting in the way.

On Thursday, the city of Springfield sued the Las Vegas-based casino operator, arguing that it’s failing to live up to terms in its host community agreement with the city. Among the areas where the city says MGM Springfield is falling short: the number of employees, the amount of games, and the redevelopment of a nearby building.

City officials have been negotiating with MGM for two years over issues raised in the host community agreement. MGM says in response to the lawsuit that the big beef is over the sale of the casino operations (MGM has already sold the casino’s underlying real estate); the host community agreement also gives the city approval power over any transfer of the casino business.

MGM Resorts said Sarno and the city “initiated frivolous litigation to continue to delay its consideration of MGM’s request to approve the proposed sale of its interest in MGM Springfield to a well-qualified casino operator.”

MGM didn’t disclose the potential buyer. The Las Vegas-based company put another casino on the market around the same time, the Northfield Park Racino in Ohio, that was sold earlier this year to Clairvest Group. The Toronto-based private equity firm owns a number of gambling businesses.

MGM says it notified Sarno in early 2024 that it had a potential buyer lined up, with the hopes it could receive a green light from the city to move forward. It says it agreed to convert 101 State St., next to the casino, into a hotel, per the city’s wishes. The company now argues that Sarno and other city officials were “not acting in good faith” and instead were just trying to delay the sale.

The city and company had gone to arbitration to resolve their issues, and MGM said the city had a deadline of Friday to respond.

MGM became the first full-scale resort-style casino in Massachusetts when it opened its doors in 2018 to much fanfare. (Wynn Resorts opened the only other one in the state the following year, in Everett.) At the time, Sarno joined MGM’s top local executive in a vintage Rolls-Royce to celebrate in a procession down Main Street.

It seems unlikely Sarno will be sharing a car ride with MGM executives now. In the lawsuit, the city complains of unmet promises. The casino has 1,600 slot and video gaming machines and 50 table games today, compared to 2,800-plus machines and at least 75 table games pledged in the community agreement. Likewise, only around 1,500 people work for MGM in the city, with about 1,000 full-timers, well short of the 3,000 workers, including 2,200 full-time employees, that were once promised.

Jon Chesto can be reached at jon.chesto@globe.com. Follow him @jonchesto.

Colorado group suing eatery in East Boston

By Brendan Nordstrom
BOSTON.COM

When La Tavernetta opened its East Boston doors this past April, the founders of the waterfront Italian eatery received a cease-and-desist letter from a Colorado-based restaurant group that same day.

Frasca Hospitality Group, which was founded in Boulder, Colo., has operated a restaurant called Tavernetta in Denver since 2017 and one with the same name in Vail, Colo., since 2024. Now, roughly four months after the letter, a lawsuit alleges the Boston restaurant infringed on its copyright, ultimately confusing customers, according to court records.

FFW IP Holdings, LLC, which owns the trademarks for the Frasca Hospitality Group, is asking a federal court to stop the Boston restaurant from using the name “Tavernetta.” However, the Boston restaurant says differences in the name and location distinguish the two entities.

La Tavernetta, on Lewis Street in East Boston, opened on April 13 as the sister restaurant to MIDA, both of



JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

La Tavernetta in East Boston is the subject of a lawsuit brought by a Colorado hospitality group with two restaurants named Tavernetta.

which are owned and operated by restaurateur duo Seth Gerber and chef Douglass Williams. The restaurant, with a name that means “The Little Tavern” in Italian, serves sandwiches, pasta, and spritzes.

Meanwhile, Tavernetta launched in Denver in 2017 and serves similar upscale Italian food. The restaurant group, which has received Michelin recognition and a James Beard semifinalist nod, trademarked the name in April 2018.

“As set forth in the complaint, our goal is for Mida to stop using our name ‘Tavernetta’ in connection with their restaurant,” wrote Mike Laszlo, who represents Frasca Hospitality Group, in an email to Boston.com.

A federal lawsuit filed in the US District Court in Colorado last month by Frasca Hospitality Group alleges the Boston restaurant deliberately infringed on the Colorado restaurants’ copyrighted title, causing confusion among customers and aiming “its conduct at Colorado consumers.”

“Defendant adopted the Infringing Mark ... for the purpose of trading on the Colorado-originating and nationwide goodwill of Plaintiff and of capturing and diverting to Defendant the consumers who search online for Plaintiff and its Tavernetta Services (id.),” the complaint reads.

The lawsuit points to online reservation portal OpenTable, which lists

TAVERN, Page D2

Hiring burst of 162,000 jobs in August puts focus squarely back on inflation in the US

By Paul Wiseman
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — The US labor market bounced back in August as employers added a surprising 162,000 jobs, ending a summer of lackluster hiring with a bang.

The unemployment rate remained at a low 4.1 percent.

Hiring far exceeded the 65,000 jobs that forecasters had expected, according to a poll by FactSet. Labor Department revisions also looked good, adding 55,000 to June and July payrolls. Employers created 21,000 jobs in July; the Labor Department had originally reported that they’d cut 23,000.

Two months before the midterm elections, President Trump welcomed the strong hiring report Friday. “Great jobs number just announced, breaking all estimates (except mine!) by double and triple - And you haven’t seen anything yet!” Trump wrote in a social media post.

But inflation has dominated conversations this year in business and households. Voters are increasingly frustrated by higher costs, particularly fuel prices that have hit record levels since the US

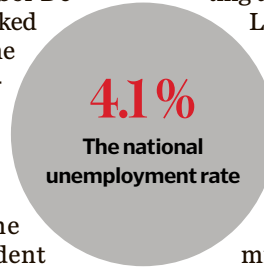
and Israel attacked Iran in late February.

And meager pay raises have made rising prices more painful for many. Average hourly wages rose 3.1 percent last month from a year earlier, the weakest year-over-year increase since May 2021.

Restaurants and bars added 59,000 jobs last month, construction companies 22,000 and manufacturers 16,000. Factory jobs are up by 58,000 since hitting a recent low in December, the Labor Department noted.

And the US labor force — the number of people working or looking for work — jumped by 683,000 last month after falling in June and July.

Diane Swonk, chief economist at the tax and consulting firm KPMG, called the report “incredible. It’s a summer heatwave.” She noted that a broad measure of the unemployment rate — which includes people so discouraged they’ve given up looking for work and those working part time because they can’t find the full-time jobs they want — dropped to 7.7 percent, the lowest in more than a year.



JOBS, Page D2

115

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The Boston Globe

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25

Index of publicly traded companies in Massachusetts

Global 25 Index
Total market cap: \$1,634.6b

High: 266.93
Low: 244.72
Last: 258.31
~10%

Date	Index Value
May 5, 2011	245.00
May 12, 2011	244.72
May 19, 2011	255.00
May 26, 2011	260.00
June 3, 2011	255.00
June 10, 2011	250.00
June 17, 2011	250.00
June 24, 2011	245.00
June 30, 2011	255.00
July 7, 2011	255.00
July 14, 2011	266.93
July 21, 2011	260.00
July 28, 2011	255.00
August 4, 2011	258.31

Yesterday 258.31 ▲ 0.31 ▲ 0.1% ▲ YTD 6.7%				
	Price	Chg	% chg	Market cap (bil.)
GE VERNOVA INC (GEV)	941.95	+0.11	+0.0	250.9
THERMO FISHER (TMO)	613.78	-4.65	-0.8	226.9
ANALOG DEVICES (ADI)	362.25	+5.75	+1.6	175.5
TJX COS INC (TJX)	132.08	-0.11	-0.1	145.3
VERTEX PHARM (VRTX)	546.12	-11.84	-2.1	138.4
AMERICAN TOWER C (AMT)	175.85	-1.90	-1.1	81.9
BOSTON SCIENTIFIC (BSX)	47.80	+0.85	+1.8	69.3
MODERNA INC (MRNA)	145.55	-3.32	-2.2	58.1

TERADYNE INC (TER)	357.03	+18.44	+5.4	55.8
STATE ST CORP (STT)	194.26	+0.32	+0.2	53.4
KEURIG DR PEPPER (KDP)	32.59	-0.29	-0.9	44.3
WATERS CORP (WAT)	409.38	-4.18	-1.0	40.2
ALNYLAM PHARMACE (ALNY)	266.11	+1.61	+0.6	35.6
IRON MOUNTAIN (IRM)	116.86	+1.88	+1.6	34.8
BIORGEN INC (BIBR)	220.83	-3.68	-1.6	32.6

VERVOGEN (VNOV)	220.85	-5.88	-1.8	22.0
EVERSOURCE ENERGY (ES)	71.05	-0.42	-0.6	26.8
SYMBIOTIC INC (SYM)	42.94	+1.34	+3.2	26.0
VERALTO CORP (VLTQ)	96.31	-1.57	-1.6	23.5
ENTEGRIS INC (ENTG)	138.74	+8.04	+6.2	21.2
MACOM TECHNOLOGY (MTSI)	268.95	+9.00	+3.5	20.5
AMGEN INC (AMGN)	269.31	+10.66	+4.2	17.5

MKS INC (MKS)	260.31	+10.86	+4.3	17.6
CLEAN HARBORS (CLH)	317.10	-1.55	-0.5	16.7
PTC INC (PTC)	141.02	-9.06	-6.0	15.3
AKAMAI TECHNOLOG (AKAM)	105.22	-1.28	-1.2	15.1
VICOR CORP (VICR)	188.55	+9.79	+5.5	8.7

Markets

Stocks end week on down note

US stocks fell and Treasury yields rose Friday after the government reported that employers unexpectedly added 162,000 jobs last month, a development that could increase chances that the US central bank will raise interest rates later this month. The S&P 500 fell 0.4%, though it managed to eke out a modest gain for the week. The Dow Jones Industrial Average fell 0.5%, and the Nasdaq composite gave back 0.3%. Wall Street expects the Federal Reserve to raise interest rates before the year ends in an effort to cool inflation, which has been running hot due to rising oil prices amid the US war

increase in pricing last month could give the central bank's policymakers leeway to raise the Fed's benchmark short-term interest rate to fight inflation at their next policy meeting in less than two weeks. "Today's jobs report does lean toward the Fed increasing rates," said Terry Sandven, chief equity strategist at US Bank Asset Management Group, noting, however, that a rate hike is "not a foregone conclusion."

ASSOCIATED PRESS

[illegible]

High: 54,349.12

The chart displays the price of the 12-month futures contract for the S&P 500 index. The y-axis represents the price in dollars, ranging from \$48,000 to \$52,000. The x-axis shows the time period from May 2011 to April 2012. The price starts at approximately \$50,500, peaks at \$52,500 in late 2011, and ends at \$53,414.25 in April 2012. A shaded area indicates a volatility range, and a low point of \$49,918.78 is marked in late 2011.

Date	Price
May 2011	~\$50,500
Low	\$49,918.78
Peak	\$52,500
April 2012	\$53,414.25

Yesterday 53,414.25 ▼ 271.86 ▼ 0.5% ▲ YTD 11.1%

NASDAQ Composite index

High: 26,803.03 Last: 26,506.99

▲10%

S&P 500 index

Yesterday 7,718.60 ▼ 29.11 ▼ 0.4% ▲ YTD 12.8%
SOURCE: Bloomberg News

The Boston Globe

POWER PLAY



Shirley Leung



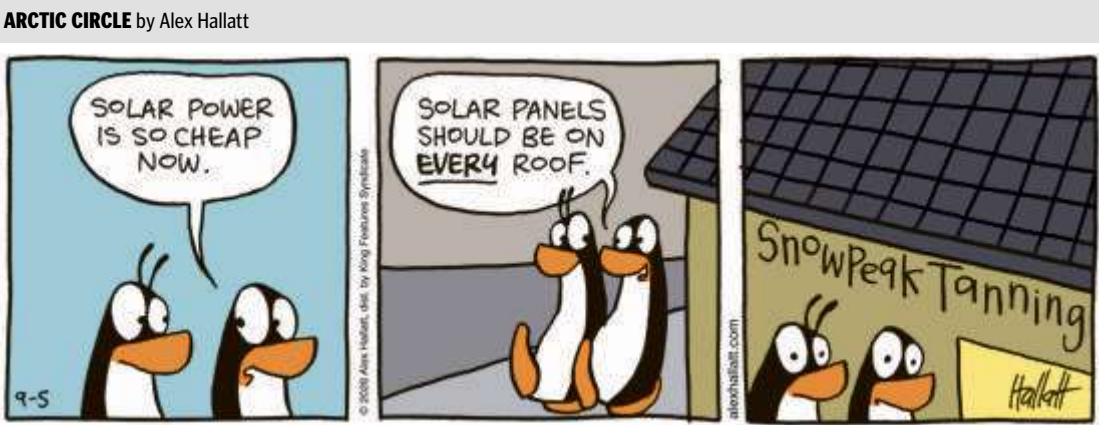
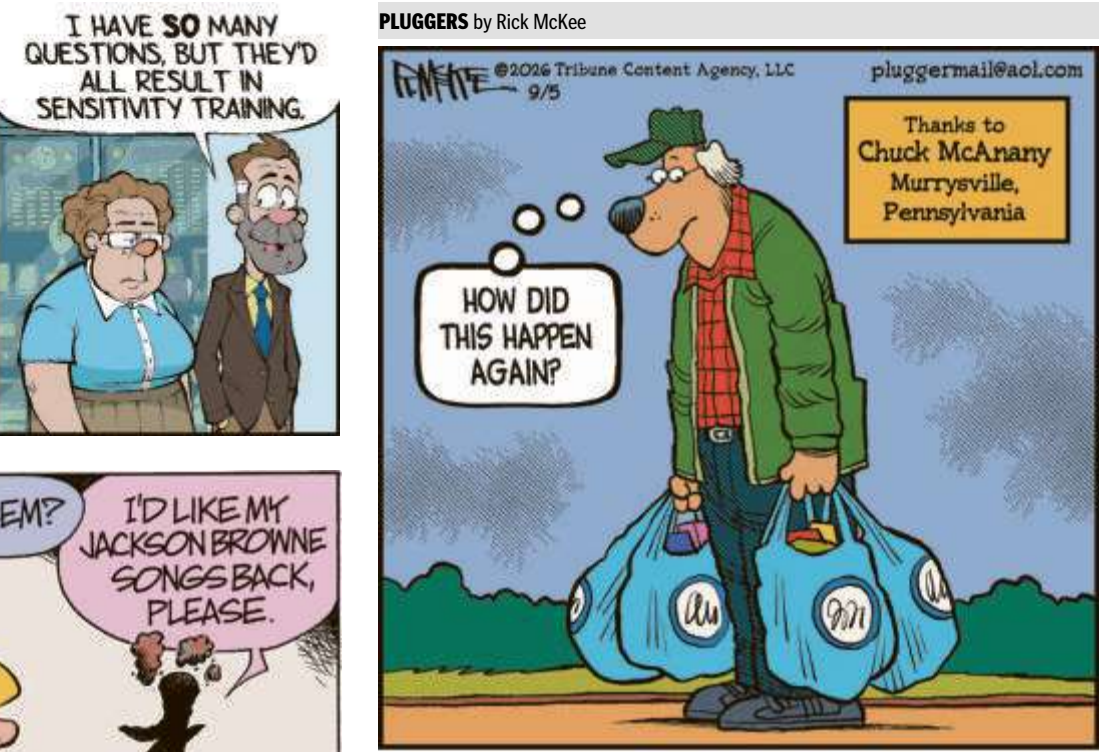
Jon Chesto

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UNIVERSAL CROSSWORD PUZZLE

UNIVERSAL FREESTYLE 238 BY ADRIAN JOHNSON AND ALEXANDRA DOUMANI | EDITED BY AIDAN DESHONG

ACROSS

1 Often-torn knee part, for short

4 Sternward

7 Door fastener

12 Hair claw, for one

14 Response to a vague threat

17 Coastal inlet

18 Citrusy garnish for a gold rush or brandy daisy

19 Applications

20 ___ salts

21 Gym unit

22 First-of-the-month payment

23 Wager

24 Lawn invaders

26 "Moonlight" actor Mahershala

27 ___ & Jerry's

28 Motion pictures, perhaps?

29 Three-ring bender

33 Yankees catcher known for his malapropisms

34 Snitch

36 Gullah spiritual song

37 Qatari banknotes

39 ___ Grant (need-based scholarship)

40 ___ a Bad Mama Jama"

42 "The Cask of Amontillado" author

43 Hawaiian garland

44 Spiny animal such as Knuckles

46 Early TV host and women's golf tournament founder

51 Yuletide carol

52 "Praying for that"

53 Abolitionist Julia Ward whose surname sounds like a question meaning "In what way?"

54 Artistically pruned plant

55 Pattie Gonias artform

56 Game full of quick checks?

57 HS yearbook section

DOWN

1 Precision

2 Thorough examination

3 Adding excitement to

4 Early ISP

5 Complimentary admission

6 Entice

7 "I wasn't done!"

8 "How cute!"

9 Base known as the "hot corner"

10 Instances

11 Letters before ://

13 Annoyance

15 ___ Lobos (Chicano rock band)

16 Strand with a blizzard

23 "Face the facts"

25 English assignment

27 Springy sports figurine

28 Indian state hidden in "Here we go again"

30 Like a fast-motion video of a slow-motion subject

31 401(k) alternatives

32 Magicians' ways out, perhaps

35 Titular battle between Jedi knights and identical troopers

37 Gradually withdraws

38 Landlubber's lack

41 They save the day

45 Like a hi-res broadcast

46 "Mine!"

47 Denny's competitor

48 Zero

49 Ice planet in "The Empire Strikes Back"

50 Fairy-tale monster

JUMBLE CROSSWORDS™

by David L. Hoyt 9-5-26

CLUE

1. ___ seed

5. ___ Anderson

6. Educate

7. Joint

ACROSS

1. ___ seed

5. ___ Anderson

6. Educate

7. Joint

ANSWER

ESASEM

RYHRA

NTAIR

DAESRH

CLUE

1. Clever plan

2. Lengthen

3. London district

4. Veered

DOWN

1. Clever plan

2. Lengthen

3. London district

4. Veered

ANSWER

HCEMES

ETHTRCS

RYAIAFM

ETDUNR

DOUBLE BONUS

The circled letters can be unscrambled to form two different BONUS answers.

How to play

Complete the crossword puzzle by looking at the clues and unscrambling the answers. When the puzzle is complete, unscramble the circled letters to solve the Bonus.

ANSWERS: 1A-Besame 5A-Harry 6A-Train 7A-Share 1D-Scheme 2D-Stretch 3D-Mayfair 4D-Turned B-Testament B-Statement

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CLUE: Proof of a fact or quality

CLUE: Declaration

Boston's forecast

TODAY

6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.

HIGH 69-74

Intervals of clouds and sun with a shower.

LOW 58-63

Winds NNE 8-16 mph. Turning out clear tonight. Winds N 7-14 mph.

SUNDAY

6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.

HIGH 68-73

Sunshine and a few clouds. Winds NNE 8-16 mph. Clear at night. Winds NNW 7-14 mph.

LOW 58-63

MONDAY

6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.

HIGH 74-79

Sunny and beautiful. Winds NNW 7-14 mph. Partly cloudy at night. Winds W 6-12 mph.

LOW 60-65

TUESDAY

6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.

HIGH 78-83

Sunny to partly cloudy. Winds WNW 7-14 mph. Increasing clouds at night. Winds SW 4-8 mph.

LOW 62-67

WEDNESDAY

6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.

HIGH 77-82

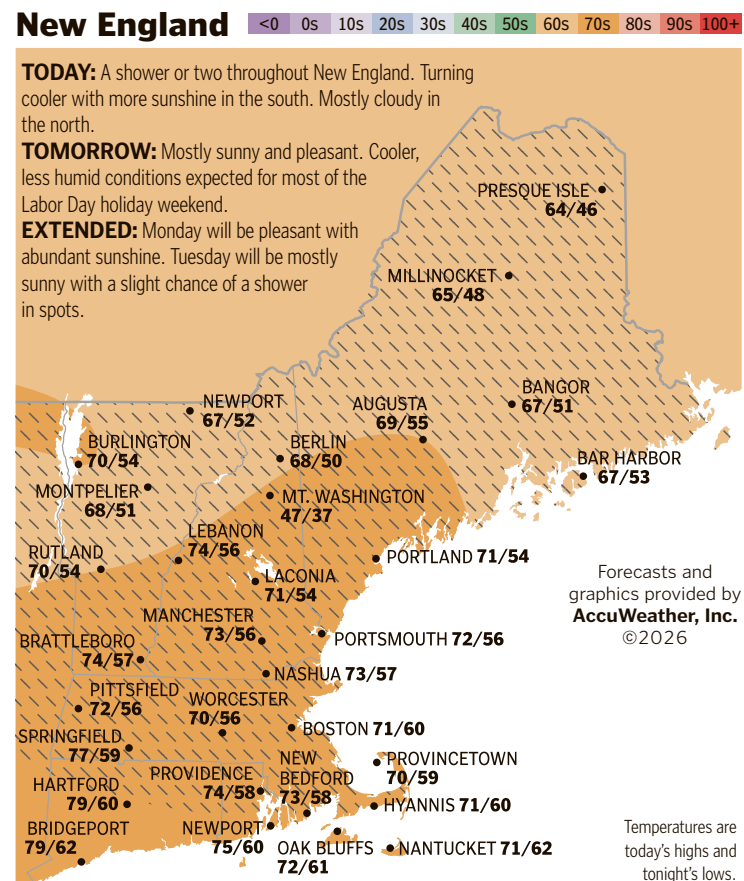
Cloudy. Winds SSW 7-14 mph. Showers Wednesday evening; otherwise, mostly cloudy and warm. Winds SW 10-20 mph.

LOW 68-73

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Cities

Forecast high and low temperatures and conditions

● Travel delays possible, C Clouds, F Fog, H Haze, I Ice, Pc Partly Cloudy, R Rain, Sh Showers, S Sun, Sn Snow, Fl Flurries, T Thunderstorms, W Windy

	Today	Tomorrow		Today	Tomorrow
● Atlanta	96/76 T	97/74 T	● Los Angeles	87/71 Pc	84/72 T
● Atlantic City	82/63 S	75/56 Pc	● Miami	91/78 T	92/79 T
● Charlotte	98/73 T	88/68 Pc	● New Orleans	90/76 T	92/78 T
● Chicago	82/68 T	78/66 S	● New York City	80/63 S	74/63 Pc
● Dallas	98/77 S	100/79 S	● Philadelphia	83/66 S	78/64 Pc
● Denver	90/63 T	92/64 Pc	● Phoenix	101/83 Pc	104/85 Pc
● Detroit	79/61 Pc	77/60 S	● Salt Lake City	90/68 S	84/62 T
● Fort Myers	92/77 T	91/76 T	● San Francisco	72/58 Pc	72/56 Pc

	Today	Tomorrow		Today	Tomorrow
● Seattle	70/52 Pc	72/54 Pc	● Jerusalem	85/68 S	83/68 S
● Washington	83/67 Pc	83/66 Pc	● London	72/56 S	77/61 Pc
● Beijing	93/66 Pc	89/68 S	● Moscow	64/53 Sh	60/47 Sh
● Cancun	93/77 T	93/77 R	● Paris	77/55 Pc	84/63 C
● Mexico City	78/58 Sh	75/58 Sh	● Rome	89/70 S	89/68 S
● Montreal	70/54 C	74/55 S	● San Juan	91/80 T	92/80 T
● Toronto	75/61 S	73/57 S	● Stockholm	59/44 Sh	66/46 S
● Vancouver	68/53 C	68/55 Pc	● Tokyo	78/71 C	78/74 R

HOROSCOPES

HAPPY BIRTHDAY for Saturday, Sept. 5, 2026: You're concerned with the happiness of others. You're empathetic, generous, and imaginative. This is a year of service, perhaps service to family. Therefore, take care of yourself so you can be a support to others when they turn to you for guidance, comfort, solace, and courage.

ARIES (March 21-April 19) Today you're more sensitive about home and family, and might feel hurt if someone makes a disparaging remark. Conversations might be confusing. Someone might make an assumption. Don't agree to anything important today. Just kick back and relax. Tonight: Relax at home.

TAURUS (April 20-May 20) Your imagination is activated today, which is great for those of you who are involved with artistic projects. Many of you might spend time daydreaming today or being lost in a fantasy world. In the real world, make an effort to clarify communications, because it's a "fuzzy" day! Tonight: A conversation.

GEMINI (May 21-June 20) Conversations with friends as well as groups and organizations might be a tad confusing today. You might be dealing with someone's idealism. Or perhaps you are the idealist who confounds someone else. Keep things light. This is a playful, fun-loving day. Tonight: Check your money.

CANCER (June 21-July 22) Today the Moon is in your sign at odds with fuzzy Neptune, which can induce a dreamy state of mind. It can also lend to bad decisions that require clear thinking. It might distort your view of things. Be mindful of excess today. Tonight: You win!

LEO (July 23-Aug. 22) Although your primary focus is on money, cash flow, and your assets right now, today you might be caught up in mystical ideas or spiritual pursuits. If so, be aware that you're in a suggestible frame of mind. Things might not be as they appear. Tread carefully. Tonight: Enjoy privacy.

VIRGO (Aug. 23-Sept. 22) You are basically strong and grounded today because both the Sun and your ruler Mercury are in your sign. Nevertheless, the placement of the Moon might create

confusion in your discussion with friends and groups. You might assume something or be misunderstood. Double-check your communications. Tonight: Be friendly.

LIBRA (Sept. 23-Oct. 22) There is a curious astrological combo taking place today. In one way, you want to hide and be low-key because of the Sun's placement. But in another way, you are high-viz, whether you like it or not, because of the placement of the Moon. (In fact, some people know personal details about your private life.) Tonight: You're admired!

SCORPIO (Oct. 23-Nov. 21) This is a feel-good day for you! If you can travel that would be perfect because you want some adventure, something different. Go someplace you've never been before, even if it's in your own neighborhood. Do something curious or stimulating. Younger people will interest you. Tonight: Explore and learn.

SAGITTARIUS (Nov. 22-Dec. 21) This is a poor day to make important financial decisions about shared property, taxes, debt, mortgages, or anything jointly owned. Confusion, assumptions, misinterpretations, and even deceit are possible. Postpone important fi-

nancial decisions for another day. Tonight: Check your finances.

CAPRICORN (Dec. 22-Jan. 19) Tread carefully today, because the Moon is opposite your sign, which is a bit challenging. Generally speaking, it means you have to go more than halfway when you're dealing with others. You have to be accommodating. Furthermore, an element of confusion exists today. Be aware. Tonight: Listen and cooperate.

AQUARIUS (Jan. 20-Feb. 18) You'll be smart to double-check your work in your job today, because confusion and misunderstandings can lead to problems. Assume nothing. Clarify all your instructions. Incidentally, this same advice will apply to your health. Tonight: Get organized.

PISCES (Feb. 19-March 20) This is a tricky day for romance. You or your partner might over idealize something. You might be disappointed because of unexpressed expectations, or because you had unrealistic expectations. Perhaps there's a plain old misunderstanding. Stay positive. Tonight: Socialize!

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SUDOKU

3	6						
7				2	4	1	
9		5					
				2	9	6	
						3	4
4		9	7	6			5
5	3					4	1

Fill in the grid so that every row, every column, and every 3X3 box contains the digits 1 through 9. Puzzle difficulty levels: Easy on Monday and Tuesday, more difficult on Wednesday and Thursday, most difficult on Friday and Saturday. Tips and computer program at www.sudoku.com.

DAILY BRIDGE CLUB

BY FRANK STEWART
South dealer — N-S vulnerable

North

♠ J 10 9
♥ 7 3
♦ K Q 10 9 5
♣ 7 6 3

West

♠ K 8 6 5 2
♥ Q 10 5
♦ 2
♣ K 10 8 4

East

♠ 7
♥ J 9 8 4 2
♦ A 8 7 6 4
♣ J 9

South

♠ A Q 4 3
♥ A K 6
♦ J 3
♣ A Q 5 2

South

2 NT

West

Pass

North

3 NT

East

All Pass

Opening lead — ♠ 5

“Do you think all tricks are equal?” Cy the Cynic asked me.

“If you're at 3NT and need nine tricks,” I shrugged, “it won't matter whether you win the first nine or the last nine. Actually, it's a saying that ‘a good player loses four tricks early, a poor player loses five tricks late.’”

“I think not,” said Cy. “All tricks are equal, but some are more equal than others — especially Trick One.”

Today's West led a spade against 3NT, and dummy's jack won. Declarer led a diamond to his jack and back to dummy's king. East took the ace and shifted to a heart.

South won and tried leading the queen of spades, but West played low. Then South never saw dummy's high diamonds and was lucky to go down only one.

Cy is right that the play to the first trick can be crucial, and South's was expensive. He should win with the queen of spades. After he forces out the ace of diamonds, he can lead a low spade and reach dummy with the ten to run the diamonds. He makes an overtrick.

DAILY QUESTION You hold: ♠ A Q 4 3 ♥ A K 6 ♦ J 3 ♣ A Q 5 2. Neither side vulnerable. The dealer, at your right, opens three spades. What do you say?

ANSWER: Since room to look for your best contract has been removed, you must guess. Assume your partner has a decent share of the missing high cards. Bid 3NT. A good partner will provide enough points in dummy to give you a chance. If he has nothing, you will go down, but you must take a chance so as not to be stolen from.

ZIPPY “Bed and Disinfectant” by Bill Griffith



BIZARRO by Wayno & Piraro



MOTHER GOOSE & GRIMM by Mike Peters



ADAM@HOME by Rob Harrell



ROSE IS ROSE by Pat Brady & Don Wimmer



Today's Crossword Solution

S	R	S		S	S	E	H	C	D	E	P	S			
G	V	R	D		E	R	L	I	V	S	N	O	B		
E	M	O	H		D	O	G	O	L	E	P	O	H	I	
T	E	O	N		E	R	O	H	S	H	V	N	I	D	
V	N	D	I	H	C	O	E		I	E	T				
E	O	P		S	E	H	S		T	I	E	P			
S	T	V	A	I	R	V	A	V	B	W	U	K			
	C	R	V	N		V	R	R	E	B	I	G	O	A	
						S	I	N	O	I	L	N	O	C	
						S	I	G	N	E	B		I	T	V
	S	D	E	E	M		L	E	B		L	N	E	R	
P	E	R			W	O	S	P	E		S	E	S	U	
T	S	I	M	T	N	O	W	E	T		E	V	O	C	
T	V	H	M	E	S	T	E	R	O		P	I	T	C	
H	C	T	A	T		T	F	A			C	L			

Today's Sudoku Solution

1	4	7	2	8	6	9	3	5
5	8	2	3	9	7	6	1	4
3	9	6	5	1	4	7	8	2
4	6	3	7	5	8	1	2	9
7	1	5	9	6	2	3	4	8
8	2	9	1	4	3	5	7	6
6	7	4	8	3	9	2	5	1
9	3	1	4	2	5	8	6	7
2	5	8	6	7	1	4	9	3



JORDAN STRAUSS/INVISION/AP/FILE

The Aflac campaign is just the latest foray into the world of big brand ads for Ben Affleck and his Artists Equity team.

Ben Affleck and Aflac duck unite for ad campaign

Ben Affleck has a new on-screen partner, and he's a bit of a quack.

The acclaimed actor and director is teaming up with insurance company Aflac for a new campaign that will, naturally, pair Affleck with the Aflac duck mascot. The company has updated many of its social accounts to include a new headshot drawing of Affleck alongside his new fowl friend. Aflac also shared a new image on social media Thursday, featuring the star smirking at the duck as they sit on a couch together.

According to the Hollywood Reporter, Affleck will star in a new campaign opposite the famed Aflac duck, which is set to run through next summer. The Cambridge-raised Oscar winner and Artists Equity (the production company founded by Affleck and Matt Damon) will also helm the spots, with Affleck set to direct them with Brandon Pierce, co-president of advertising and executive creative director at Artists Equity.

“What started as a coincidental word play ended up being a true connection between an iconic brand and an

iconic man,” Pierce told THR.

Prior to this week’s reveal, there was already speculation over an Affleck-Aflac team-up brewing, as mysterious signs for the company graffitied with the star’s last name started popping up across Los Angeles last month. Earlier this week, TMZ also shared images of Affleck wearing a gray hoodie and jeans as he tagged an Aflac sign with spray paint in an alleyway. Now it seems the cat — or rather duck — is out of the bag.

The Aflac campaign is just the latest foray into the world of big brand ads for Affleck and his Artists Equity team. Affleck, of course, has become the face of Dunkin’ in recent years thanks to his star-studded commercials for the Canton-based coffee chain, including the popular DunKings Super Bowl spots.

Outside of ad campaigns, it’s been a busy year for Affleck. In March, his AI startup InterPositive was acquired by Netflix for \$587 million. The streamer also signed Artist Equity to a first look deal following the success of “The Rip,” the crime thriller starring Affleck and Damon, which premiered on Netflix in January. Affleck’s next flick, “Animals,” debuts on Netflix Oct. 9.

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As we celebrate Labor Day, let’s re-examine a letter from 10 years ago. I *think* I still agree with my 2016 advice, but I can see where the commenters are coming from.

Check out a brand new “Love Letters” podcast episode where we investigate why so many people have trouble with in-laws — mother-in-laws specifically.

A storyteller explains her unique take on her own mother-in-law — and has some tips.

You can find the episode wherever you get podcasts — or at www.boston-globe.com/lifestyle/relationships/love-letters.

Q. I’ve been dating a guy, Rob, since February. We met on OKCupid. We’re both 31, had serious relationships that took up a chunk of our 20s (four years for him, three years for me), and we both entered this looking for something casual.

The first six weeks or so did feel casual, but since then I have developed serious feelings for him. Rob is everything I want in a guy. We just click when we’re together, and we have the exact same sense of humor. He gets along great with my friends and ditto with his friends. The intimate part of the relationship is great as well.

What’s the catch, you might ask? He’s not going to be in Boston much longer. You see, Rob is a consultant and his project ends next month. He is based out of “elsewhere,” where he is from, and says he sees himself raising a family there.

I’m a Boston gal through and through. I love my job here, I love having my family close, and I love my friends and the life I’ve created. Now, I would consider relocating for the right guy, but after six months I don’t think I’m ready to declare Rob that just yet. I wouldn’t even call him my boyfriend, just a guy I’m seeing. This is still the stage where we are getting to really know each other. We haven’t defined the relationship because I haven’t felt a need to. We have talked some about what happens when he moves. His company is headquartered here, and although he is going to be assigned a

LOVE LETTERS CLASSICS

BY MEREDITH GOLDSTEIN

He’s leaving Boston

new project, he says he will be back about twice a month or maybe more. But is that any way to truly develop a relationship?

We have both been casually seeing other people since we first started dating, which I believe is healthy, although I have found myself less interested in other guys. It seems like we’re on the same page in that department, though we don’t go into too much detail other than dating horror stories. I don’t want to tell him not to see other women when he lives elsewhere full time.

Some of my friends say just to cut bait now because this appears that this is going to end badly. Other friends say just see where it goes. If we like each other and have fun together, there is no need to end it. I wonder though if that is wasting my time and setting us up for further heartbreak later. What should I do?

NOT READY TO DTR

A. There’s no harm in continuing this relationship after he moves elsewhere. You talk about possible heartbreak, but it doesn’t seem like a huge risk. After all, it doesn’t seem to bother you that this guy is still seeing other people. You don’t seem stressed about the fact that he could have a great date and fall for someone else. If you can stay casual in the same town, why not long-distance?

My only thought is that the distance will require more effort from both of you. If you’re keeping in touch because you see a possible future, you’ll have to reach out more, share your feelings, and find new ways to feel close. You’ll also have to be honest about when it’s time to define the relationship. If distance goes well, you’ll want to.

MEREDITH

READERS RESPOND:

His wife and kids will be happy to have him home.

VALENTINO—

I disagree with Meredith that there is no harm in continuing with Rob after he leaves. Clinging to the illusion that this relationship is going anywhere may keep you from finding

something more substantive. If the guy really cared about you, he wouldn’t be OK with your seeing other people. Just say thanks for the memories, and end it.

BLUEAWNING

A casual long-distance relationship? Too much work. ... Find someone nearby. If he leaves and decides he can’t live without you, he will call.

THENURSE

Basically this boils down to one thing: After failed long-term relationships in your 20s, both of you guys are gun shy about making a big commitment. Neither one of you is willing to give up “home” and make a change geographically without a guarantee. Understand neither one of you will be available for a serious commitment until you both break through that scar tissue and are willing to take a risk.

HEYTTHINK

My advice: Don’t stress or be a drama queen to him about the situation. Don’t talk it to death with friends either, or you will just get more mixed up. Remind yourself that you and he agreed to be casual, and you will end it that way — and act like a grown-up. At the very least, you had some fun and identified some things that you’d like to find in a long-term partner. After he leaves, don’t sit around moping and living for his calls or texts. Don’t chase him, either; I’ve never seen that end well. If he wants to be exclusive with you in a long-term relationship and for you to not date others, he will tell you, but I wouldn’t hold my breath, hon, based on my impression from this letter. Last advice ... I would suggest not being so inflexible that you’ll never leave Boston. Good luck.

JIVEDIVA

Send your own relationship and dating questions to loveletters@globe.com. Catch new episodes of Meredith Goldstein’s “Love Letters” podcast wherever you listen to podcasts. Column and comments are edited and reprinted from boston.com/loveletters.

Saturday September 5, 2026

	7 pm	7:30	8 pm	8:30	9 pm	9:30	10 pm	10:30	11 pm	11:30
2	WGBH PBS Local, USA	Local, USA	Mr Bates-Post	Mr Bates-Post	Mr Bates-Post	Mr Bates-Post	Downton Abbey on Masterpiece			Antiques "D-Day"
4	WBZ CBS Post-game	Jeopardy!	Harlan "Shot in the Dark"	48 Hours	48 Hours	48 Hours	News	(35) Gourmet		
5	WCVB ABC Football (Live)	College Football Stadium as both teams kick off the 2026 season.	Clemson at LSU (Live)	LSU plays host to the 2026 season.	Clemson at Tiger (Live)	NewsCenter 5	(35) CityLine			
6	WLNE ABC Saturday Night Live	Saturday Night Live	Saturday Night Live	Saturday Night Live	Saturday Night Live	Saturday Night Live	Saturday Night Live			
7	WHDH (N)	Broa-dway (N)	Family Feud	Family Feud	7 News at 9PM	7 News at 10PM	7 News at 11PM	(35) Extra (N)		
9	WMUR ABC Football	College Football Clemson at LSU	(Live)	(Live)	(Live)	(Live)	News	Chaos		
10	NBC Boston Big Ten (Live)	College Football Western Michigan at Michigan	(Live)	(Live)	(Live)	(Live)	Boston News	SNL		
10	NBC Boston Big Ten (Live)	College Football Western Michigan at Michigan	(Live)	(Live)	(Live)	(Live)	News (Live)	SNL		
11	WENH PBS Murder "Death by Miss Adventure"	Father "The Horns of Cernunnos"	Boniface "There's No 1 in Slaughter"	Death in Paradise	Astrid "Mandala"					
12	WPRI CBS Post-game	Jeopardy!	Harlan "Shot in the Dark"	48 Hours	48 Hours	48 Hours	12 News at 11	Recovery TV		
25	WFTX FOX MLB Baseball	New York Yankees at San Diego Padres From PETCO Park in San Diego.	(Live)	(Live)	(Live)	(Live)	9-1-1 "Monsters"	The 1% Club "The 1% Smack Down"		
27	WUNI (6:30) Fútbol Mexicano Primera División Querétaro vs. Monterrey	(N) (Live)	Fútbol Mexicano Primera División América vs. Tijuana	(N) (Live)	Fútbol Atlas vs. Atlante	(N) (Live)				
36	WSBE PBS (6:30) The Highwaymen Live	Billy Joel: The 100th -- Live at Madison Square Garden					Our Town RI "Tiverton"	Price of Admission: Black Baseball		
38	WSBK College Football	Edward Waters at Jackson State From Mississippi Veterans Memorial Stadium in Jackson, Miss.	(N) (Live)	(Live)	(Live)	(Live)	The Connors	WOW - Women Tag Team Fortunes	(N)	
44	WGBX PBS (6:00) Caregiving	Billy the Kid	Made in the West	Austin City Limits (N) (SP)	Austin City Limits "Jorge Drexler"					
50	WWJE The Devil You Know	The Devil You Know	Killer Cases	Killer Cases	Meet					
56	WLVI CW (6:30) NASCAR	NASCAR O'Reilly Auto Parts Series Fleetio 200 From Darlington Raceway in Darlington, S.C.	(N) (Live)	(Live)	(Live)	(Live)	College Football UNLV at Hawaii	(Live)		
64	WNAC FOX (6:30) MLB Baseball	New York Yankees at San Diego Padres From PETCO Park in San Diego.	(N) (Live)	(Live)	(Live)	(Live)	12 News	Seinfeld	The 1% Club "The 1% Smack Down"	
68	WBPX ION (6:30) NWSL	Angel City FC at Racing Louisville FC	(Live)	NWSL-Post	Law & Order: Special Victims Unit	Law-SVU "A Misunderstanding"	Law-SVU "Forty-One Witnesses"			
PREMIUM CABLE										
Cinemax	(25) ★★ Cocktail ('88) Bryan Brown, Elisabeth Shue, Tom Cruise. (P)		(05) ★★ Risky Business ('83) Tom Cruise.	(45) ★★ The Outsiders ('83) C. Thomas Howell, Matt Dillon.						
Flix	(6:00) ★★ Escape From Alcatraz ('79)	★ ★ A Perfect Murder ('98) Gwyneth Paltrow, Michael Douglas.		(55) ★★ Fatal Attraction ('87) Glenn Close, Anne Archer, Michael Douglas.						
HBO	(5:50) ★★ Blue Beetle ('23)	★ ★ Fuze ('25) Theo James, Aaron Taylor-Johnson.		(40) Lanterns "OutKast"	(35) Conan O'	(20) ★★ Zombieland (P)				
HBO 2	(6:50) Lanterns	(45) Lanterns "Trust Fall"	(35) Lanterns "OutKast"	(35) ★★ The Revenant ('15) Tom Hardy, Domhnall Gleeson, Leonardo DiCaprio.						
Paramount-Sho	(6:05) ★★ Dunkirk ('17)	★ ★ Godzilla ('14) Ken Watanabe, Elizabeth Olsen, Aaron Taylor-Johnson.		(05) ★★ 300 ('07) Lena Headey, David Wenham, Gerard Butler.						
Showtime 2	(6:00) ★★ My Cousin Vinny ('92)	★ ★ The Hangover ('09) Ed Helms, Bradley Cooper.	(45) ★★ The Hangover Part II ('11) Ed Helms, Bradley Cooper.							Hangover Part III
Starz!	(05) Fightland	★ ★ Southpaw ('15) Forest Whitaker, Naomie Harris, Jake Gyllenhaal. (P)		(05) Fightland	★ ★ Michael ('26) Jaafar Jackson.					
TMC	(6:05) The Relic ('25) Corey Pettit.	★ ★ The Ring ('02) Martin Henderson, David Dorfman, Naomi Watts.		★ ★ The Ring Two ('05) Simon Baker, David Dorfman, Naomi Watts.						
SPORTS										
CBSSN	College Football	Idaho State at Utah State	The Utah State Aggies host the Idaho State Bengals in Logan for an NCAA football game.	(N) (Live)	College Football	Western Kentucky at Nevada	(N) (Live)			
ESPN	College Football	Missouri State at Texas A&M	(N) (Live)	Scoreboard	College Football	UCLA at California	(N) (Live)			
ESPN2	2026 US Open Tennis Men's & Women's Third Round	From the USTA Billie Jean King National Tennis Center in Flushing, N.Y.	(N) (Live)	30 for 30	Unmatched					
Fox Sports 1	College Football	Abilene Christian at Texas Tech	(N) (Live)	College Football	Central Michigan at New Mexico	(N) (Live)				
Golf	(4:30) DP World Tour Golf		Golf Central	2026 Walker Cup Day 1						
NBA	Stories	Stories	NBA Social Vol. 1	NBA Shot Clock	Best of Vol. 5	Stories				
NBC Sports	Pats Podcast	Tom Curran's	Pats Podcast	Quick Snap	Pats Podcast	Football	United Fight Alliance UFA 492	World Chase Tag		
NESN	MLB Baseball	Boston Red Sox at Baltimore Orioles	(N) (Live)	Extra	Red Sox	MLB Baseball				
FAMILY										
Cartoon	Burgers	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	RickMorty	RickMorty	RickMorty		
Disney	(6:30) ★★ Cars 2 ('11) Owen Wilson.	(25) ★★ Cars 3 ('17) Voices of Cristela Alonzo, Armie Hammer, Owen Wilson.	(25) Phineas	(55) Ladybug						
Encore Family	(6:30) Oddball ('15)	(05) Red Dog: True Blue ('16)	(35) The Ladybug	(55) My Dog the Champion						
Nickelodeon	★ ★ Harry Potter and the Half-Blood Prince ('09) Daniel Radcliffe.	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang						
Nick Jr.	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..		

Content Ratings: TV-Y Appropriate for all children; TV-Y7 For children age 7 and older; TV-G General audience; TV-PG Parental guidance suggested; TV-14 May be unsuitable for children under 14; TV-MA Mature audience only Additional symbols: D Suggestive dialogue; FV Fantasy violence; L Strong language; S Sexual activity; V Violence; HD High-Definition; (CC) Close-Captioned

	7 pm	7:30	8 pm	8:30	9 pm	9:30	10 pm	10:30	11 pm	11:30
BASIC CABLE										
A&E	Storage "Million Dollar Brand"	Storage Wars	Storage Wars "All About Steve"	Storage Wars	(05) Storage Wars					
AMC	(5:00) The Fugitive	★ ★ Men in Black ('97)	★ ★ Men in Black II ('02)							
Animal Planet	Dr. Jeff: Rocky Mountain Vet	Dr. Jeff: RMV "The Lion's Den"	Dr. Jeff: RMV "Beware of Cat"	Dr. Dee: "On the Edge of Nowhere"	Dr. Dee: Alaska Vet "High on the Hog"					
BBC America	★ ★ Rambo ('08) Sylvester Stallone.	★ Rambo: Last Blood ('19)	Law Abiding Citizen							
BET	The Equalizer "Bout That Life"	The Equalizer "Legacy"	★ ★ Kill Bill: Vol. 1 ('03) Lucy Liu, Vivica A. Fox, Uma Thurman.							
Bravo	★ ★ ★ Titanic ('97) Kate Winslet, Billy Zane, Leonardo DiCaprio. Two lovers from different backgrounds fall in love on the maiden voyage of the R.M.S. Titanic.		Below Deck "Pardon Your French"							
CMT	★ ★ ★ Dirty Dancing ('87) Jennifer Grey.	★ ★ ★ Grease ('78) John Travolta.								
CNN	CNN Newsroom	Decades In 1990s	Decades In 1980s	Decades In 1970s	Decades In 2000s					
Comedy Central	(6:30) ★★ The Waterboy ('98) Kathy Bates, Adam Sandler.	★ ★ ★ 21 Jump Street ('12) Channing Tatum, Brie Larson, Jonah Hill.	★ ★ ★ 22 Jump Street ('14)							
CSPAN	Washington This Week	Public Affairs Events	Public Affairs Events							
CSPAN2	America	America	Lectures in History	C-SPAN Presiden..	(10) C-SPAN Tours	America 250				
Dest. America	Food Par. "Stuffed"	Food Paradise	Food Paradise	Carn Eats	Carn Eats	Carn Eats	Carn Eats			
Discovery	Expedition	Expedition Unknown	Expedition Unknown	Expedition Unknown	Expedition Unknown					
Discovery Life	Mystery Diagnosis	Mystery Diagnosis	Mystery Diagnosis	Mystery Diagnosis	Mystery Diagnosis					
E!	Movie	(40) ★★ Horrible Bosses ('11)	(35) ★★ Horrible Bosses 2 ('14) Jason Bateman.							
Encore	(6:30) ★★ Minority Report ('02)	Jack Ryan: Shadow Recruit	(50) ★★ The Da Vinci Code							
Food	Diners, Drive, In	Diners, Drive, In	Diners, Drive, In	Diners, Drive, In	Diners, Drive, In	Diners, Drive, In	Diners, Drive, In			
Fox News	Weekend (Live)	Life (Live)	My View (Live)	Saturday (Live)	Gutfeld!					
Freeform	Movie	(50) ★★ ★★ Beauty and the Beast ('91)	(50) ★★ ★★ Aladdin ('92) Scott Weinger.							
FUSE	(6:30) Ma..	Elvis: Death	BKB 58: Miami							My Big
FX	(6:00) ★★ ★★ Star Wars: A New Hope	★ ★ ★★ Star Wars: The Empire Strikes Back ('80) Mark Hamill.								
FXM	(6:25) ★★ ★★ Saturday Night	(40) ★★ ★★ Once Upon a Time... In Hollywood ('19) Leonardo DiCaprio.								
Hallmark	(6:00) Missing the B...	Haunted Harmony Mysteries: Prelude to a...	Love Finds You ('26) Aimee Teegarden.							
Hallmark Myst.	(6:00) Emma	Emma Fielding "More Bitter Than Death"	Murder, She Wrote	Murder, She Wrote	Murder, She Wrote					
HGTV	House Hunters	House Hunters	House Hunters	House Hunters	House Hunters					
History	UnXplained "Serial Killer Creatures"	The UnXplained	The UnXplained	(05) The UnXplained	(05) The UnXplained					
HLN	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic			
HSN	Diane	La-Z-Boy (N) (Live)	Nakery Beauty	Nakery Beauty	Nakery Beauty					
ID	Fear Thy Neighbor "Bloodland"	Seduced to Slay "Thrill Kill"	Seduced to Slay	Seduced "Star Crossed Killers"	Seduced "Three-Ring Murder"					
IFC	Movie	(45) ★★ ★★ Django Unchained ('12) Christoph Waltz, Leonardo DiCaprio, Jamie Foxx.	Movie							
Lifetime	(6:00) Abducted Off ...	Surviving the Silence: Roxane Gay Story	(05) I Am Mary Jo Buttafuoco ('26)							
LMN	(6:00) Killer in the W...	Dead Girl Summer ('25) Sydney Hamm.	The Bear Lake Murders ('25)							
MAGN	Lakefront Barg	Lakefront Barg	Lakefront Barg							
MSNBC	The Weekend	Connect With	Crooked on	The Rachel	The Beat: Weekend					
MTV	★ ★ Just Go With It ('11) Adam Sandler.	(45) ★★ ★★ Pitch Perfect ('12) Anna Kendrick.								
National Geographic	..Smuggler "Bud Bound for Britain"	..Smuggler "Meth-Mom Mayhem"	To Catch a Smuggler (N)	Contraband "Carry-On Cannabis" (N)	..Smuggler "Meth-Hot Chili Peppers"					
NatGeoWild	Life Below Zero	Life Below Zero	Life Below Zero	Superbeast (N)	Port Protection					
NECN	On Her	OpenHou..	1st Look /Rescue	On Her	HUBToday	1st Look	Rescue			
NewsNation	Batya	NewsNation	NewsNation	NewsNation	Batya					
Ovation	Leverage "The Nigerian Job"	Leverage	Leverage	Leverage	Leverage					
OWN	Iyanla: Inside	Iyanla: Inside (N)	Put a Ring	Put a Ring	Iyanla: Inside					
Oxygen	Unknown Ser	Unknown Ser	Unknown Ser	Unknown Ser	Real Murders					
Paramount	(6:35) Yel..	(40) Yellowstone	(40) Yellowstone	(50) Yellowstone	Yellowst..	Yellowst..				
QVC	Power (N) (Live)	Belle by Kim Gravel -- Fashion (N) (Live)	Sandra Bennett's (N) (Live)							
Science	Hunting Atlantis	Hunting Atlantis	Hunting Atlantis	Hunting Atlantis	Hunting Atlantis					
Sundance	★ ★ ★ Conan the Barbarian ('82) James Earl Jones, Sandahl Bergman, Arnold Schwarzenegger.	★ ★ Conan the Destroyer ('84) Grace Jones, Wilt Chamberlain, Arnold Schwarzenegger.								
SyFy	(5:30) The Mask	★ ★ ★ The Goonies ('85) Josh Brolin, Sean Astin.	★ ★ ★ The Mask ('94)							
TBS	(5:30) ★ Blended	★ ★ Practical Magic ('98) (P)	(05) ★★ Father of the Bride ('91)							
TCM	(6:00) A Little Roma...	★ ★ ★ Fat City ('72) Stacy Keach.	★ ★ ★ Inside Moves ('80) John Savage.							
TLC	Double Lives	Double Lives (N)	Double Lives (N)	Last Resort	Last Resort					
TNT	(4:00) Lord of the Ri...	All Elite Wrestling: Collision	★ ★ The Accountant ('16) Ben Affleck.							
Travel	Ghost Adventures	Ghost Adventures	Ghost Adventures	Ghost Adventures	Ghost Adventures					
TruTV	(6:00) Central Intelli...	★ ★ ★ Ocean's Twelve ('04) George Clooney.	(45) ★★ ★★ The Suicide Squad							
TV Land	Seinfeld	Seinfeld	Seinfeld	Seinfeld	Seinfeld					
TV One	GoodTim..	GoodTim..	GoodTim..	GoodTim..	GoodTim..					
USA	(6:00) College Football	Wyoming at Colorado State (Live)	College Football	Portland State at San Diego State From Snapdragon Stadium in San Diego.	(N) (Live)					
VH-1	(5:30) New Jack City	★ ★ I Know What You Did Last Summer ('97)	★ ★ ★ Last Night in Soho (P)							
WE	NCIS "Faith"	NCIS "Ignition"	NCIS	NCIS "Jet Lag"	NCIS "Masquerade"					